

Name: \_\_\_\_\_



Created by Austen Cloud  
v 0.4.3

drink water

# *Support the author!*

I hope the information within this book gives you a thorough understanding and greater confidence in forging your own choreographed sequences!

Your support can play an important role in this system's development.

A donation of any amount is deeply appreciated.



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# READ ME FIRST

Greetings, flow arts aficionado!

You've come across The Kinetic Alphabet, a notation system designed to help you craft and communicate your own unique choreography. This grid-based language is designed for music, using pictographs and letters that combine like puzzle pieces for each beat. This system has propelled my sequence creation to new heights, and I hope it will do the same for you!

The Kinetic Alphabet is a fusion of elements from VTG (Vulcan Tech Gospel), siteswap (Juggling Notation), and musical notation. Although it can be introduced to beginners, it's designed for intermediate learners, bridging the gap between improvisation and choreography. Originally built for double staves, it can be applied to any dual wielded static prop like clubs, fans, triads, buugeng, and more.

Pictographs form the core of The Kinetic Alphabet.

The letters are a useful tool to categorize and communicate the pictographs, but they are secondary to the pictographs themselves. It's not necessary to memorize the letters immediately to benefit from this system.

This is a work-in-progress and has many steps before reaching its final form. Please remember this when judging its contents. Whether you fully embrace this system, draw inspiration from certain parts, or follow a different path altogether, I hope the ideas presented here contribute to your creative growth.

I can't wait to see the unique choreography you'll create!

With love,  
Austen Cloud

A handwritten signature in black ink, reading "Austen Cloud". The signature is fluid and cursive, with the first name "Austen" and the last name "Cloud" clearly distinguishable.

# Table of Contents

## 1.0 - Positions / Motions

|                                                        |    |
|--------------------------------------------------------|----|
| The Grid .....                                         | 1  |
| Hand Positions .....                                   | 2  |
| Hand Motions .....                                     | 3  |
| Type 1, <b>Dual-Shifts</b> - Alpha, Beta .....         | 4  |
| Gamma / Type 2 - <b>Shifts</b> .....                   | 5  |
| Type 3/4 - <b>Cross-Shifts</b> and <b>Dashes</b> ..... | 6  |
| Type 5/6 - <b>Dual-Dashes</b> and <b>Statics</b> ..... | 7  |
| Staff Positions .....                                  | 8  |
| Staff Motions .....                                    | 9  |
| Negative Space / Body Turns .....                      | 10 |

## 1.1 - Letters

|                                    |    |
|------------------------------------|----|
| <b>Base Letters</b> .....          | 11 |
| Double Staff .....                 | 12 |
| Clubs .....                        | 14 |
| Buugeng (same) .....               | 16 |
| Buugeng (opp) .....                | 18 |
| Triads .....                       | 20 |
| Fans .....                         | 22 |
| Mini Hoops .....                   | 24 |
| <b>Type 1 - Dual-Shifts</b> .....  | 26 |
| ABC, GHI .....                     | 27 |
| DJ, EK, FL .....                   | 28 |
| MP, NQ, OR, STUV .....             | 30 |
| <b>Type 2 - Shifts</b> .....       | 32 |
| WXYZ, ΣΔΘΩ .....                   |    |
| <b>Type 3 - Cross-Shifts</b> ..... | 33 |
| W-X-Y-Z-, Σ-Δ-Θ-Ω- .....           |    |
| <b>Type 4,5,6 -</b> .....          | 34 |
| Φ, Ψ, Λ .....                      |    |
| Φ-, Ψ-, Λ- .....                   |    |
| α, β, Γ .....                      |    |

## 1.2 - Words

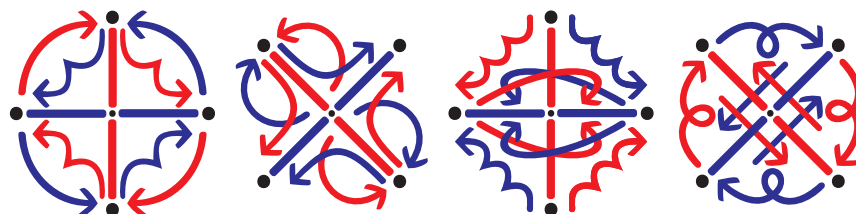
|                                  |       |
|----------------------------------|-------|
| Words .....                      | 36    |
| Permutations .....               | 37    |
| Reversals .....                  | 38    |
| Examples with A,B,C .....        | 39-41 |
| Misc. Permutation Examples ..... | 42-48 |

## 1.3 - Single-Turns

|                          |       |
|--------------------------|-------|
| Single Turns .....       | 50    |
| Glyphs / PADS .....      | 52    |
| Pro/Anti .....           | 53    |
| Leading/Following .....  | 54    |
| Shift/Static .....       | 55    |
| Shift/Dash .....         | 56    |
| Dash/Static .....        | 57    |
| Opening vs Closing ..... | 58    |
| Dash/Dash .....          | 59    |
| Static/Static .....      | 60    |
| 1 1 Examples .....       | 61-63 |
| 1 0 Letters .....        | 64-66 |
| 1 1 Letters .....        | 67-69 |

## 1.4 - Double-Turns

|                                  |       |
|----------------------------------|-------|
| Double Turns .....               | 70-71 |
| 2 0 .....                        | 72-74 |
| 2 1 .....                        | 75-78 |
| 2 2 .....                        | 79-81 |
| What's next? .....               | 82    |
| Call to Action! .....            | 83    |
| VTG links and Taco Tuesday ..... | 84    |

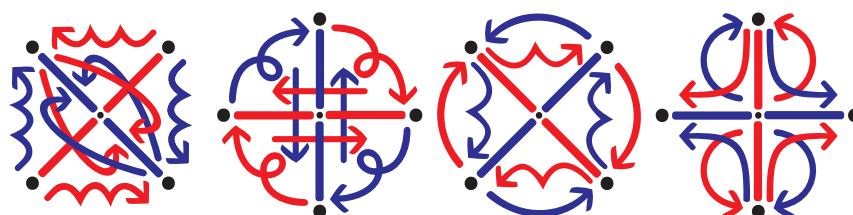


1.0



*Positions*

*Motions*



# The Grid

The Kinetic Alphabet is based on a 4-point grid.

There are two 4-point grids: box mode and diamond mode.

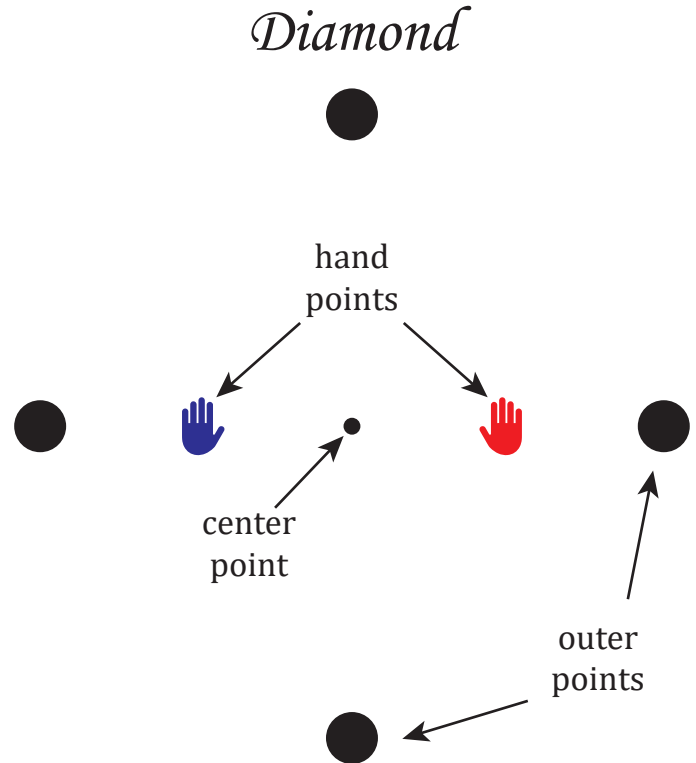
**This guide is written in diamond, but everything translates to box.**

On this grid, there are three types of points:

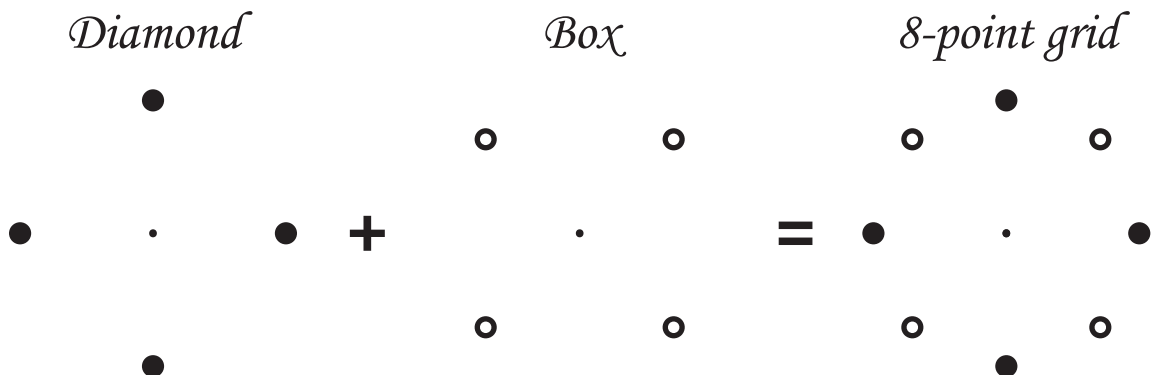
The **center point** is the hub that everything revolves around.

The four **hand points** are halfway between the center point and the outer points.

The **outer points** depict the outer edges of the grid.



Together, diamond and box form an 8-point grid:



For now, we'll use diamond mode to learn each concept.

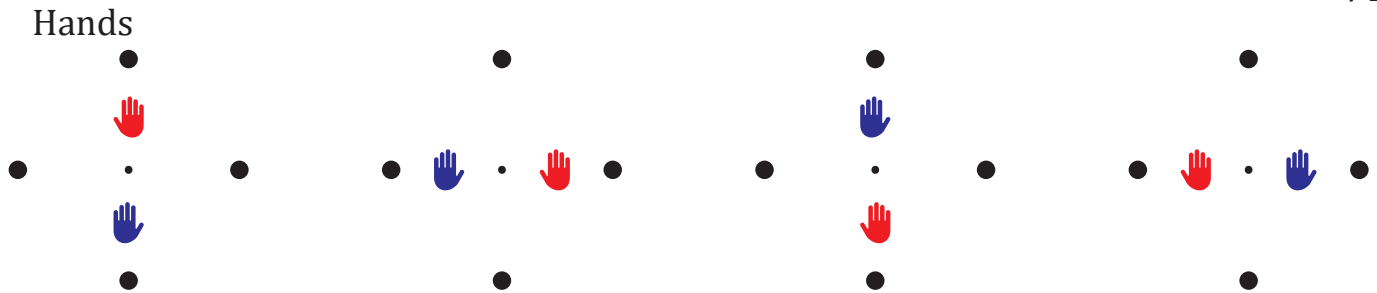
# Hand Positions

There are multiple ways to combine two hand points to form a hand position.  
As shown in these variations, positions can be rotated or mirrored.  
**Red = Right** and **Blue = Left**,

In The Kinetic Alphabet, our first three positions are called Alpha, Beta, and Gamma.

## α Alpha

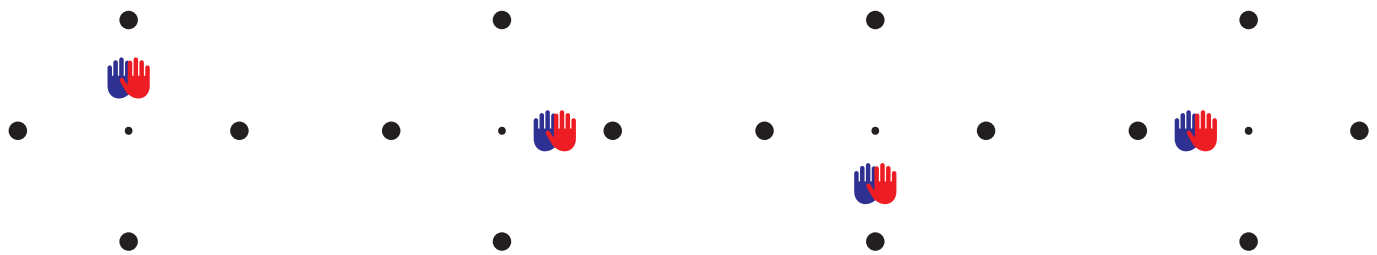
VTG: SS



*In Alpha, the hands occupy the points across from each other.*

## β Beta

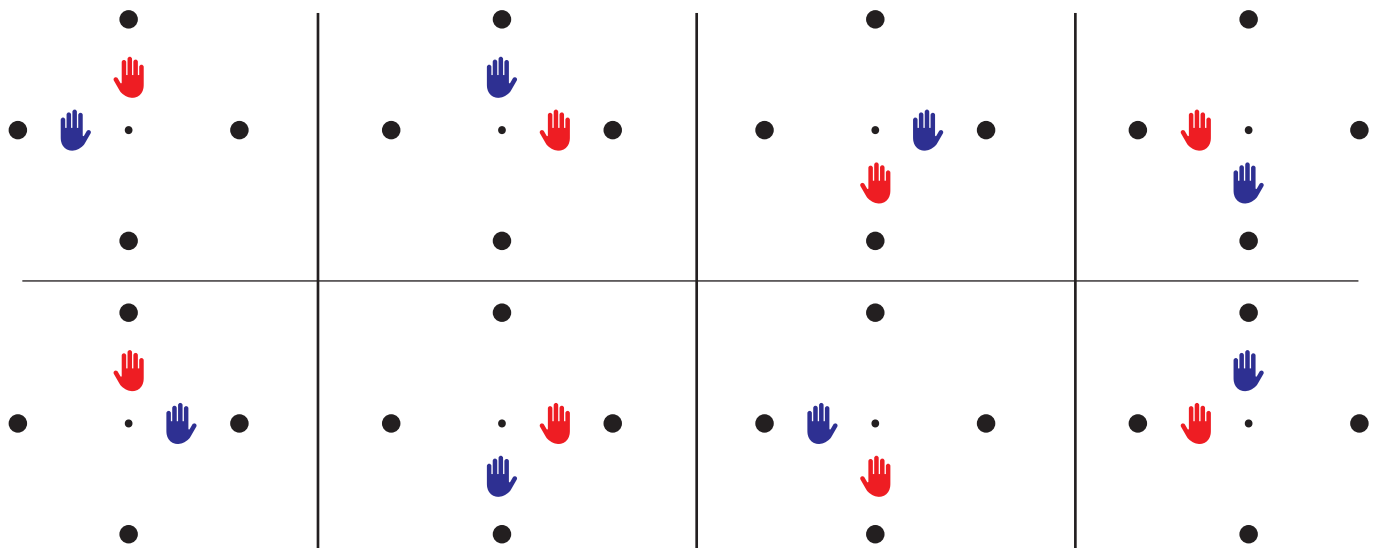
VTG: TS



*In Beta, the hands occupy the same point.*

## Γ Gamma

VTG:  
Quarter Time



*In Gamma, the hands form a right angle.*

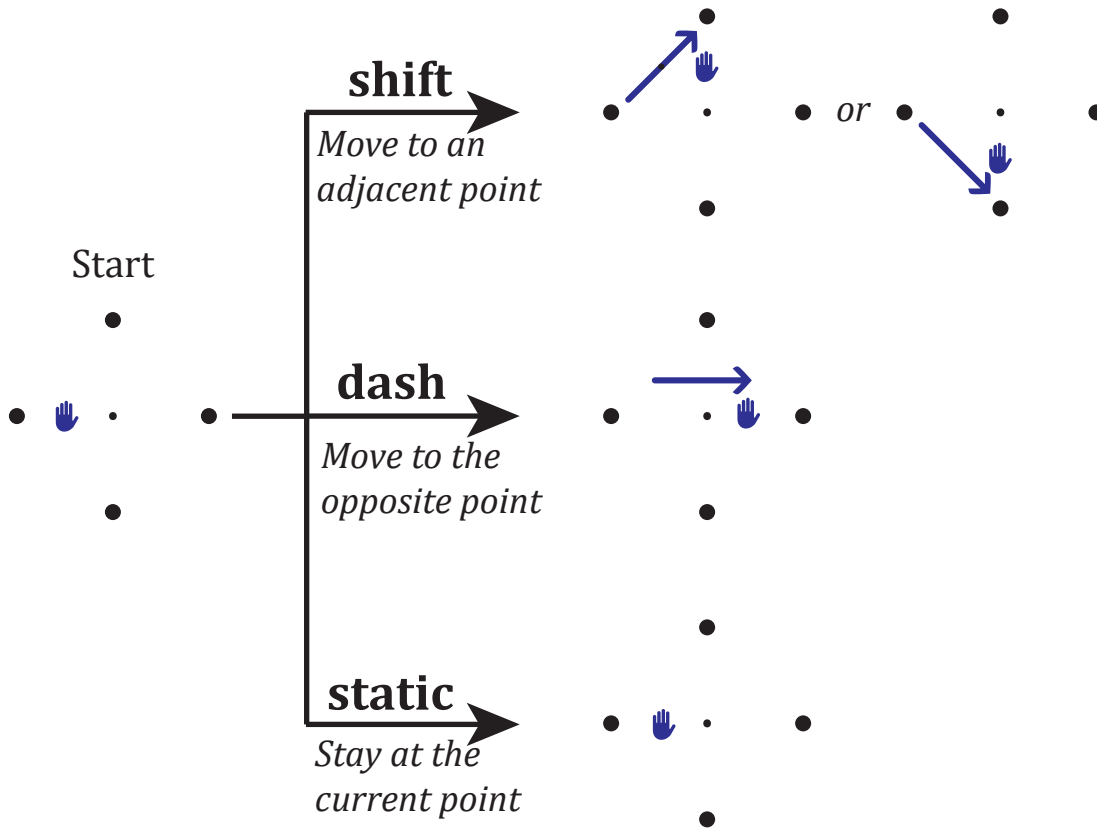


# Hand Motions

There are three fundamental hand motions in the Alphabet.

The arrow shows the direction of motion.

The hand shows the end position.



Using these, we can derive six types of motion combinations, named below.

We will explore each one individually:

## Dual-Shift

Both hands travel to an adjacent point.

## Shift

One hand travels to an adjacent point and the other hand remains static.

## Cross-Shift

One hand travels to an adjacent point and the other travels to the opposite point.

## Dash

One hand travels to the opposite point and the other hand remains static.

## Dual-Dash

Both hands travel to the opposite point.

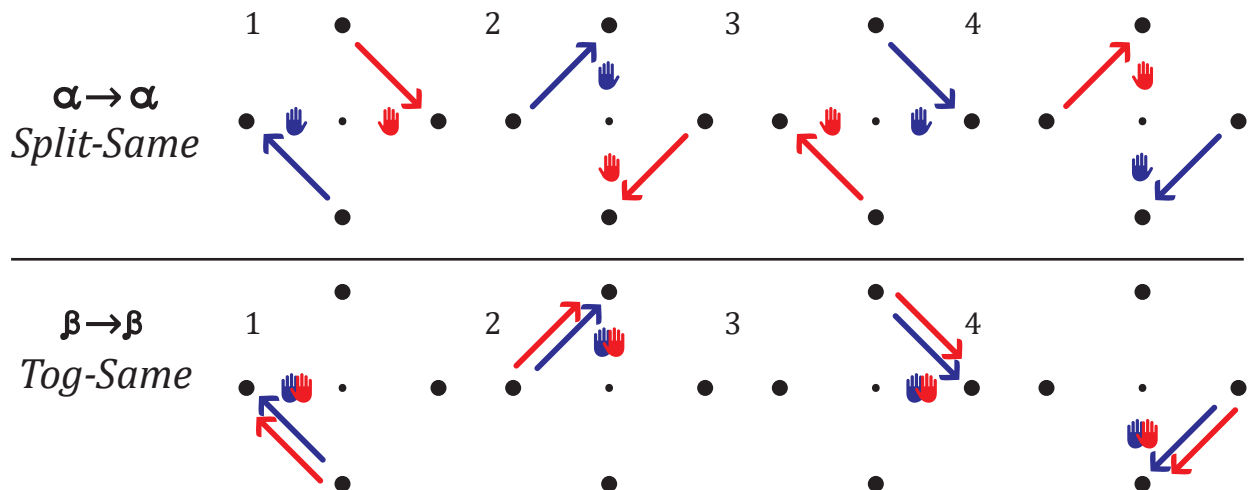
## Static

Both hands remain static.

# Type 1 - Dual-Shifts

When both hands shift, it's called a **Dual-Shift**.

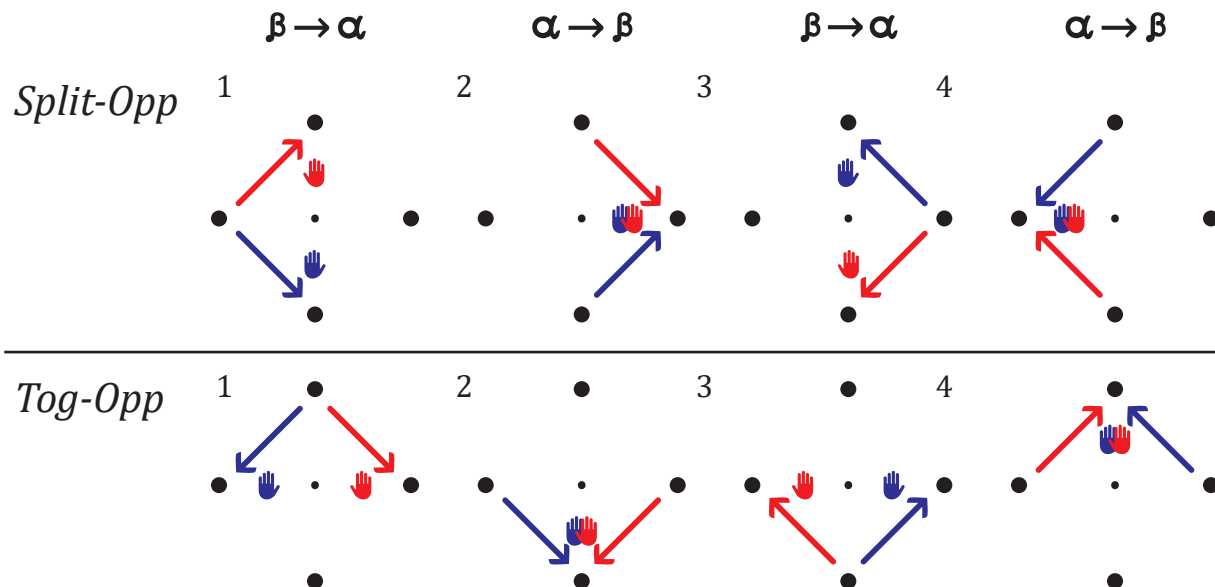
The Alpha/Beta **Dual-Shifts** correspond to the four modes in VTG - (SS, TS, SO, TO). You can determine the start position by looking at the non-pointed end of the arrow.



While VTG categorizes individual motions into the four modes based on the downbeat, TKA puts focus on the combination of two motions between positions, relative to the center point.

Let's try another type of **Dual-Shift**.

What happens when we move between  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$ ?



Note that these combinations can be either *Split-Opp* or *Tog-Opp* depending on start position.

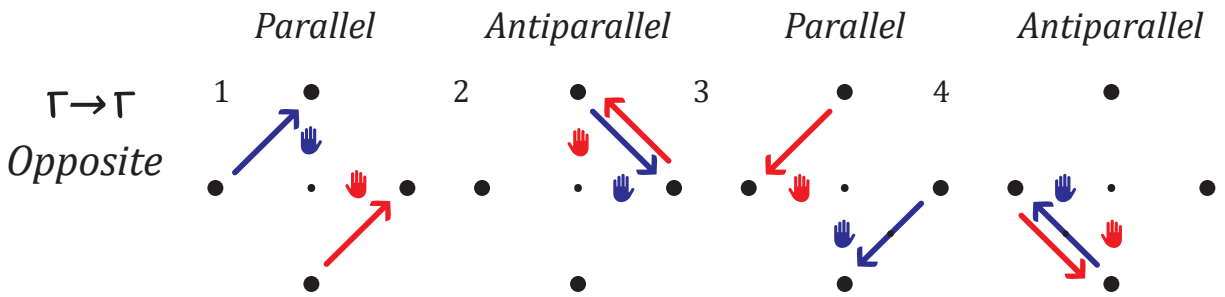
In TKA, these motions are considered  $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$  or  $\beta \rightarrow \alpha$  regardless of the downbeat.

Its categorization doesn't delineate motions based on up/down (absolute).

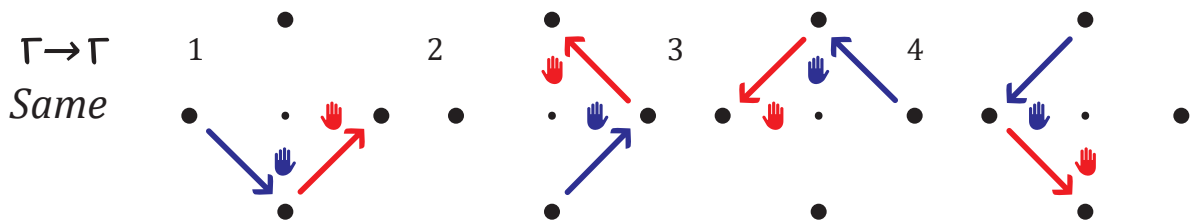
Instead, it focuses on the movement between positions related to the center point (relative).

Practice using **Dual-Shifts** to travel between Alpha and Beta in each mode.

Gamma, aka quarter-time, is not based on the four modes.  
 However we can separate the variations of  $\Gamma \rightarrow \Gamma$  into Opposite and Same direction.



Opposite direction presents variations of parallel and antiparallel.  
 In same direction, this is not a factor:

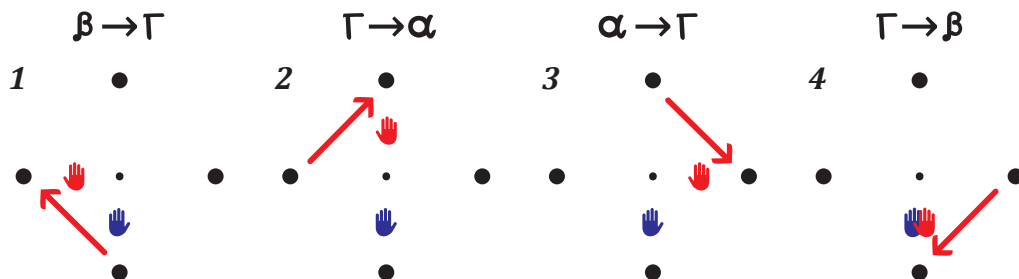


When in gamma, you can move to any other variation of gamma.  
 These examples are continuous, but non-continuous sequence are also possible.

**Practice using Dual-Shifts to create non-continuous  $\Gamma \rightarrow \Gamma$  variations.**

## *Type 2 - Shifts*

To move between  $\Gamma$  and  $\alpha/\beta$ , you can shift one hand and keep the other hand static.  
 This combination is called a **Shift** (with a capital "S").

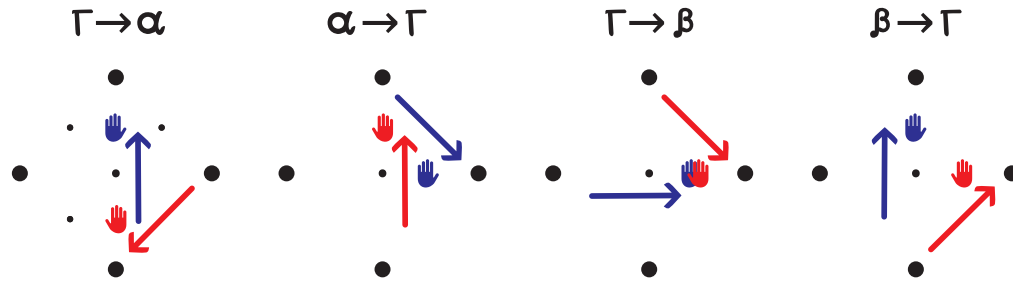


In these examples, the **right** hand is shifting, but it's equally valid to shift the **left** hand.

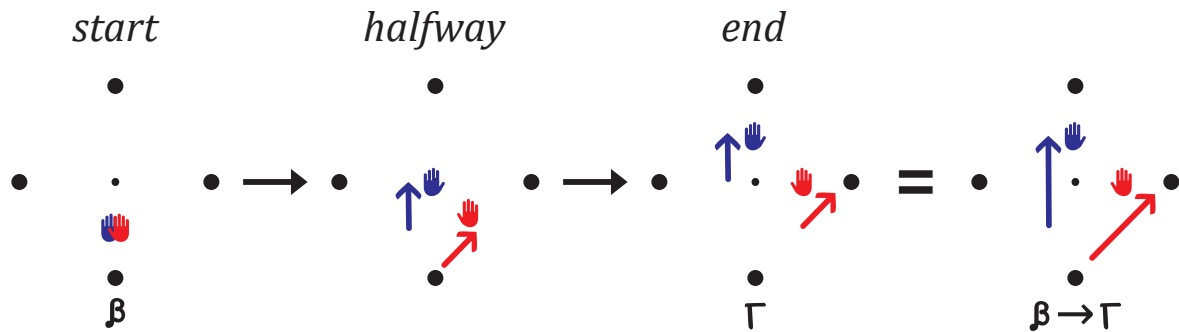
**Practice using Shifts to travel between  $\alpha/\beta$  and  $\Gamma$  in either direction with both hands.**

# Type 3 - Cross-Shifts

A **Cross-Shift** combines a shift and a dash.  
Since a dash has further to travel, it moves slightly faster.



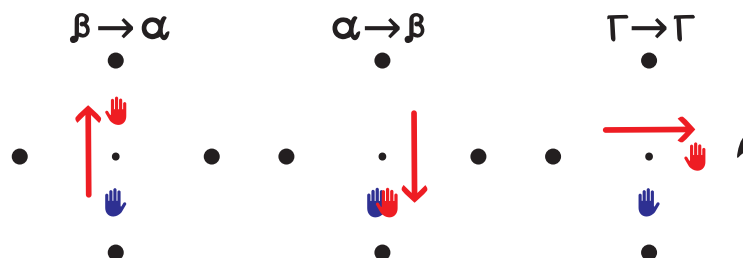
To understand **Cross-Shifts**, let's break one down into parts:



Note the halfway point. One hand is in the center point and one is on a diagonal hand point.  
By pausing at this halfway point, it ensures that the dash moves at the correct speed.

# Type 4 - Dash

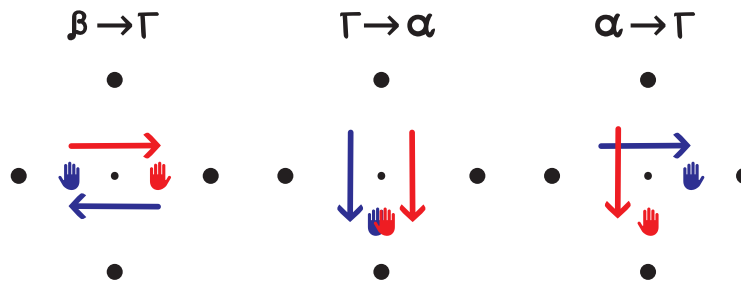
With a **Dash**, one hand executes a dash while the other hand remains static.



Just like before, the halfway position of each dash is at the center point.

# Type 5 - Dual-Dash

With a **Dual-Dash**, both hands dash simultaneously to their opposite points.

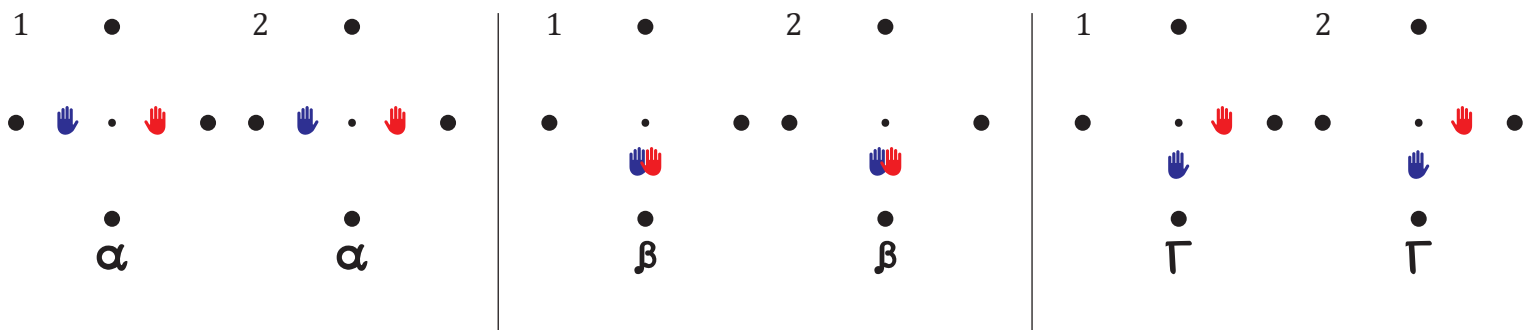


Practice using **Dual-Dashes**, **Dashes**, and **Cross-Shifts** from different start positions.

# Type 6 - Static

The combination of two static motions can be written as **Static** (with a capital “S”).

To indicate any static motion, we simply draw the position.  
Here are three **Static** 2-beat sequences.



Obviously these sequences aren't very exciting.

Later on, static sequences have more complexity when adding turns.

# Staff Positions

When writing sequences with staves, it helps to mark the thumb end with a line. The performer can use it to keep track of rotations and check their position on every beat. It also encourages negative space/body turns instead of finger spinning.

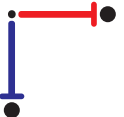
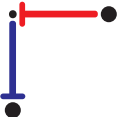
In the following examples, an end is always at the center point.

In The Kinetic Alphabet, this is called **Layer 1**.

We will learn much more about Layers in the future, but this is our starting point.

These variations are classified by the thumb end's relationship to the center point:

**Practice each position below, paying attention to the thumb orientation.**

| Thumbs:                                                                                      | In                                                                                  | Out                                                                                 | (in/out)                                                                              | (out/in)                                                                              |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <br>Alpha  |   |   |    |   |
| <br>Beta  |  |  |  |  |
| <br>Gamma |  |  |  |  |

Many of pictographs in this guide are depicted without thumb ends because it doesn't affect the letter categorization. It is only notated during sequences.

Most example sequences in this guide start with thumbs in for consistency. It's equally valid to start any sequence from a different thumb orientation.

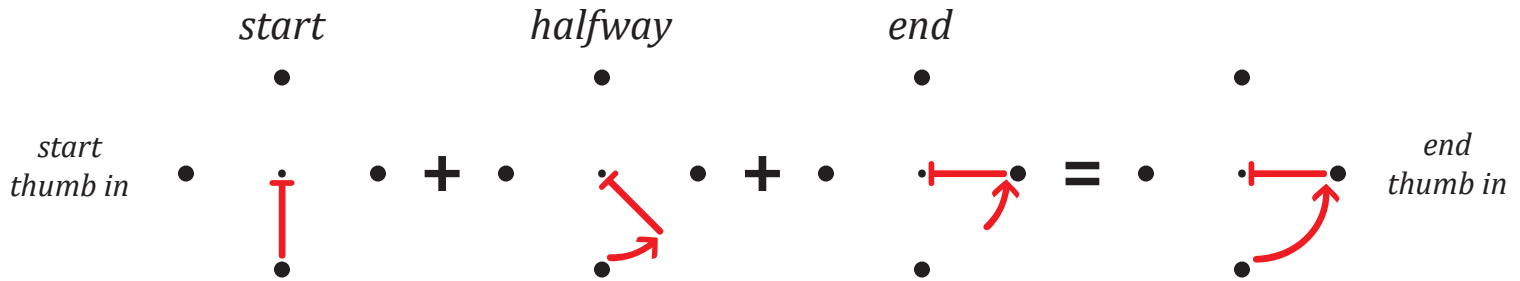
# Staff Motions

## Shift

During a shift, a prop can rotate in one of two directions - Prospin or Antispin

### Prospin

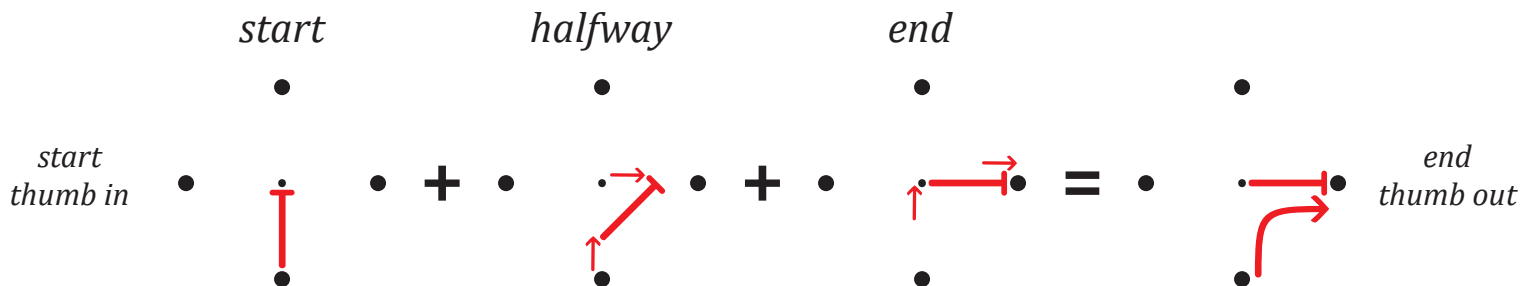
- **Prospin** - The prop rotates the same direction as the hand  
A 90 degree isolation is our base unit of a prospin.



In a base isolation, the thumb orientation remains the same for the entire motion.

### Antispin

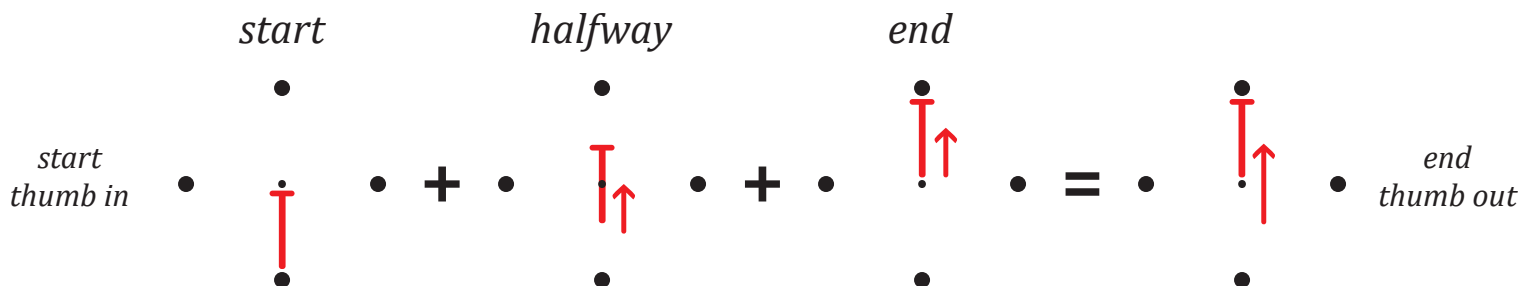
- **Antispin** - The prop rotates in the opposite direction of the hand  
A 90 degree antispin is our base unit of antispin.



In an antispin, the ends switch orientation. Here, it moves from thumb in to thumb out.

## Dash

In a base dash, the thumb orientation also switches.  
At its halfway point, the center of the staff is at the center point.



# Negative Space / Body Turns

Many sequences seem impossible, but most can be solved by using negative space or body turns.

**Negative space** lets you face the audience and reduces body movement

**Body turns** add movement and help you execute patterns with longer staves.

Each method is equally important, and learning both will maximize capability.

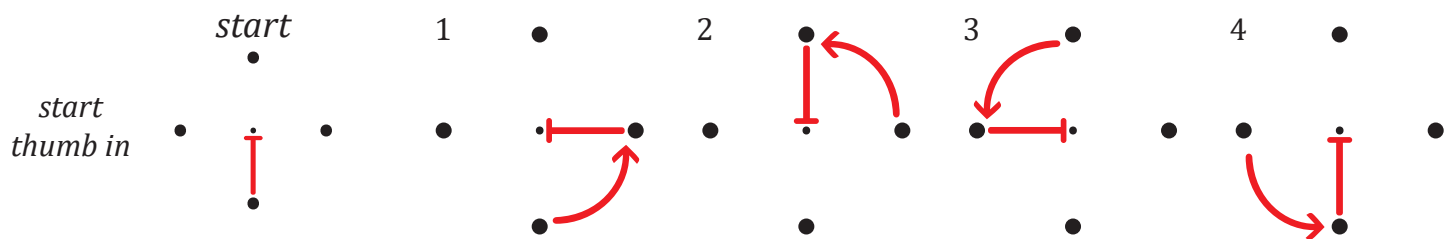
This guide will assume some knowledge of these fundamental concepts.

To make the most of the Alphabet, it's highly recommended that you learn the following.

---

VTG: 1:1

## 360° Isolation



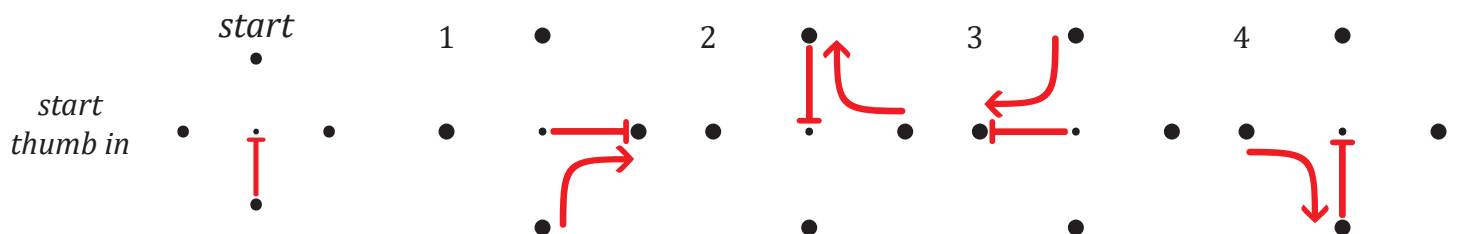
To execute this without finger-spinning, turn your torso to the left on beat 3. During this beat, the staff moves briefly in wheel-plane relative to your left-facing view. On beat 4, turn your body back to center as you return to the start position.

**Practice it in reverse, then do both directions in the other hand.**

**Then practice it with the thumb out, isolating the pinky end.**

---

## 4-Petal Antispin



To execute this in wall plane, you must do one of the following on beat 2:

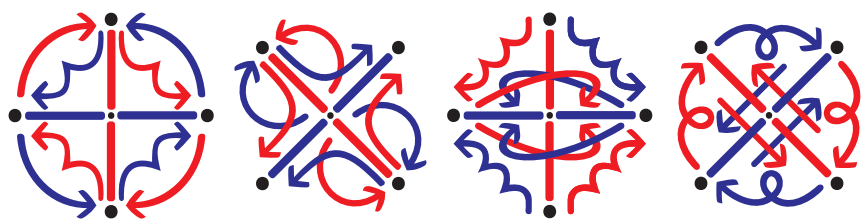
- Pass the thumb end through the negative space above your right shoulder on beat 2.
  - Turn your torso to the left on beat 2 and pass the thumb end in front, then pass the pinky end on the inside of your right arm as you move to beat 3.
- 

**Practice it in reverse, then do both directions in the other hand.**

**Then practice it all again starting with the thumb out.**

**Try using both negative space and turns. Good luck!**

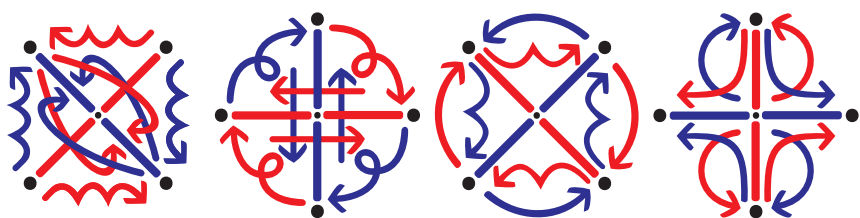




1.1



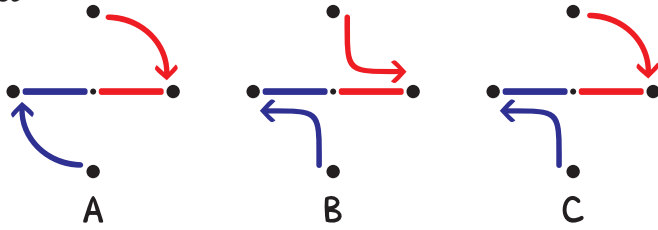
*Base Letters*



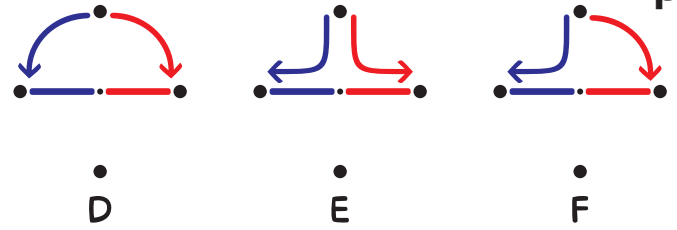
# Double Staff

## Type 1 - Dual-Shift

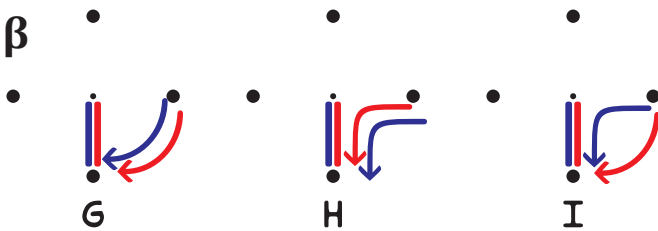
$\alpha \rightarrow \alpha$



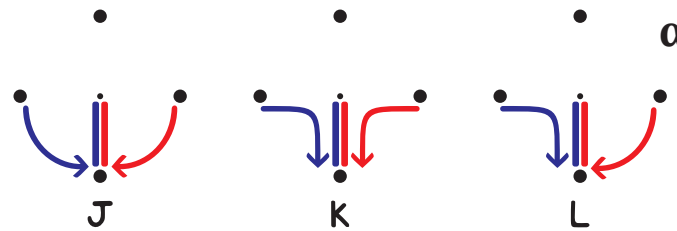
$\beta \rightarrow \alpha$



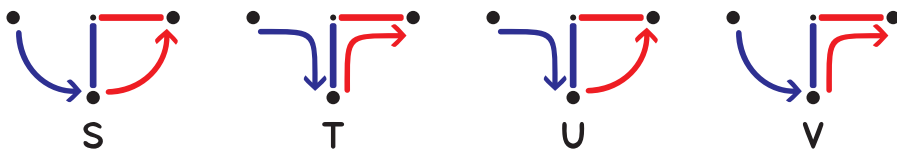
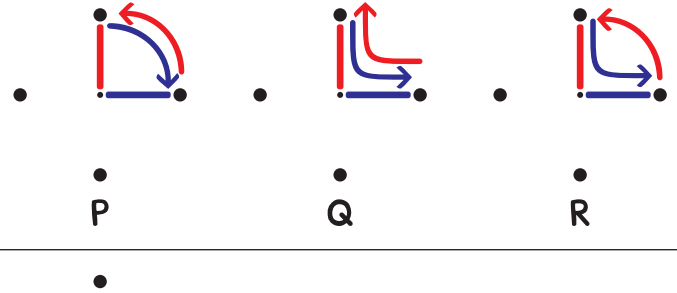
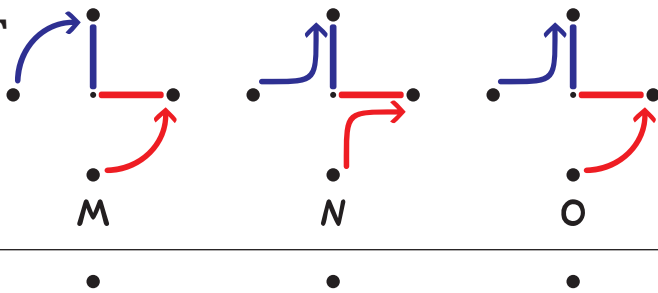
$\beta \rightarrow \beta$



$\alpha \rightarrow \beta$

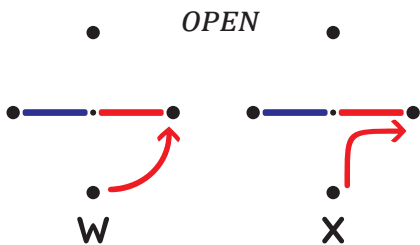


$\Gamma \rightarrow \Gamma$



## Type 2 - Shift

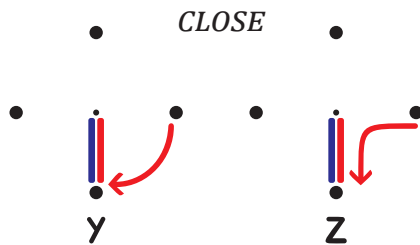
$\Gamma \rightarrow \alpha$



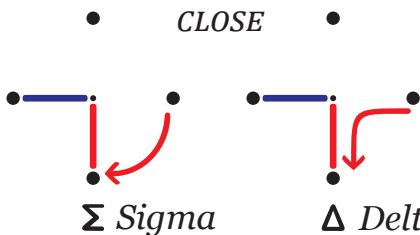
OPEN

CLOSE

$\Gamma \rightarrow \beta$

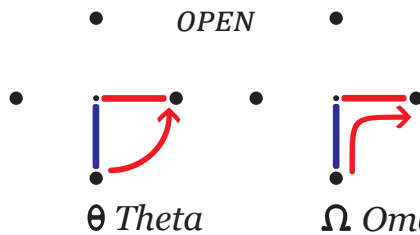


$\alpha \rightarrow \Gamma$

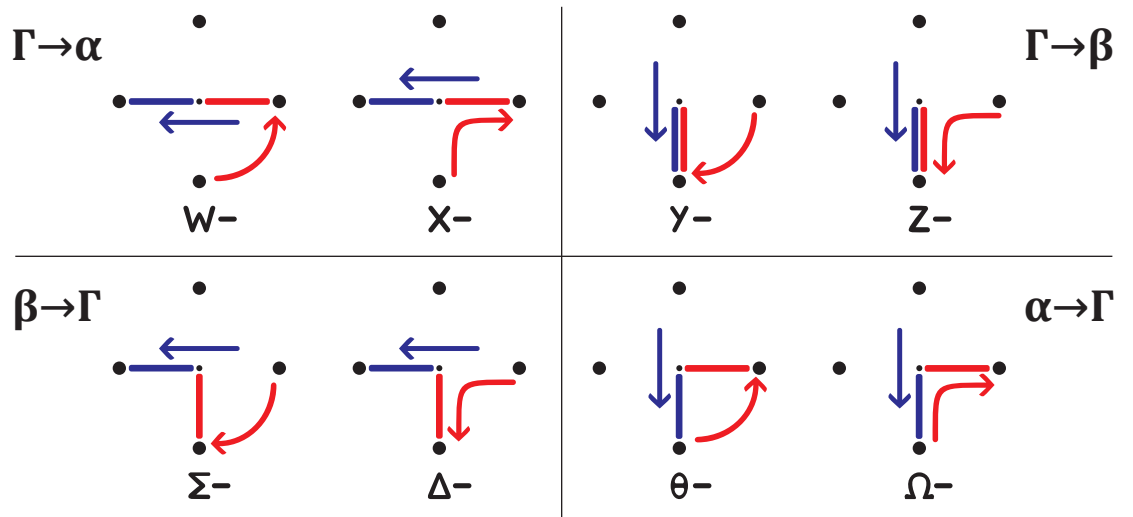


OPEN

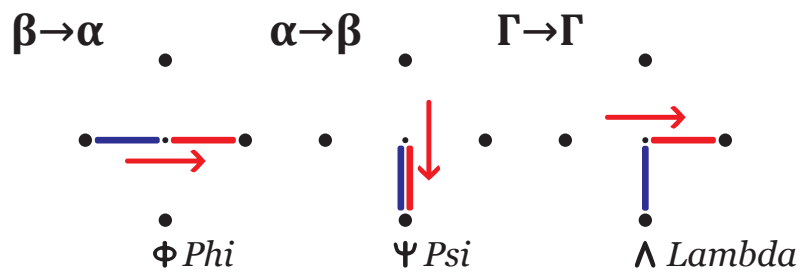
$\beta \rightarrow \Gamma$



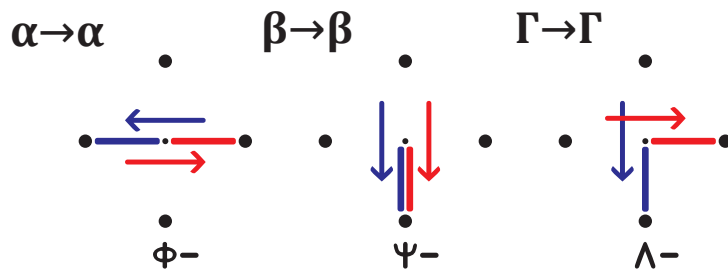
Type 3 -  
*Cross-Shift*



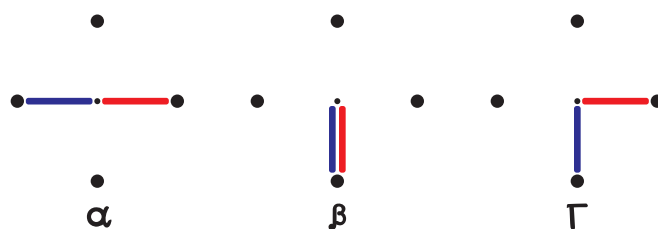
Type 4 -  
*Dash*



Type 5 -  
*Dual-Dash*



Type 6 -  
*Static*

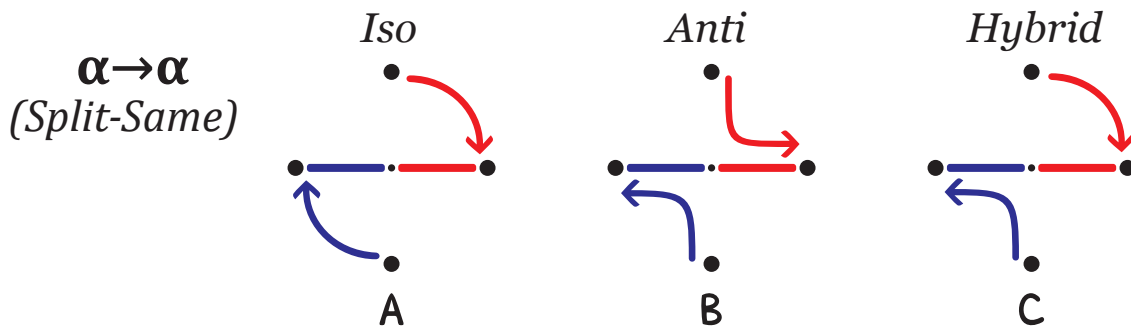


# Letters

Just like positions, each motion pictograph can be rotated, reflected, or color swapped. Letters are organized on the page by end position, Alpha, Beta, then Gamma. Let's look at each type individually. We'll use double staves as our example.

## Type 1 - *Dual-Shift*

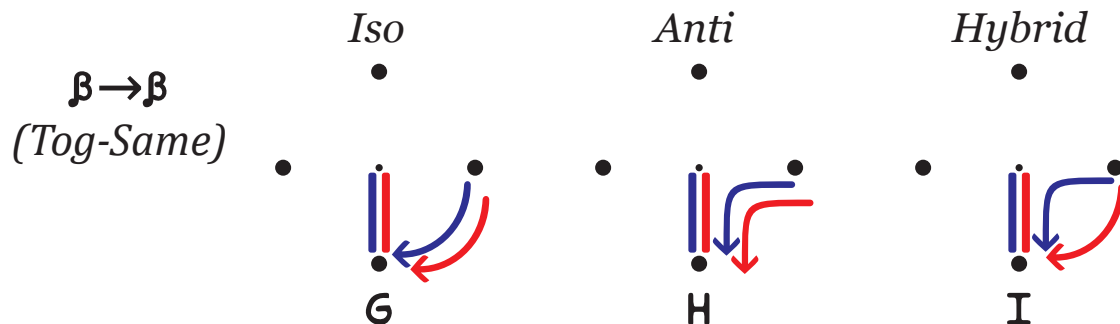
First we'll look at A, B, and C. Their handpaths are Split-Same and they move from  $\alpha \rightarrow \alpha$ :



Notice the pattern: **Isolations - Antispins - Hybrid**  
This pattern helps you navigate/memorize the letters.

If you only remember that A has isolations, you can infer that B has antispins.  
If you only remember that B has antispins, you can infer that C is a hybrid.  
***If you memorize only one letter in each group, you know all of them.***

Next let's look at G, H, and I. Their handpaths are Tog-Same and they move from  $\beta \rightarrow \beta$ :



**In hybrids like C and I, either hand can execute a prospin or antispin.**

Here, the **right** is in pro and **left** in anti, but it's equally valid to swap this.

# Alpha/Beta Words

## Same Direction

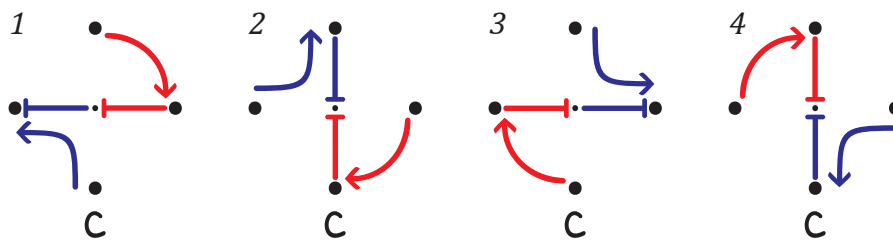
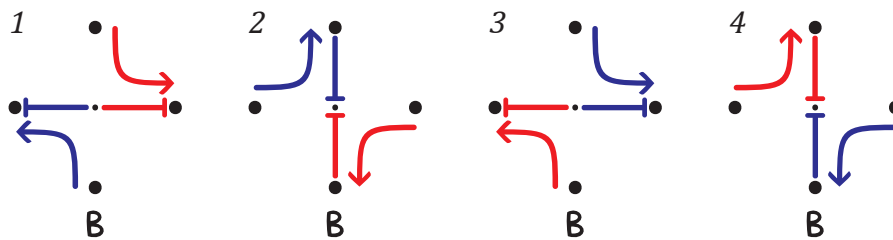
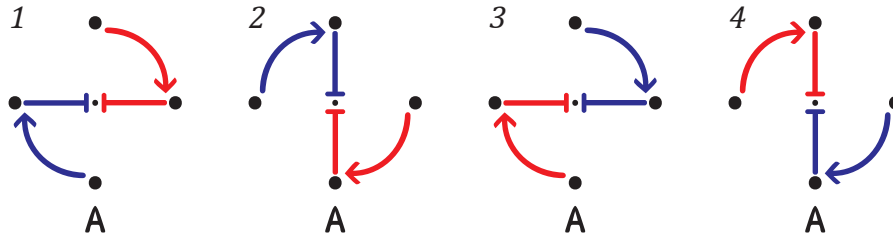
Since each shift is 1/4 of a rotation, a 4 letter word can bring you back to starting position.

The first words we will learn correspond to VTG's 1:1 motions.

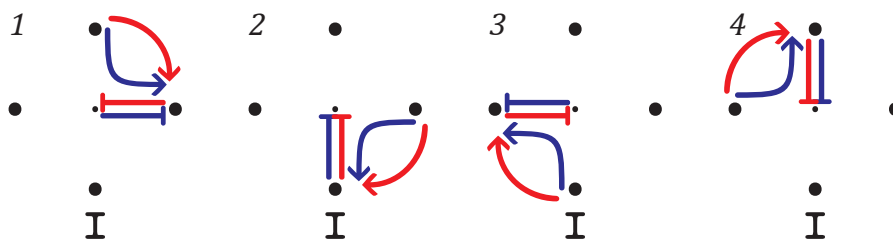
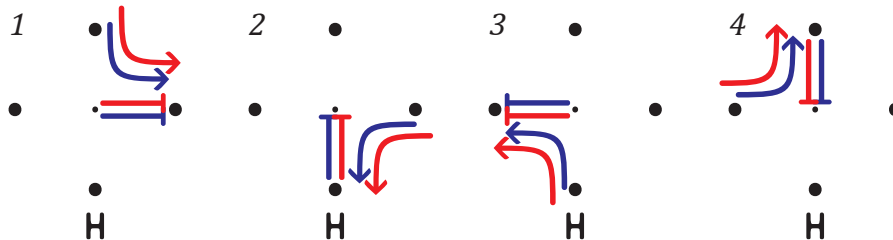
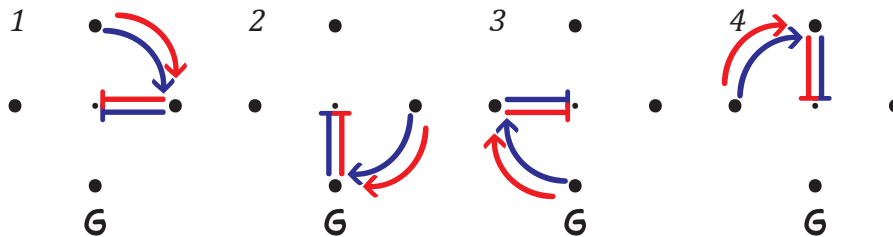
To execute these, you'll need to use body turns and/or negative space.

**Practice each word once in both directions, then again starting with thumbs out.**

$\alpha \rightarrow \alpha$   
(Split-Same)



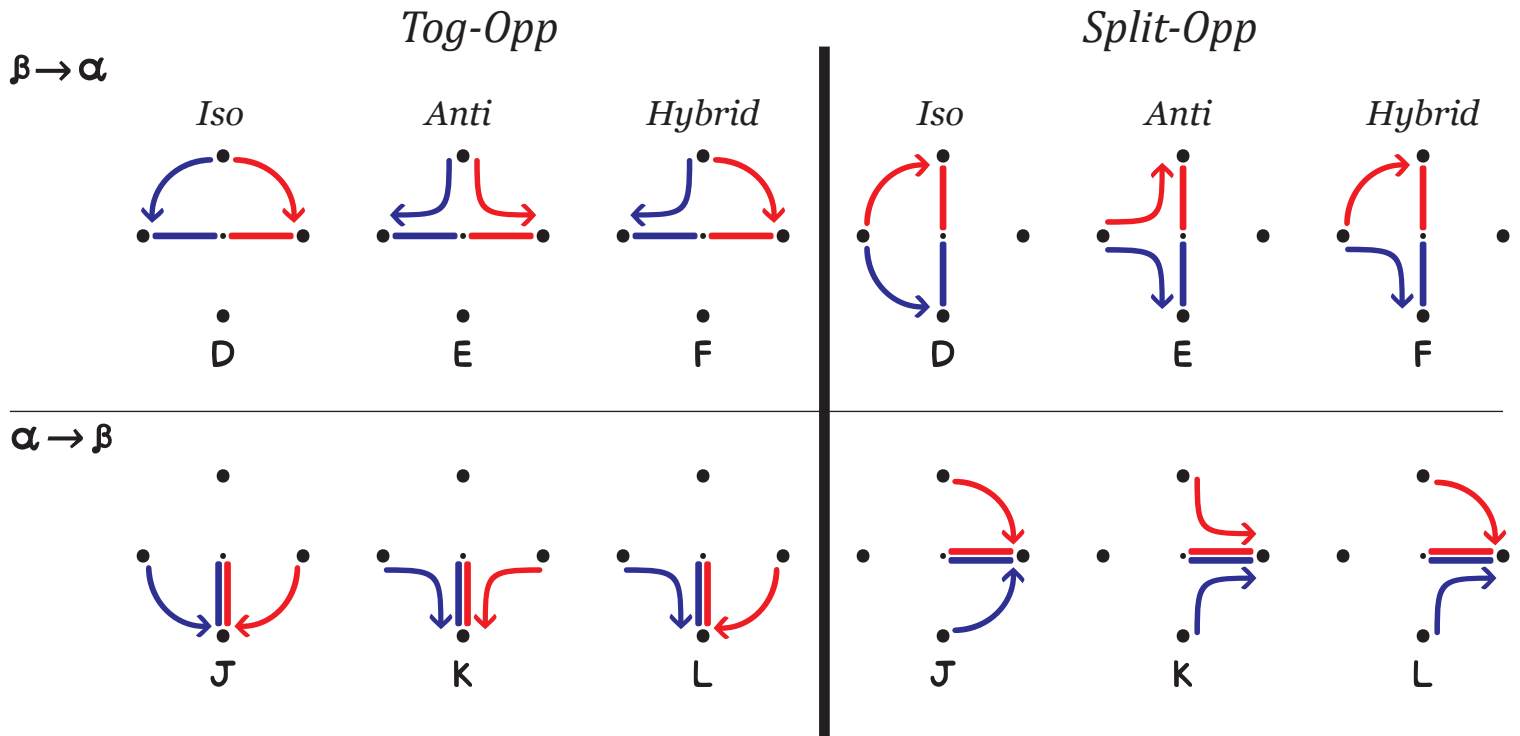
$\beta \rightarrow \beta$   
(Tog-Same)



# Compound Letters

Now let's look at the letters that move from  $\beta \rightarrow \alpha$  or  $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ .

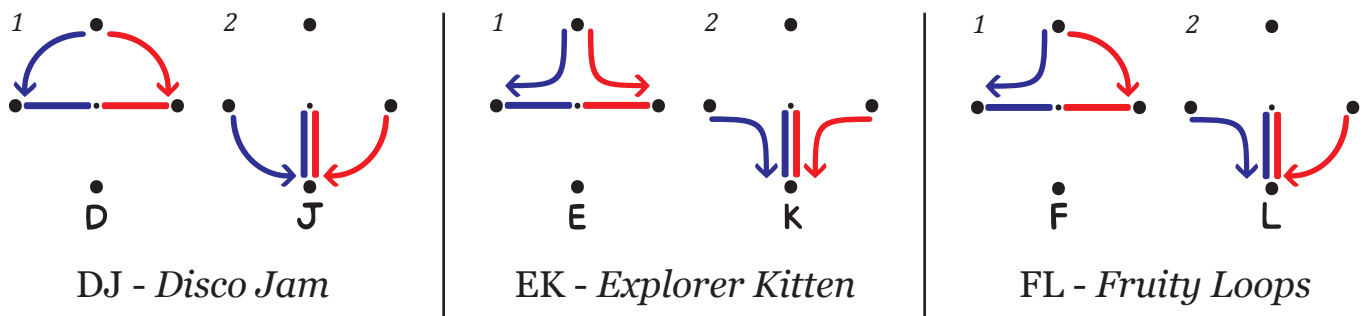
Since **all pictographs can be rotated or mirrored without changing letters**, these can be either Tog-Opp or Split-Opp depending on which  $\alpha/\beta$  you start from.



These compound letters differ from simple letters because you can't self-combine them.

Instead, they combine to form the words DJ, EK, and FL.

Here they are along a phrase to help you remember. Feel free to create your own!



Using reversals, you can use compound letters to make words such as:

DK, DL, EJ, EL, FJ, FK

You can also combine these with the singular letters to make words such as:

AJ, AK, AL, BJ, BK, BL, CJ, CK, CL, GD, GE, GF, HD, HE, HF, ID, IE, IF

We will explore reversals in detail later on, but feel free to try them now.

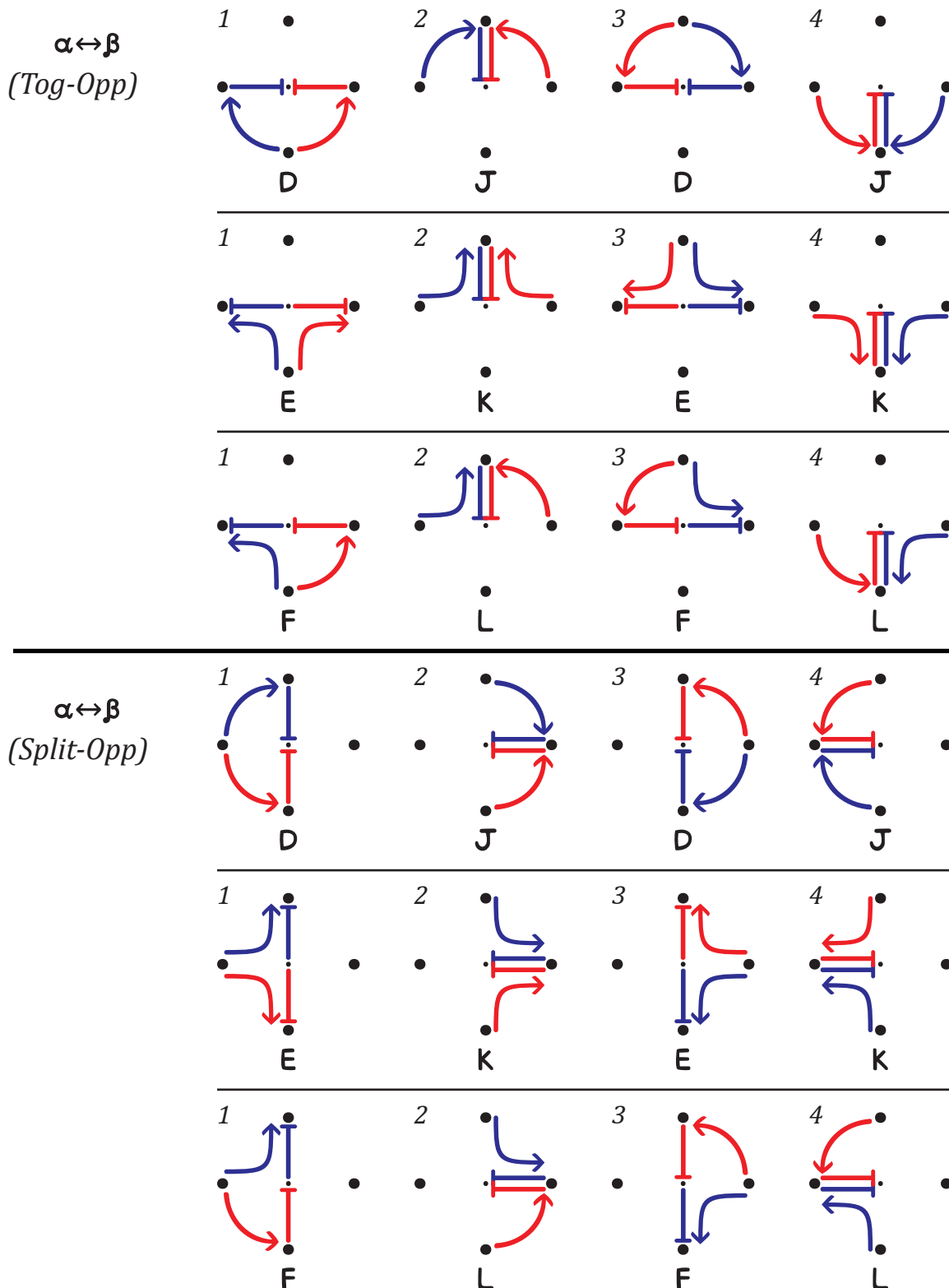
# Compound Words

These are the simplest words that use the compound letters DJ, EK, and FL.

For Tog-Opp, cross your arms or body turn to use the plane behind you.

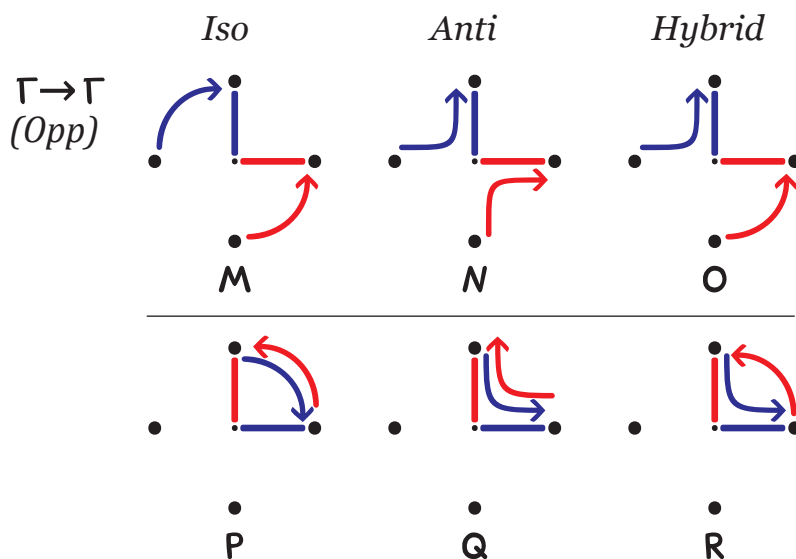
For Split-Opp, either body turn or use negative space.

Both versions are equally valid. Try them yourself!

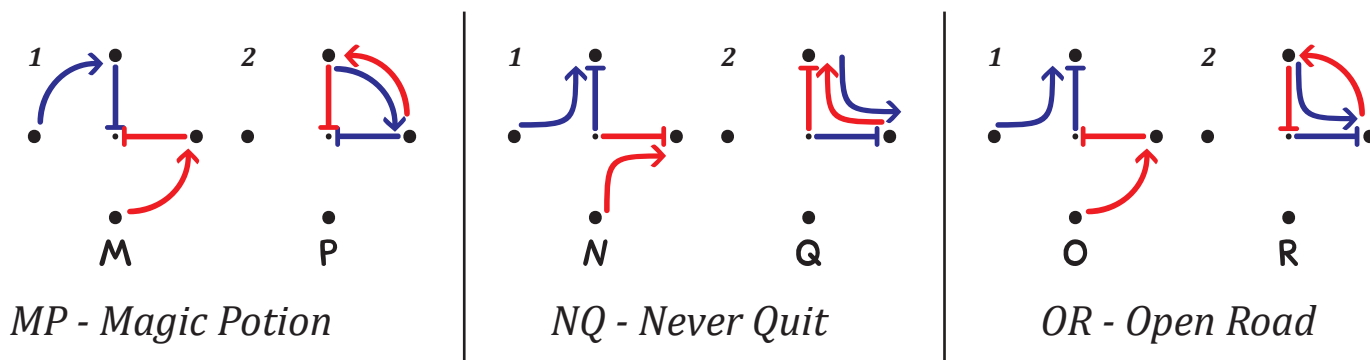


# Gamma Letters

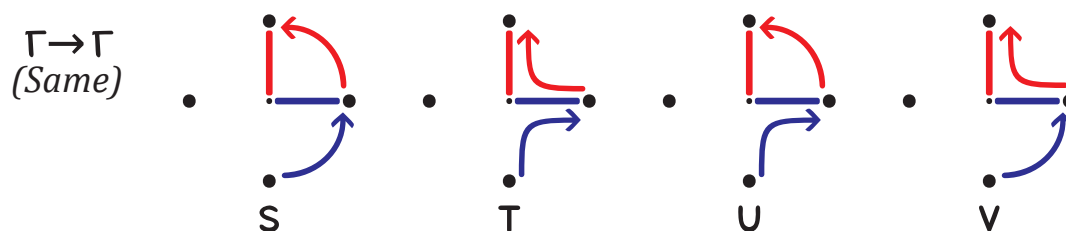
$\Gamma \rightarrow \Gamma$  motions can combine with any other  $\Gamma \rightarrow \Gamma$  motion to create lots of words!  
First let's look at the compound letters (VTG: quarter time opposite direction).



When combined as a continuous motion, these form MP, NQ, and OR.  
Here they are along with a memorable phrase:



The final  $\Gamma \rightarrow \Gamma$  group (quarter time same direction) has 4 instead of 3.  
It may seem like U and V contain the same information, but it's impossible to rotate or reflect U in order to turn it into V, and vica-versa, so they must be disambiguated.



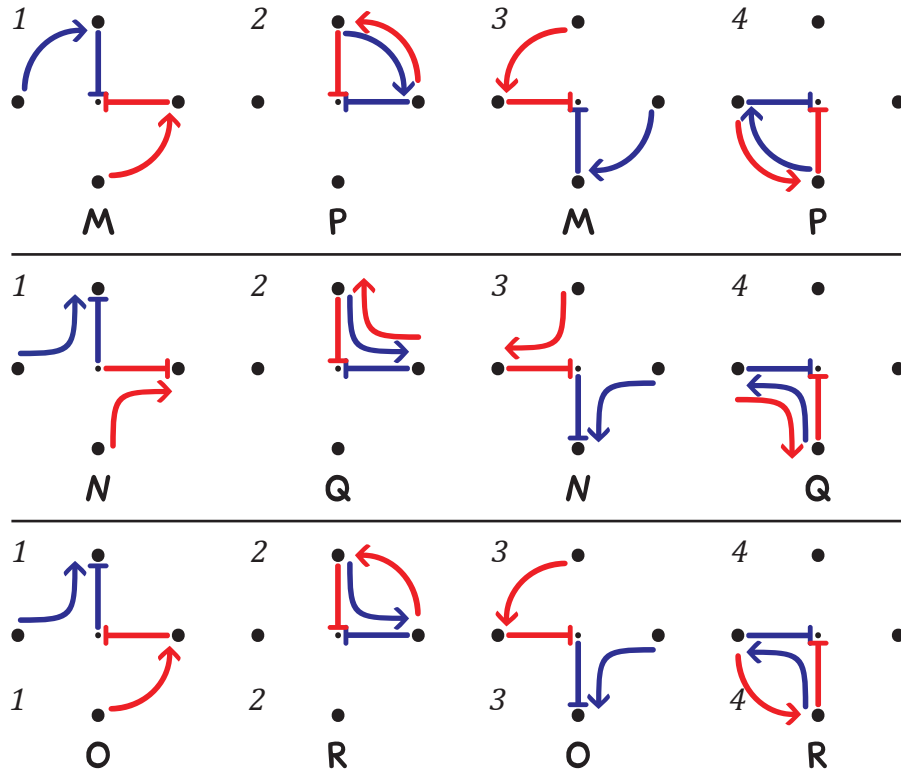
Note that all four have a *leading* hand and a *following* hand.  
Here, the **right** is leading and **left** is following, but it's equally valid to swap this.  
**U leads with an isolation** (a round motion like the letter U).  
**V leads with an antispin** (a spiky motion like the letter V).  
These self-combine to form the words SS, TT, UU, and VV.



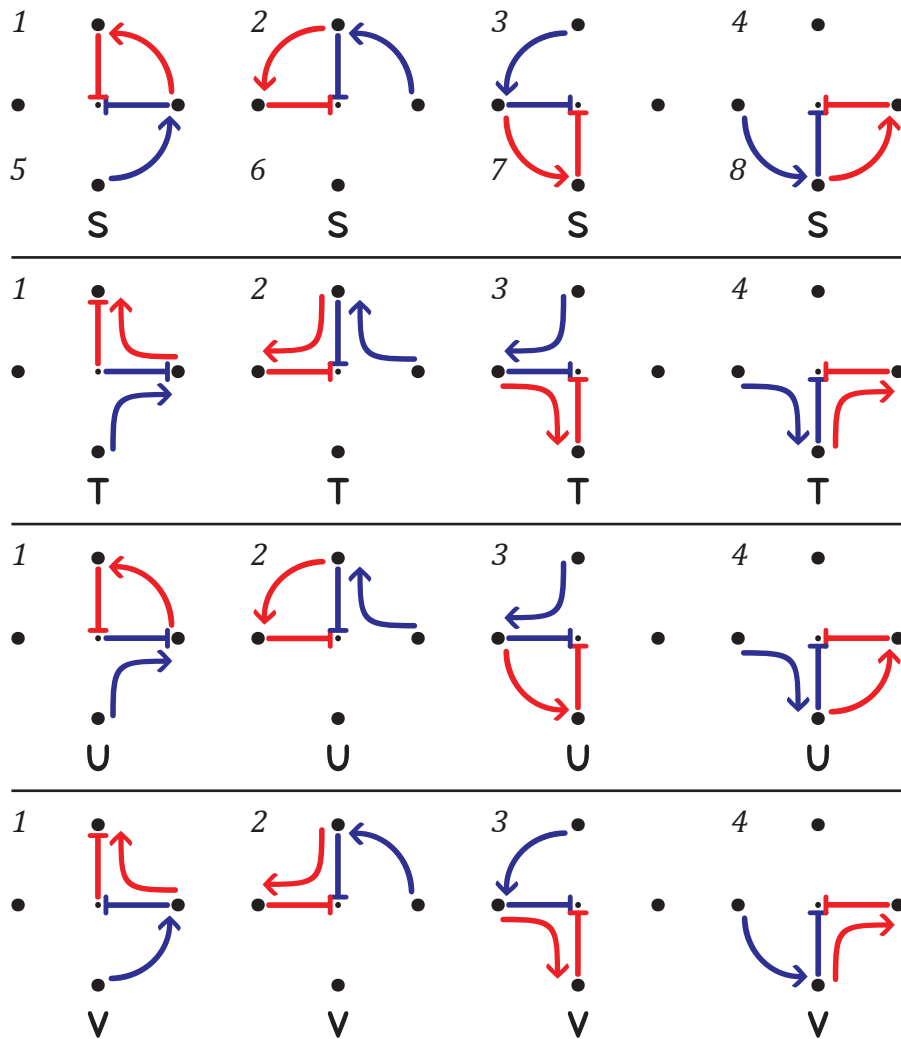
# Gamma Words

These are the simplest 4-letter words created with continuous  $\Gamma \rightarrow \Gamma$  motions:

$\Gamma \rightarrow \Gamma$   
(Opp)



$\Gamma \rightarrow \Gamma$   
(Same)

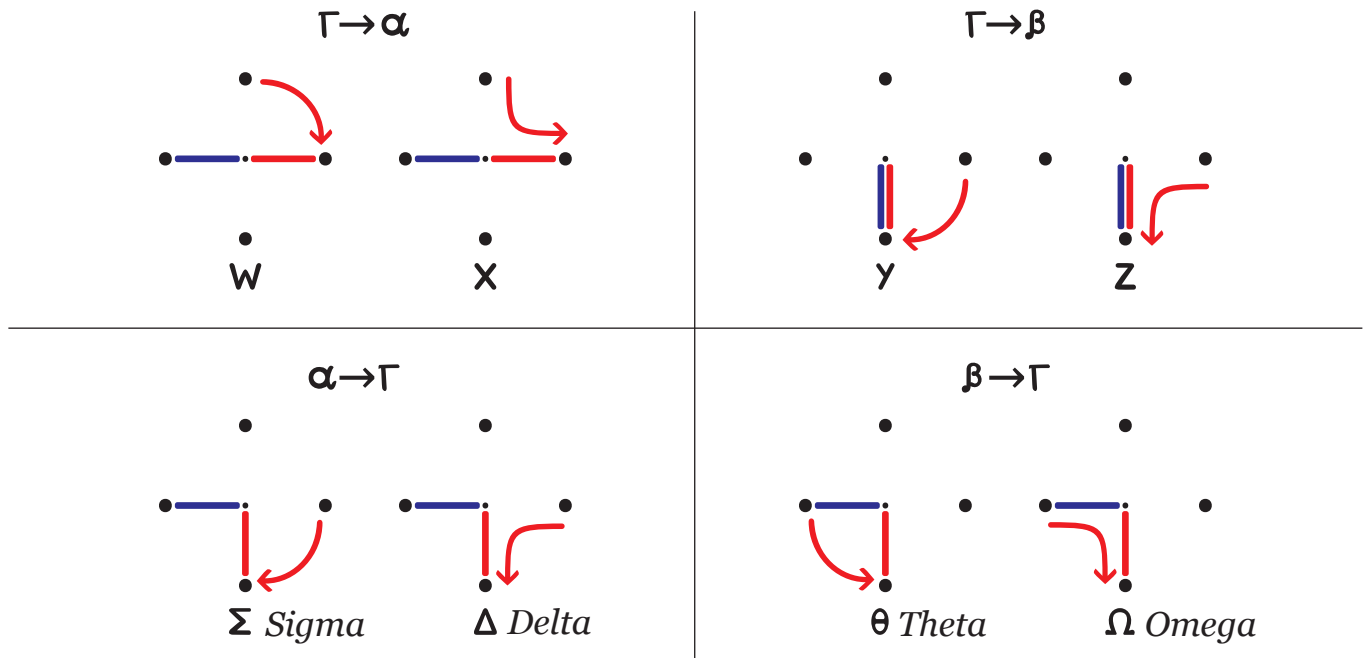


# Type 2 - Shift

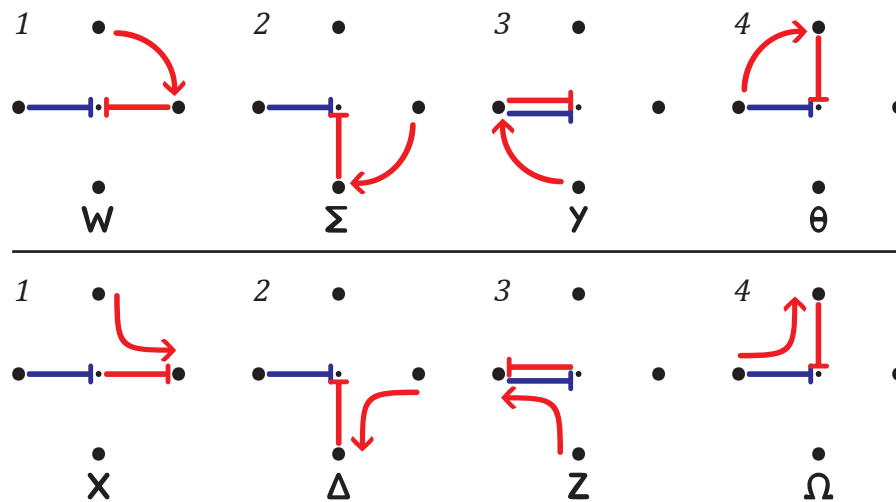
So far we've learned how to move between  $\alpha \leftrightarrow \beta$  and between  $\Gamma \leftrightarrow \Gamma$ . In order to travel between these two modes, we can use a Type 2 Motion called a **Shift**.

A **Shift** (or single shift) is the combination of one shift and one static motion.

Their letters are organized by end position:  $\alpha$ ,  $\beta$ , then  $\Gamma$ .



When we arrange them in continuous motions, we get the words W $\Sigma$ Y $\theta$  and X $\Delta$ Z $\Omega$ .



When combining a shift with a static motion,  
**The shift is considered primary and the static motion is secondary.**

Though simple at this stage, these letters are much more complex and useful as we dive deeper into the Alphabet and add rotations to static motions.

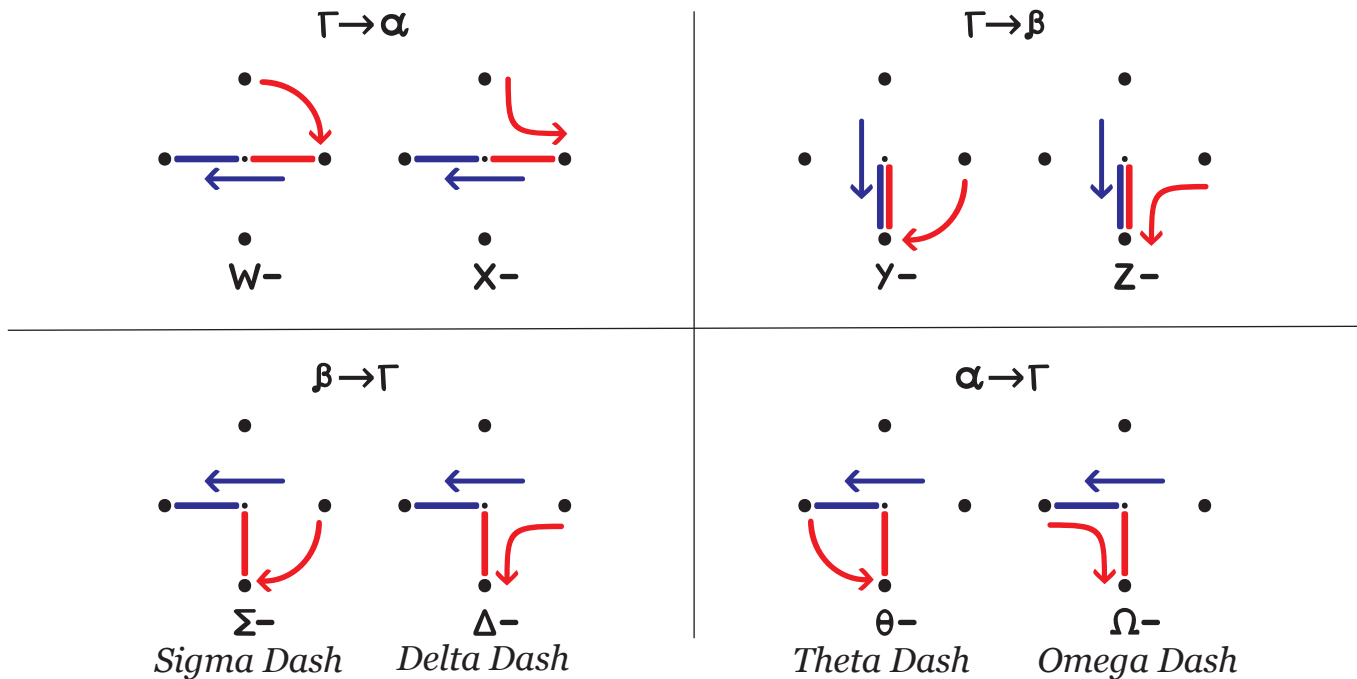
# Type 3 - **Cross-Shift**

**Cross-Shifts** use the same letters as **Shifts**, but each letter is followed by a dash to indicate that the secondary hand (the non-shifting hand) is dashing into its end position.

They are spoken as “W Dash” or “Sigma Dash”.

*A dash symbol in the glyph equals a dash arrow on the graph.*

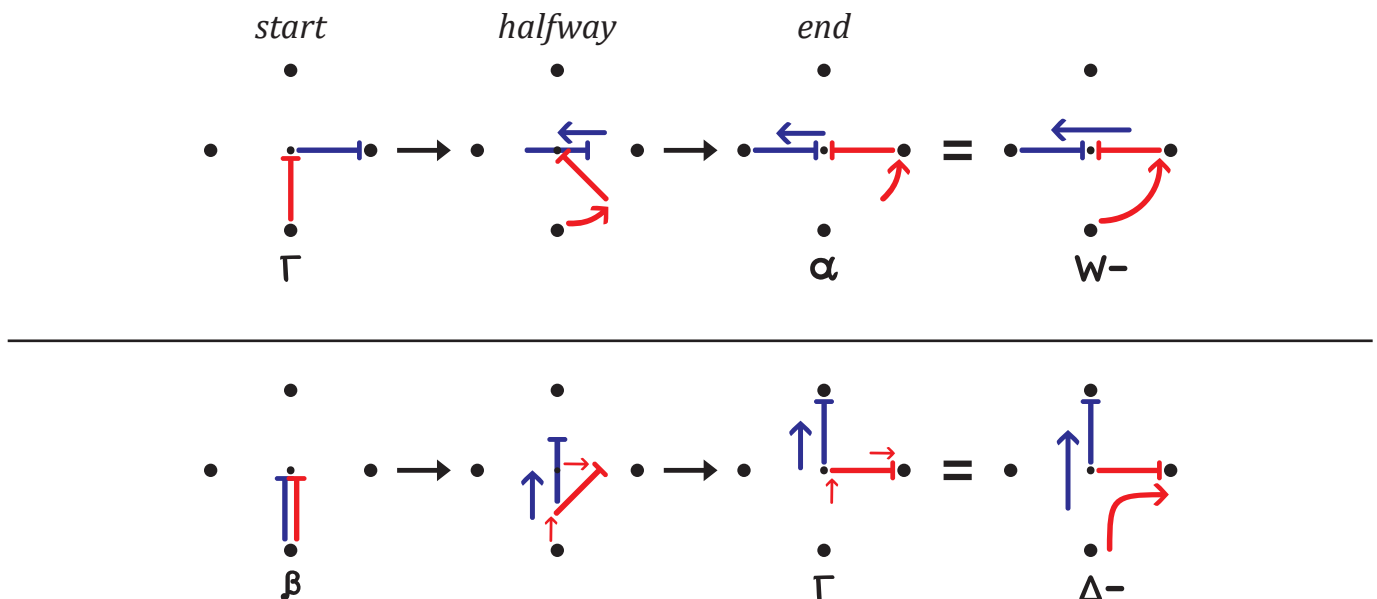
*The end position for each Type 2/3 letter remains the same.*



**Cross-Shifts** can be tricky to remember. It helps to first picture the corresponding Type 2 pictograph, then add the dash arrow without changing any other variables.

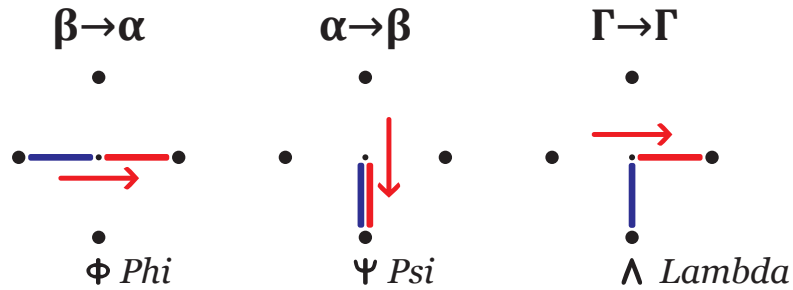
They can also be tricky to execute.

Just like we did with hands, let's break down some **Cross-Shifts** step-by-step.



*When initially learning, it's useful to pause at the halfway point to ensure proper timing.*

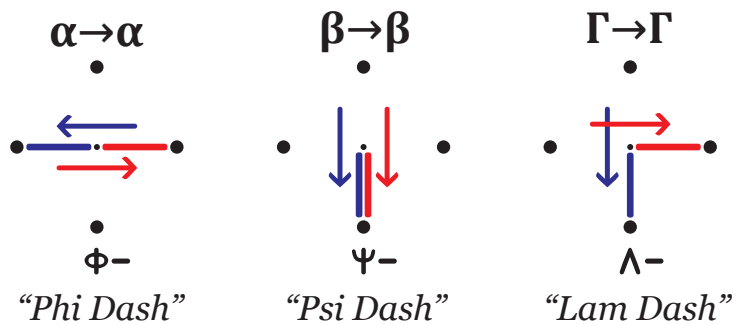
## Type 4 - *Dash*



With a **Dash**, the primary hand executes a dash and the secondary hand remains static.

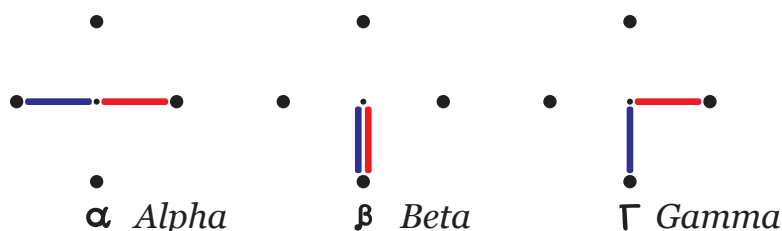
“Lambda” can be further shortened by calling it “Lam”.

## Type 5 - *Dual-Dash*

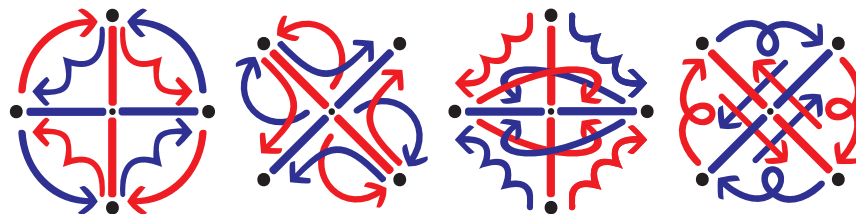


In a **Dual-Dash**, both the primary and the secondary hand are dashing.  
The end position remains the same.

## Type 6 - *Static*



In a **Static** motion, both hands remain still for a beat.  
These become more interesting when adding turns.



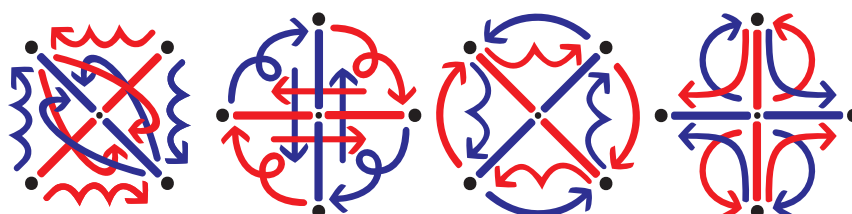
1.2



*Words*

*Permutations*

*Reversals*



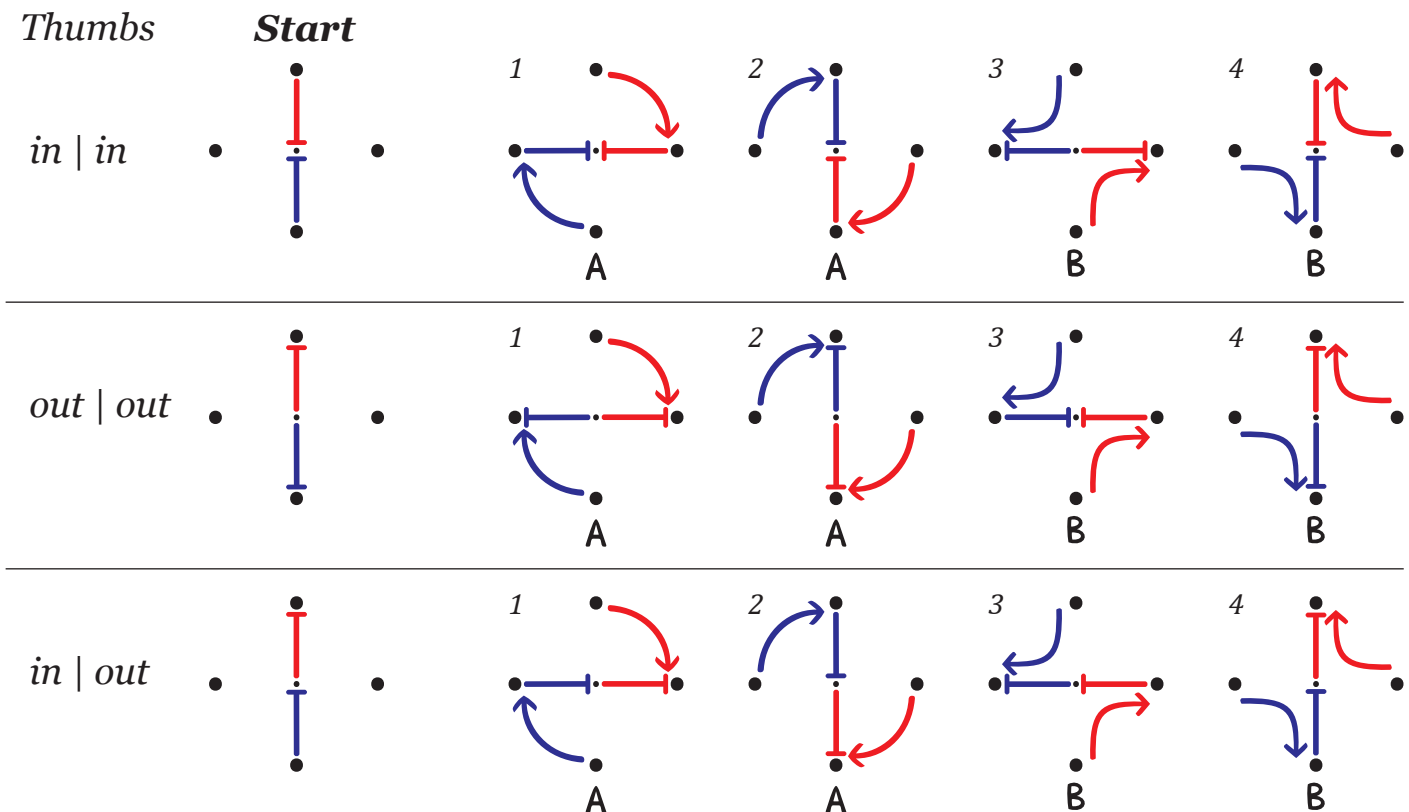
# Words

Let's create words using pictographs!

In order to perform the words in this section correctly without finger-spinning, you must be familiar with negative space and body turns.

If you finger-spin instead of using negative space, you'll lose precision and the ability to check your thumb orientation on each beat to see if you're still on track.

We'll use the word AABB as an example. Here are three variations on AABB, starting from different thumb orientations. Use staves or **red/blue** pens to follow along.



As you execute these with staves, notice that each of these sequences requires a different type of negative space, either above/below the shoulder or behind the elbow.

The execution of the same word can feel completely different depending on factors like the start position, rotation direction, and thumb orientation. That's why it's necessary to draw the full sequence with pictographs for complete clarity.

**The Alphabet is primarily a system of *pictographs*, organized by letters for convenient communication.**

The letters do not give all of the information, and are merely intended to separate motion combinations into categories which can be further clarified with detailed pictographs.

# Permutations

When a word ends on a variation of its start position, we can repeat it to trace a complimentary pattern, eventually returning back to the start position (aka home).

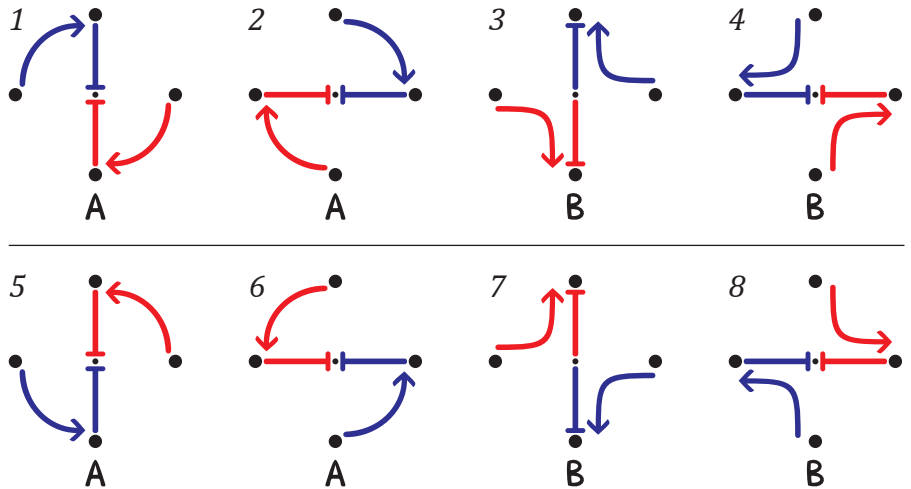
In the Alphabet, this type of sequence is called a *Permutation*.

Three common types of permutations are *Mirrored*, *Rotated*, and *Swapped*.

## Mirrored

In a mirrored permutation, the second repetition's pictographs reflect the first, which changes their rotation direction.

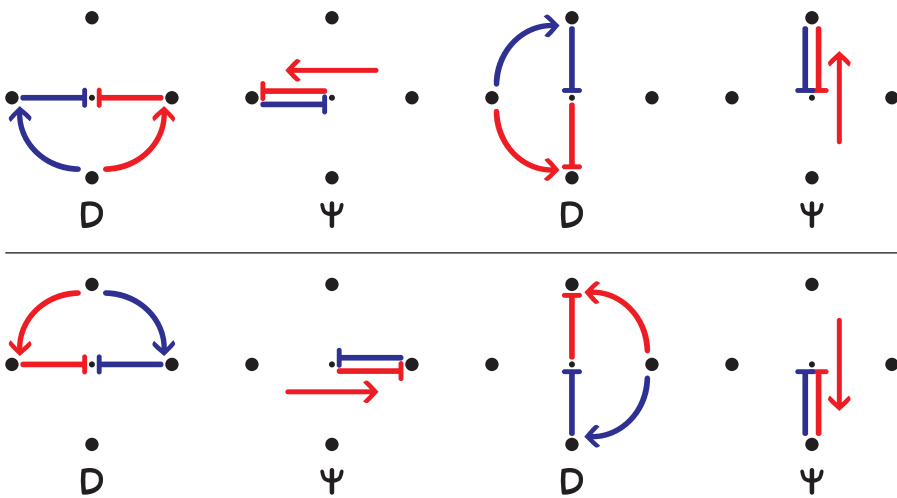
In this example, they're reflected across a horizontal plane.



## Rotated

In a rotated permutation, each repetition ends in a rotated variation on its previous position.

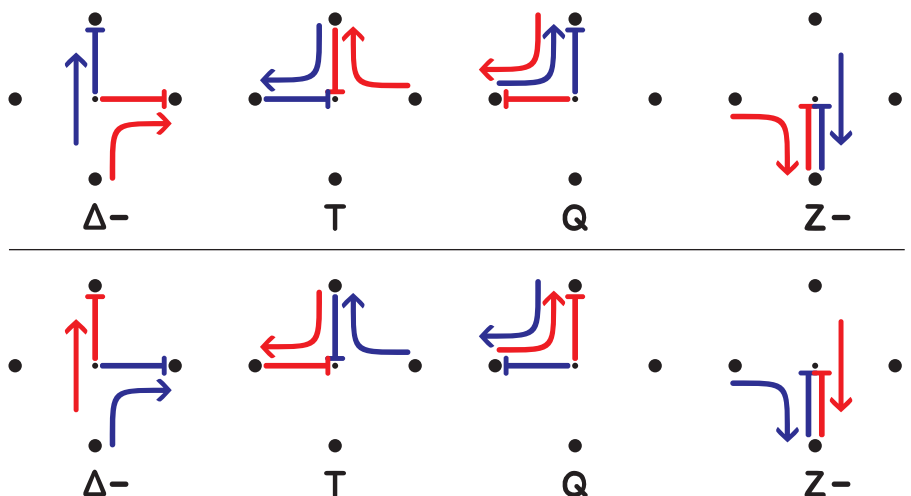
In this example, there is a 90° rotation, finally returning to the start position (aka "home").



## Swapped

In a swapped permutation, each repetition swaps the roles of **right/left**.

Though the prop's shapes look the same, this swap changes the body motion significantly.

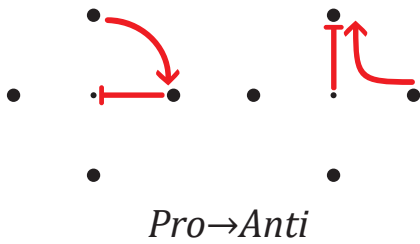


# Reversals

Reversals open up a huge number of possibilities!

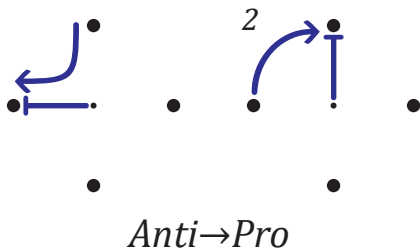
There are three types of reversals:

*start thumb in*



## *Hand-reversal*

With a hand reversal, the hand returns to the point it came from previously, without changing the prop's direction of spin. Relative to the center point, this changes a prospin to an antispin and vica-versa.

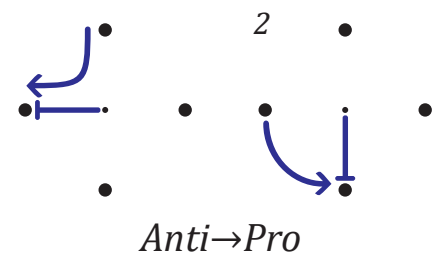
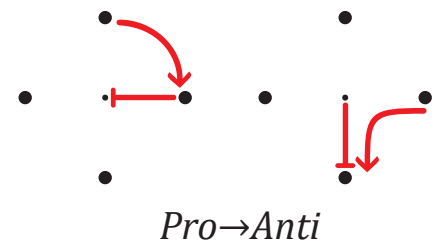


This is the simplest and least disruptive reversal. We've already used it in the previous examples.

## *Prop-reversal*

With a prop reversal, the hand continues to the next point while the prop reverses direction. This reversal also changes a prospin into an antispin and vica-versa.

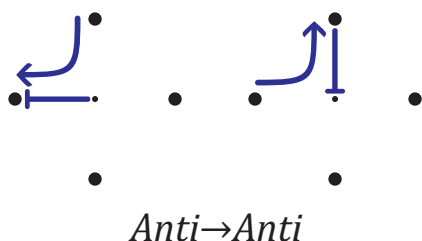
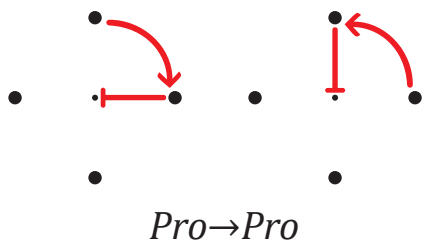
Since a prop reversal is less intuitive, you can add an “**R/R**” in the corresponding color in between the pictographs to indicate it.



## *Full-reversal*

With a full-reversal, the prop and hand retrace their paths and return to their previous position, as if going backwards in time.

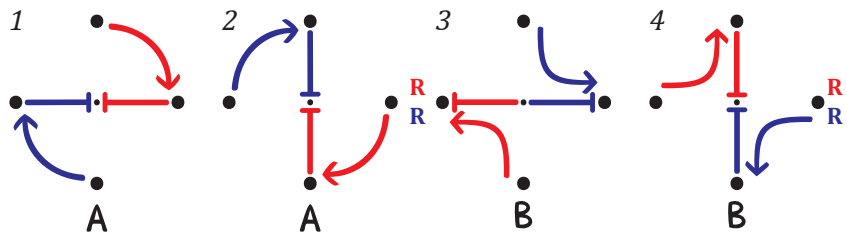
Because this contains a prop reversal, you can add an “**R/R**” to draw attention to it. This succinctly indicates to the performer that something unusual is happening.





# Examples

Let's practice reversals and permutations.  
We'll use AABB as an example to explore different reversal placements.



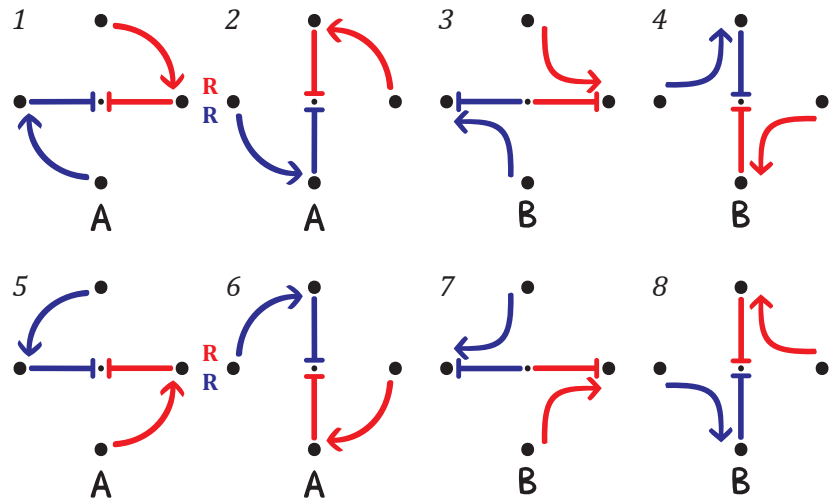
Here's an AABB in which both staves execute **prop-reversals** after beats 2 and 4, notated by an "**R/R**" in between the pictographs.

This requires negative space or a body turn to execute.

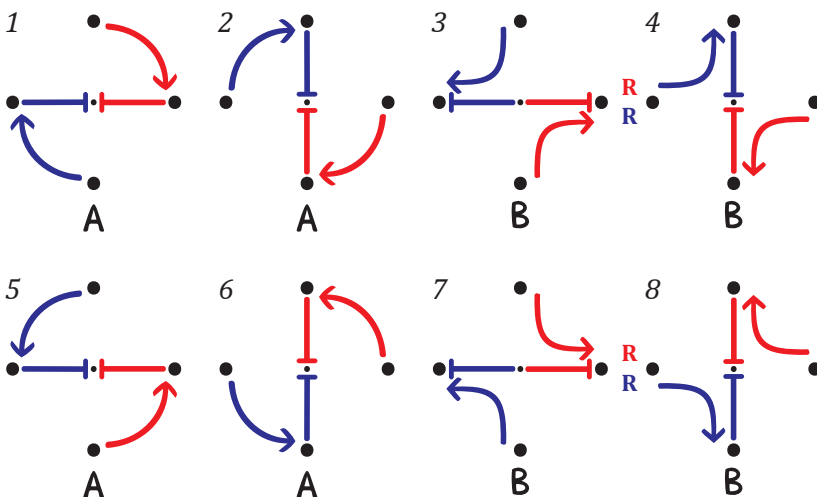
Let's place the reversals in a different place. This time we'll put them after beat 1.

This will put our left hand on top after beat 4, so we'll repeat the sequence again mirrored (with a reversal after beat 5) to return to our original home position.

This is a *Mirrored Permutation*.



Now let's look at another variation of AABBB\*2 with reversals after beats 3 & 7:



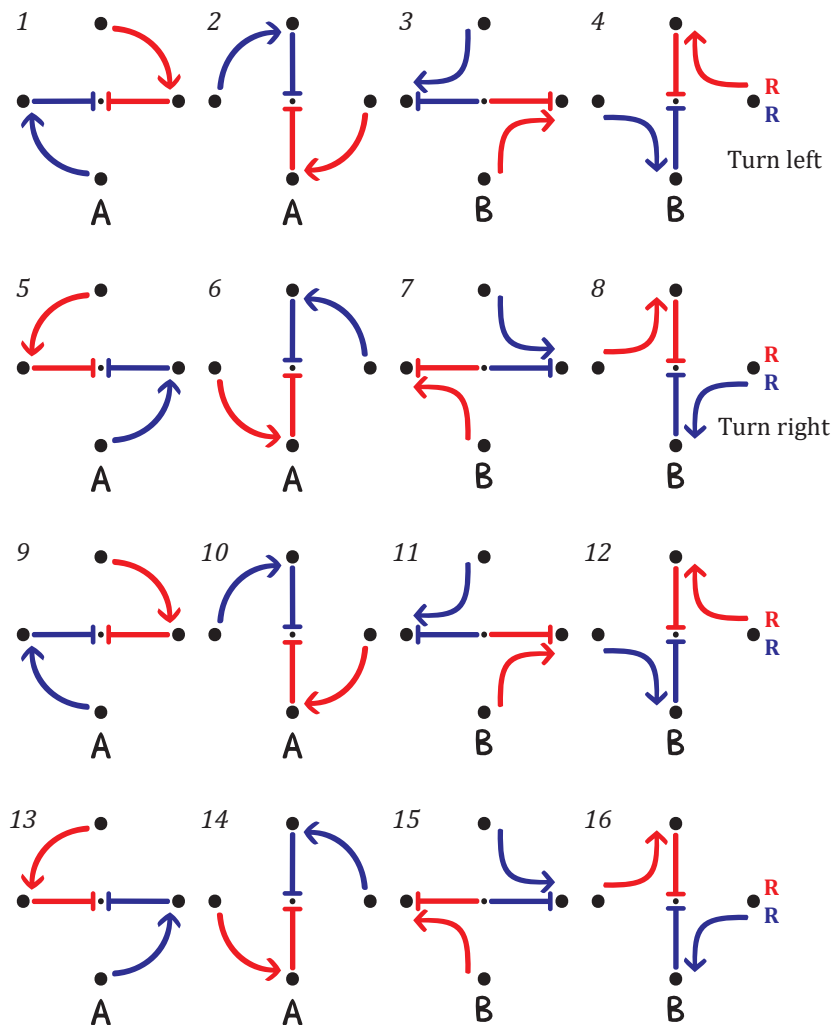
As demonstrated with these examples, a reversal in different locations in the word can lead to a notably different outcome.

The word AABBB is not limited to one presentation, it is a broad category of sequences that includes those letters with variations on reversals and thumb orientation.

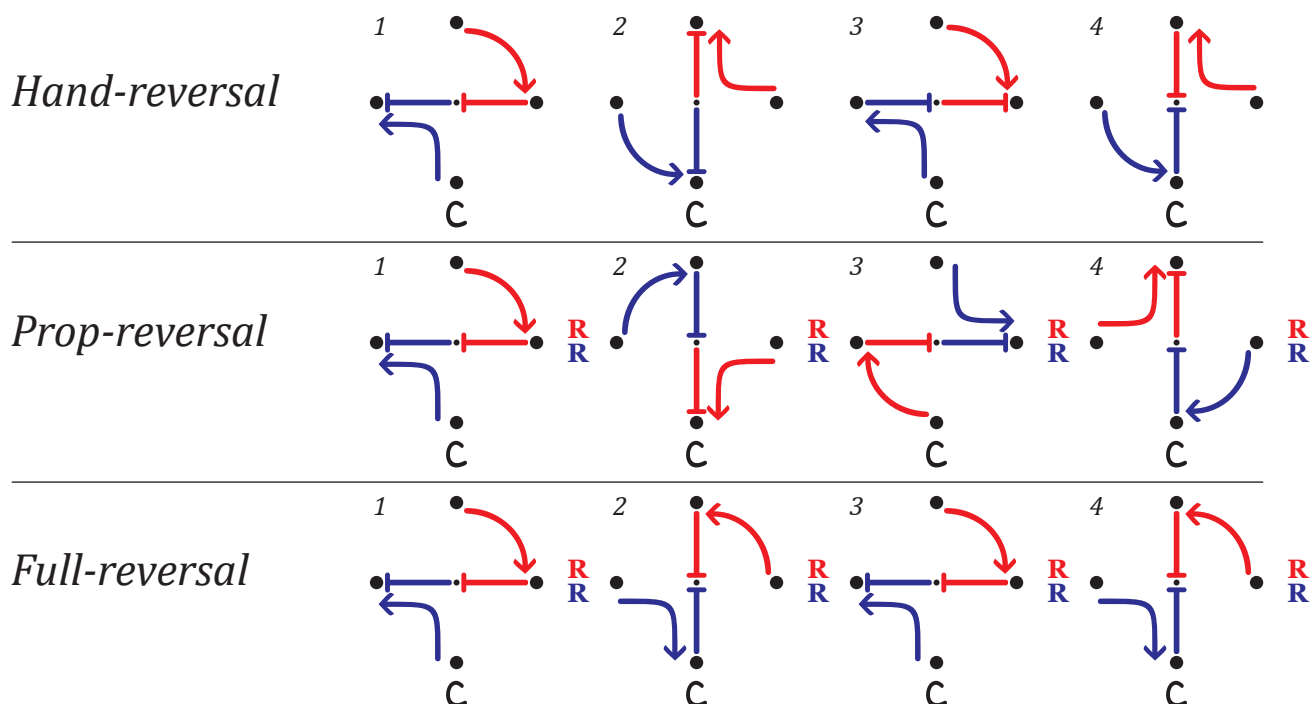
Let's add reversals after the second B. Since beat 5 has the right hand coming down on the left side of the grid, it's impossible to follow through to beat 6 while remaining square with the audience in wall plane. We must *body turn* and move into wheel plane in order to follow through.

We'll fix the asymmetry by repeating the 8-count sequence again while turning the other way, creating a 16 count sequence.

This sequence is a good example of how body turns can serve both as a method of motion execution and a body movement that can be incorporated as dance.

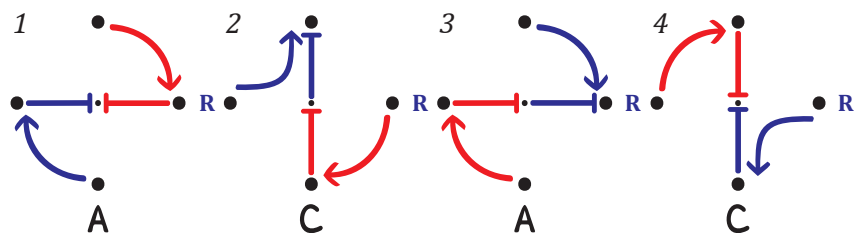


Now let's observe how reversals affect pro/anti hybrid words like CCCC. They present more variations than non-hybrids:



When combining a hybrid like C with a non-hybrid like A or B, a prop-reversal is necessary.  
Let's look at the word ACAC.

In this variation, the left hand does a reversal on every beat. Give it a try:

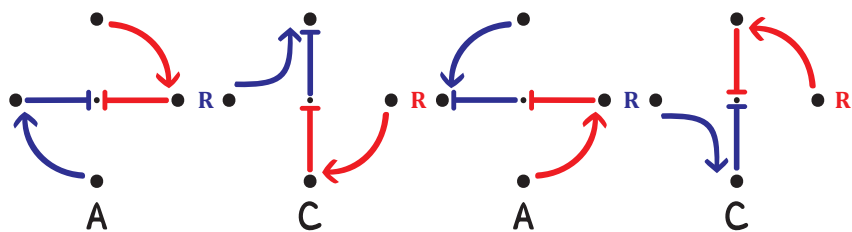


It would be impossible to execute ACAC without using a prop-reversal.

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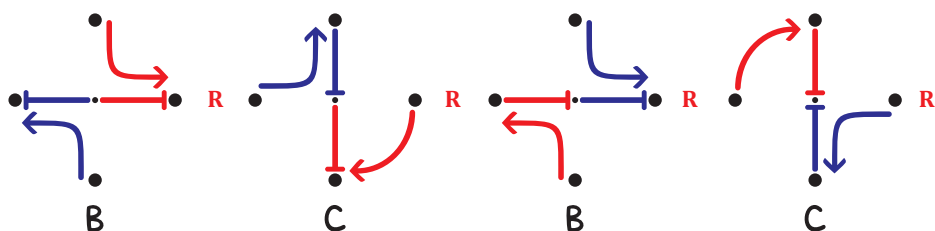
The previous example shows the hands moving in a *continuous* path.  
Let's change that in the next example by including a full-reversal in the middle.  
In this example, the reversals alternate between left (**R**) and right (**R**).

This example uses every type of reversal - *hand*, *prop*, and *full*.  
Challenge yourself to identify where each one occurs.



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Prop-reversals are also required with BCBC, as shown in this example:

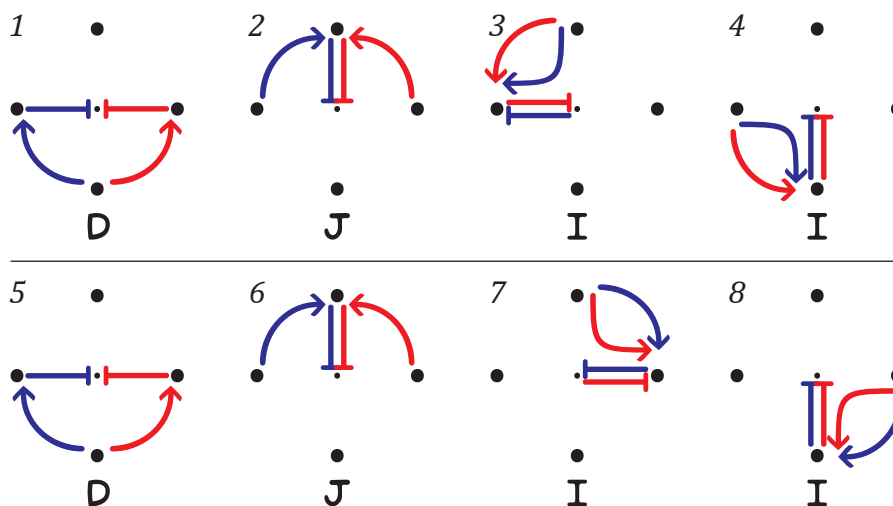


Here, the **right** hand is prop-reversing after every beat. Eventually, it returns to home.

# Type 1 Permutations

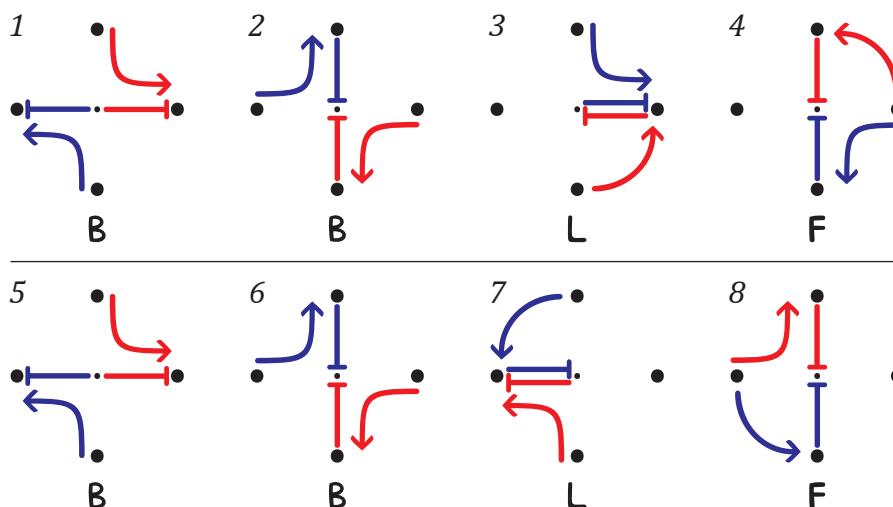
In this example of DJII, the graphs in the second repetition (beats 5-8) mirror the graphs in the first repetition (beats 1-4), classifying it as a *Mirrored Permutation*.

DJII

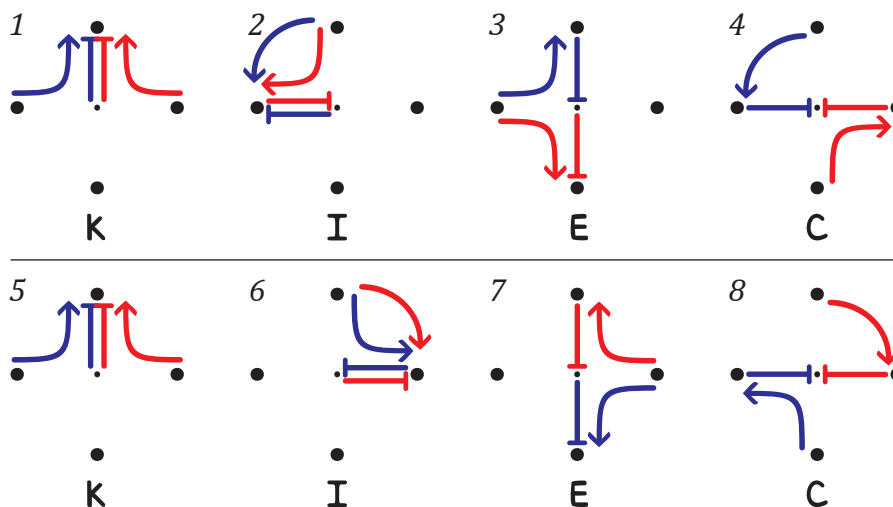


BBLF

Swapped/Rotated  
Permutation



KIEC

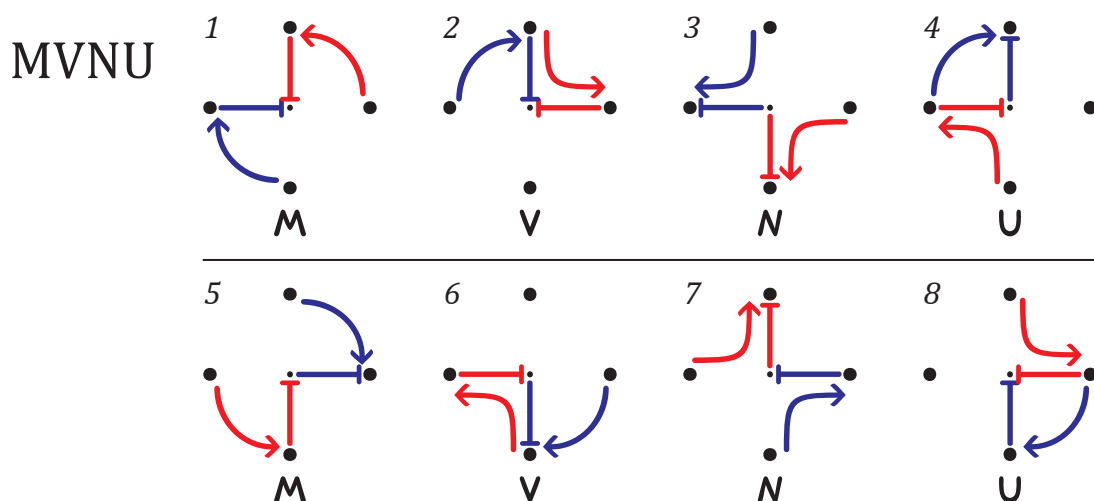
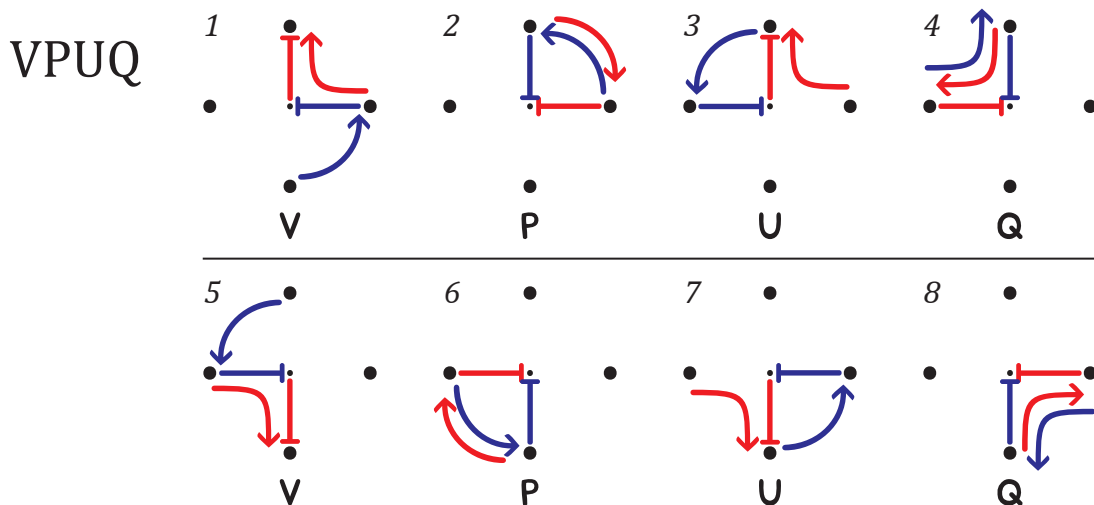
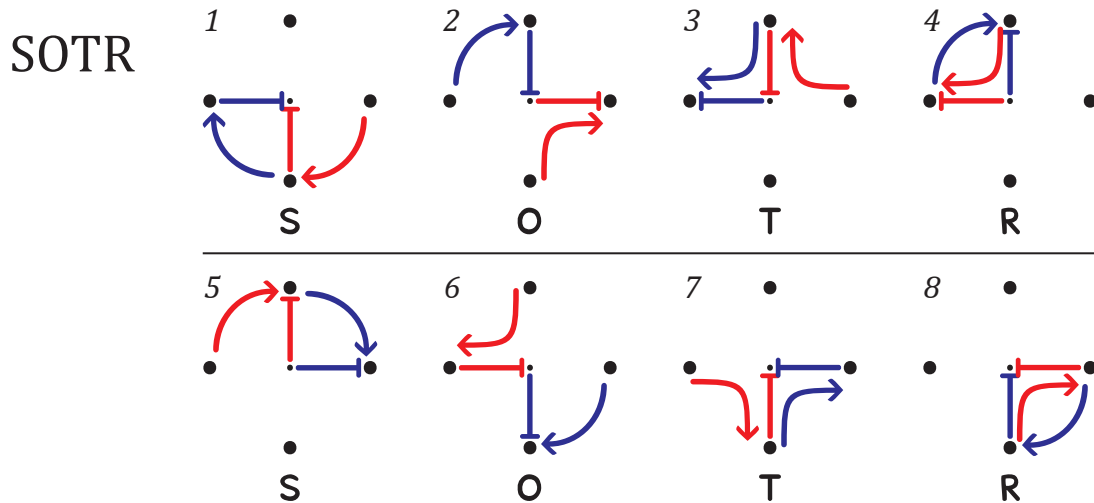


In this example of KIEC, the colors are swapped in the second half, so it is classified as a *Swapped/Mirrored Permutation*.

# Gamma

The  $\Gamma \rightarrow \Gamma$  letters can connect to any other  $\Gamma \rightarrow \Gamma$  letter.

In these examples, each word ends in gamma position on the opposite side.  
By repeating the word from there, we return to home position.



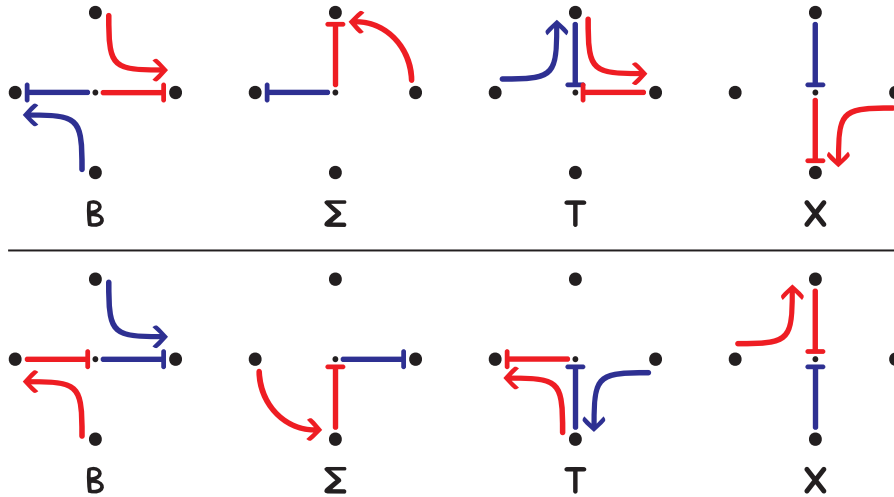
Note that the pictographs in each second word repetition are rotated 180°.  
Because of this, these examples are classified as *Rotated Permutations*.

# Type 2 Permutations

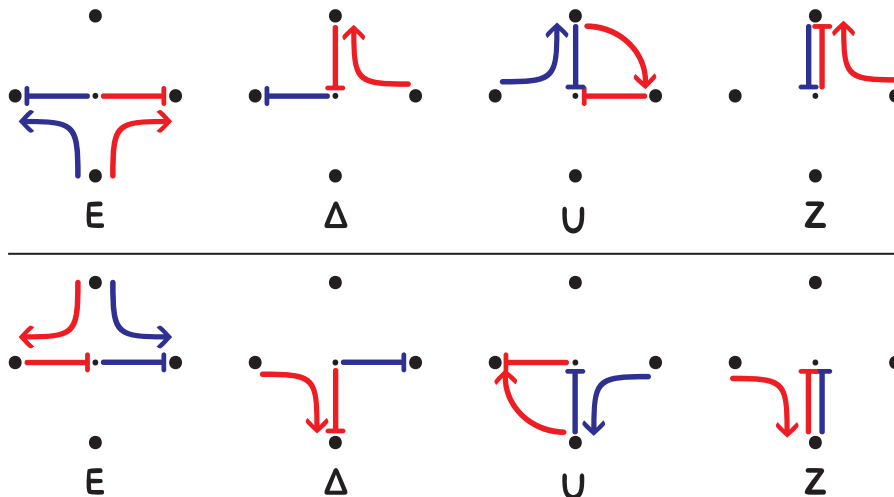
These words use the Type 2 letters to travel between  $\alpha/\beta$  and  $\Gamma$ .

Since each repetition is rotated by  $180^\circ$ , these are all *Rotated Permutations*.

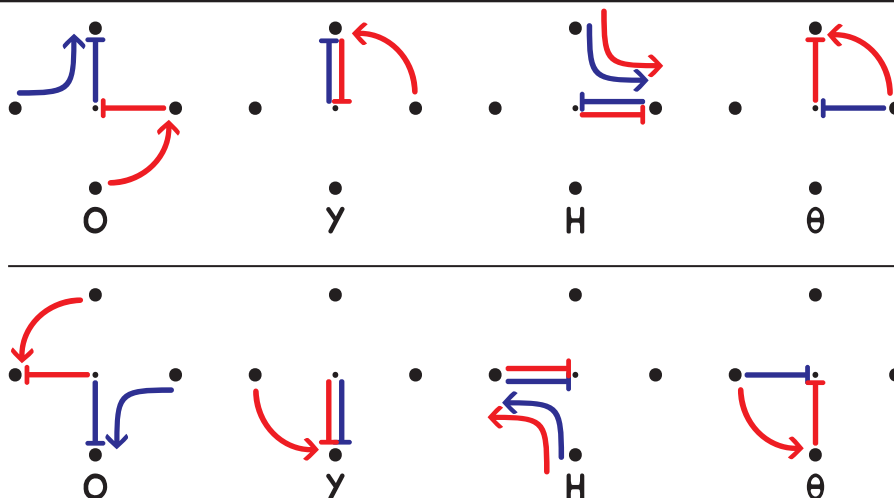
BΣTX



EΔUZ



OYHθ



# 16-Count Sequences

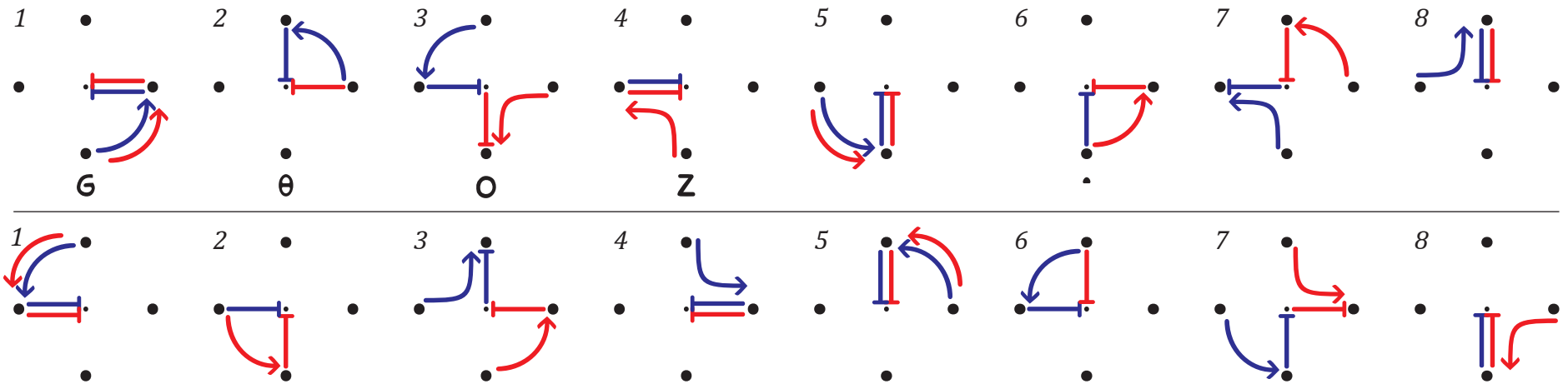
These 4-letter words repeat 4 times, giving us 16-count sequences.

As shown here, you can omit the letters when a word is repeating itself multiple times.  
This reduces visual overwhelm.

GθOZ

Here, each repetition of the word ends in a  $\beta$  that is  $90^\circ$  from its start.

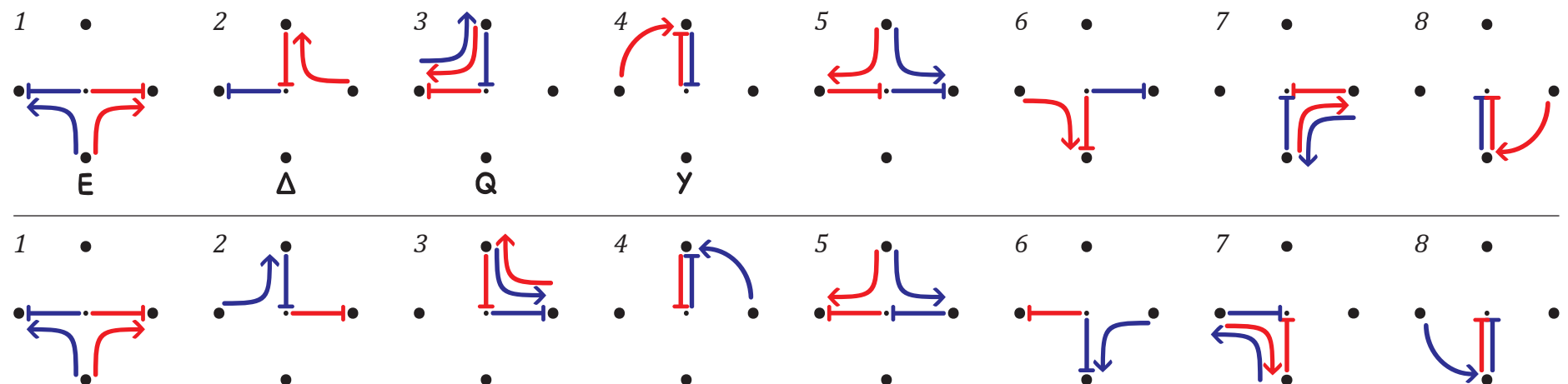
This means it will take 4 repetitions to return to home. (*Rotated+Swapped Permutation*)



EΔQY

Here, the staves return to home after two word repetitions. To make it symmetrical,

it repeats twice more, filling the rest of the quadrants. (*Rotated + Mirrored + Swapped Permutation*)

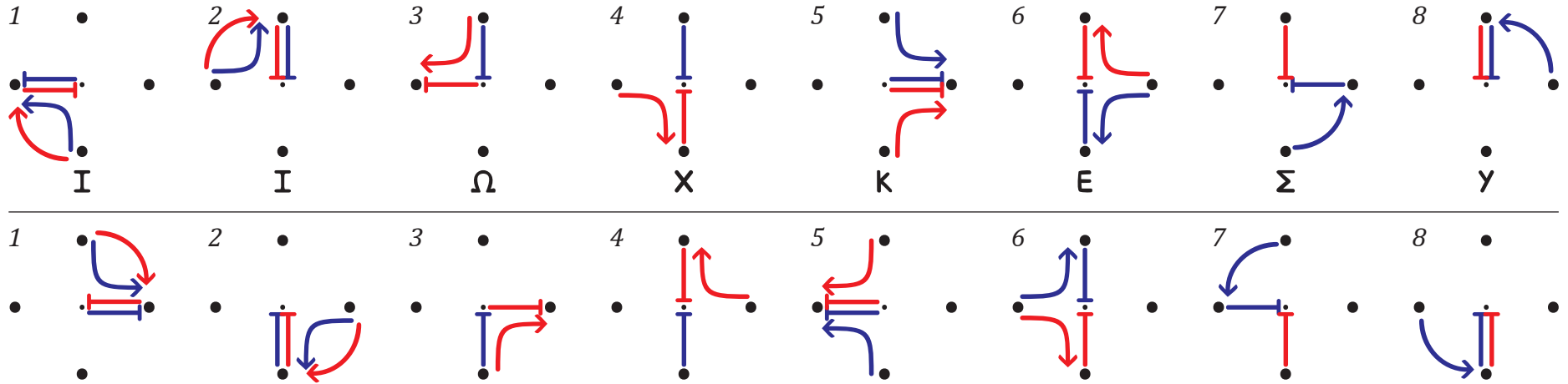


# 8-Letter Words

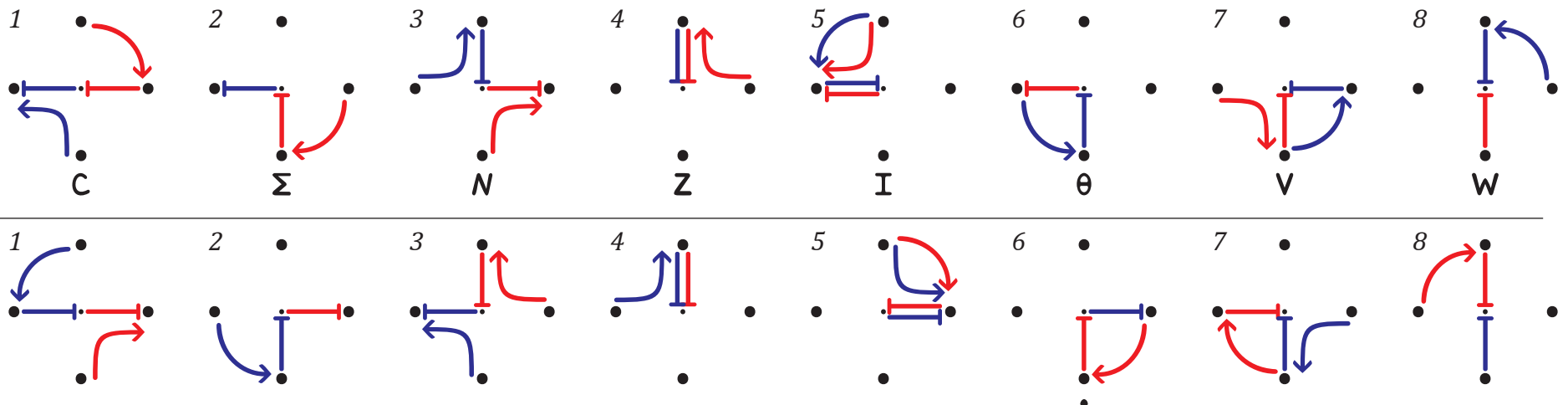
Words can be any length.

These 8-letter words repeat twice, to create 16-count sequences.

## IIΩXKEYΣY (Rotated Permutation)



## CΣNZIΘVW (Mirrored + Swapped Permutation)

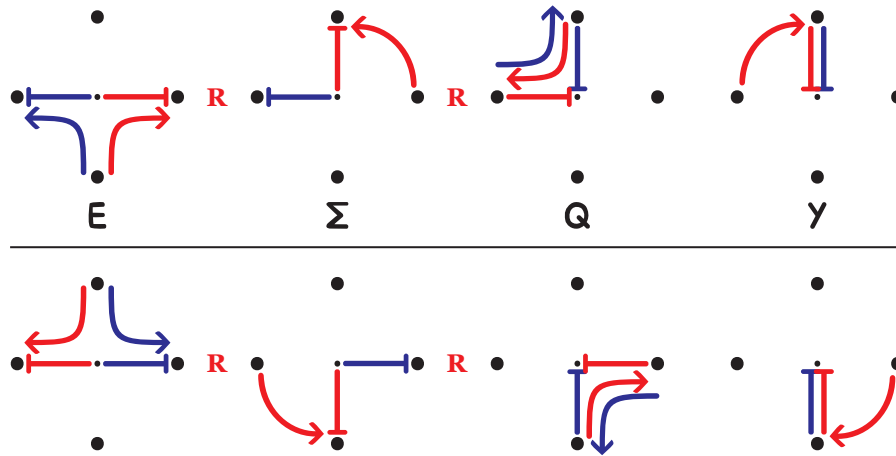




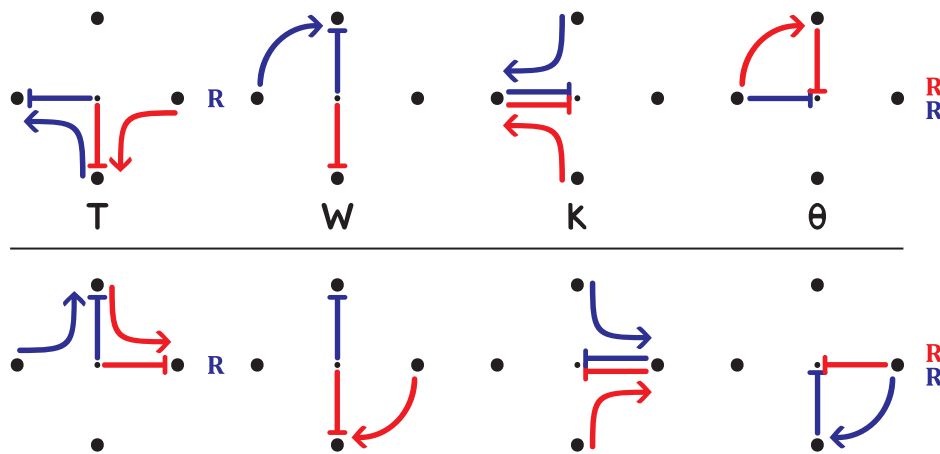
# Prop-reversal Permutations

Each of these words uses a prop-reversal.  
These examples are *Rotated Permutations*.

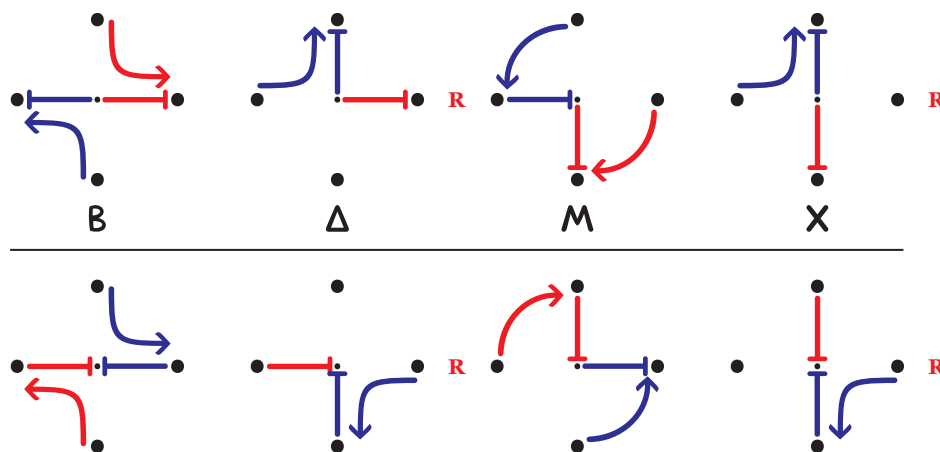
EΣQY



TWKθ



BΔMX

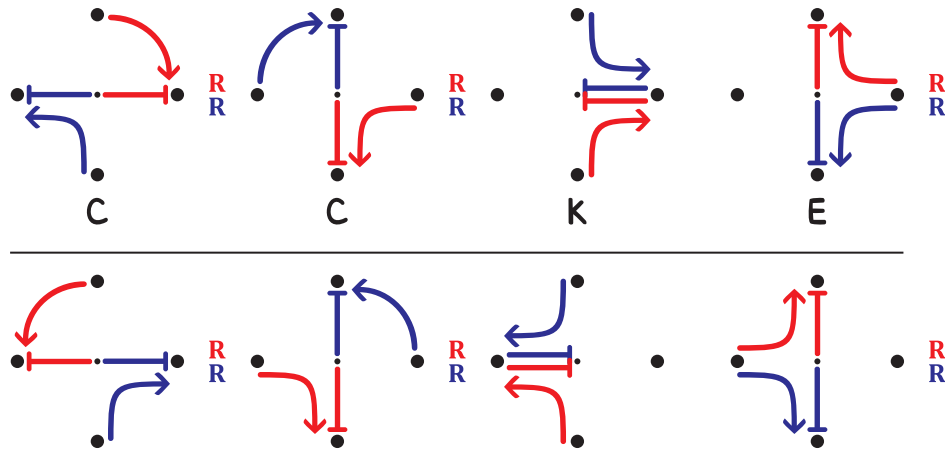


In this example of BΔMX, the **right** hand stops on beats 2 and 4 before resuming its motion around the center point. Even when there is a beat with no motion in between, we can still mark the reversal with an “**R**” to indicate the prop reversal.

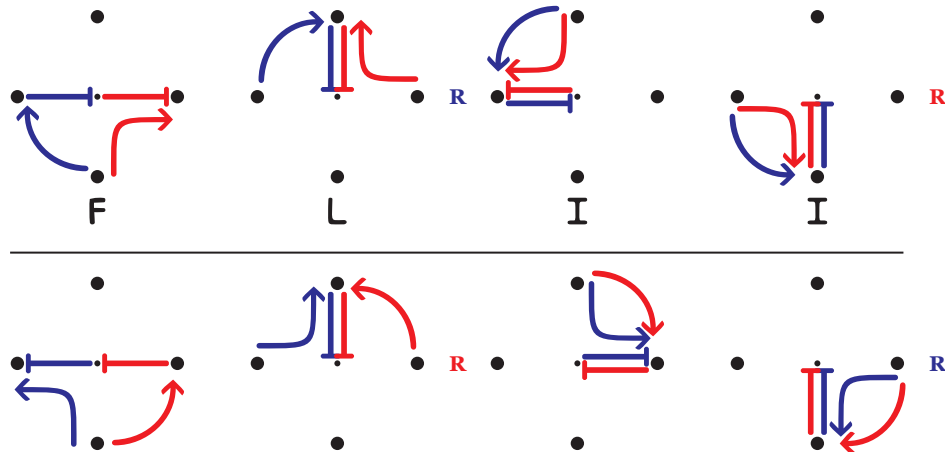
# Full-reversal Permutations

Each of these words uses a full-reversal.  
There are also prop-reversals within these words.  
Challenge yourself to identify each one.

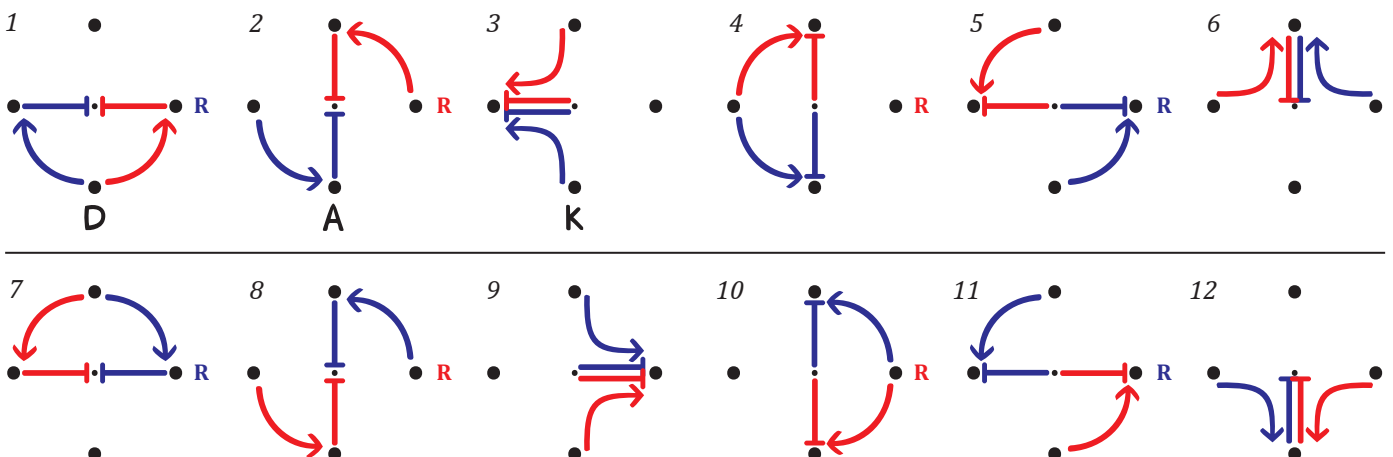
CCKE

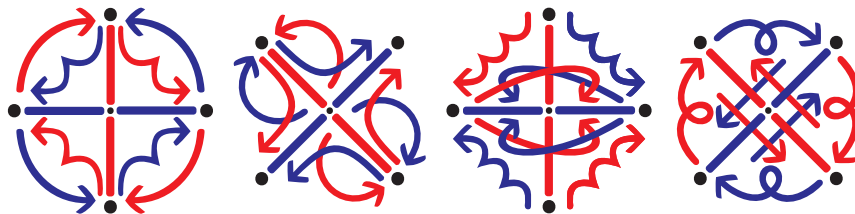


FLII



DAK



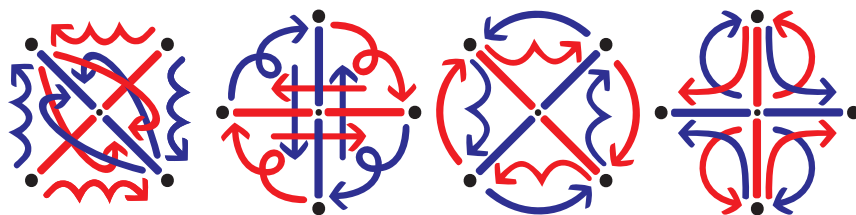


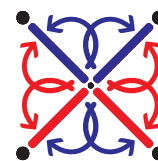
1.3



*Turns*

*Double Turns*





## Shifts

*VTG: 1:3*

Let's add a single turn to a shift.

Pro/Anti motions are rotating 90° already in their base form.

Here, we don't include this extra  $90^\circ$  when counting turns.

Instead, we focus on the amount of additional rotation added to this base motion, using the thumb orientation (in/out) as our guide.

First we'll add 1 turn to a prospin.

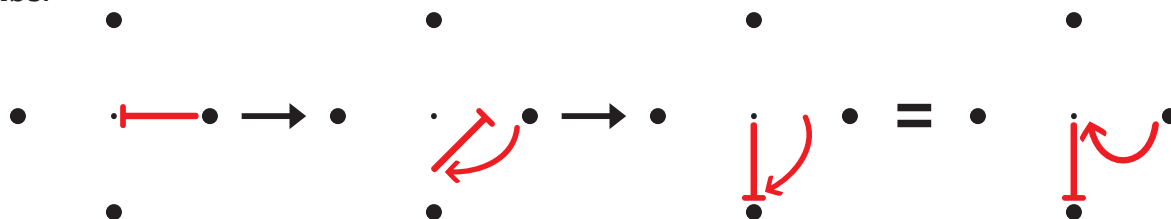
Take note of the diagonal halfway position, and pause there for a moment before continuing.

*These arrows refer to the pinky end on the first half, then to the thumb end on the second half.*

*The full arrow depicts a half-circle, from the start position's outer point.*

*halfway*

*Pro*



A base prospin (ASA isolation) has 0 thumb switches, therefore

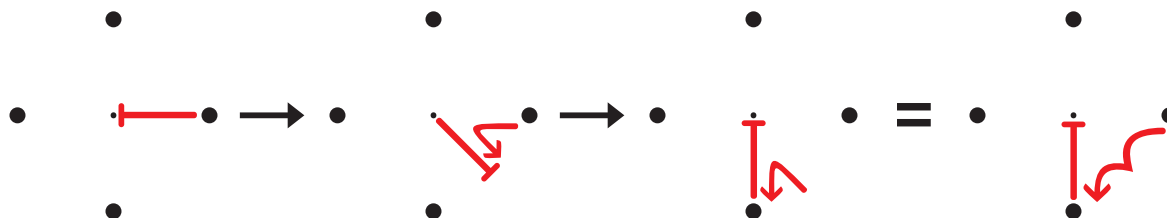
**A prospin with a turn has 1 thumb switch (in → out)**

Now let's add 1 turn to an antispin.

Again, take note of the diagonal halfway position, and pause there before continuing.

halfway  
out

## Anti



A base antispin has 1 thumb switch. (in  $\rightarrow$  out), therefore

**An antispin with a turn has 2 thumb switches (in → out → in).**

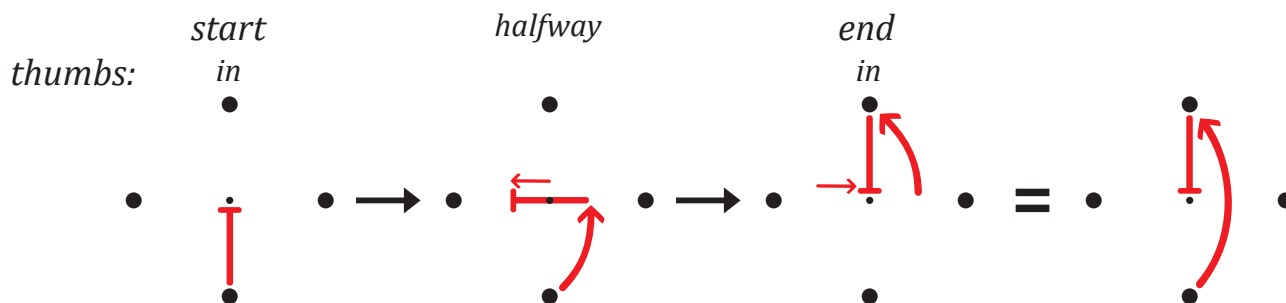
# Dashes

You can also add a turn to a dash.

VTG: 1:1

To execute this correctly, move the hand directly in a straight line.

***Pause at the halfway point while learning to ensure that your hand is in the center point and the staff is perpendicular to your starting position.***



A base dash has 1 thumb switch (in → out), therefore:

**A dash with a turn has 2 thumb switches (in → in)**

Executing this move on repeat is commonly called a ***linear extension*** or a ***cateye***.

It feels peculiar to execute with staves because one end is in pro and the other end is in anti.

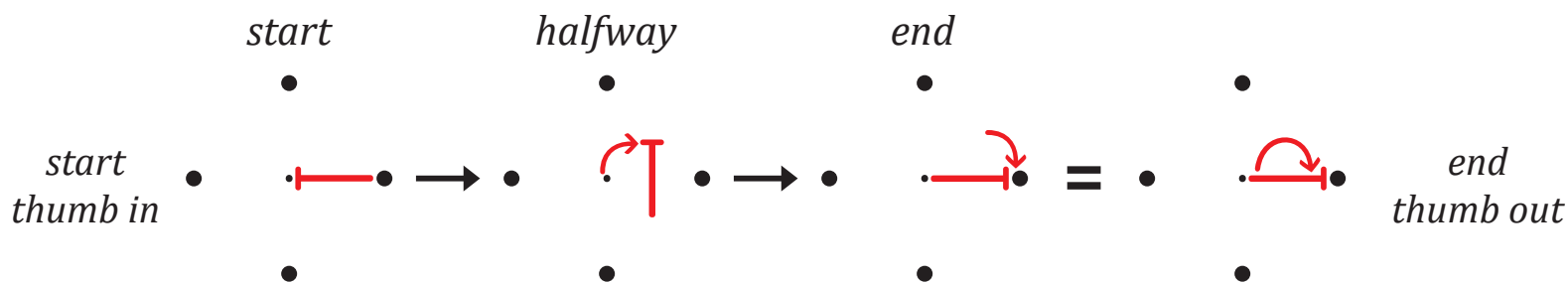
It helps to focus on the half that's in antispin.

This will ensure that you pass your hand directly through the center point.

## Static

Finally, we'll look at static turns.

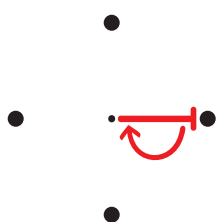
Here is a breakdown of a static turn starting from thumb in:



This can be executed at any hand point, starting from either thumb orientation, turning in either direction.

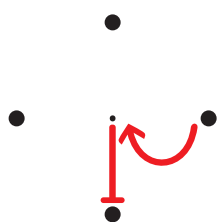
Note the differences between the arrow for static turns and the arrow for prospin turns:

### Static



Prop remains at its start position. The arrow forms a half circle with that position.

### Shift



Prop ends at an adjacent position. The arrow forms a half-circle around the empty start position.

# Glyphs / PADS

A **glyph** is a letter combined with other characters, such as numbers or symbols.

To the right of each letter, there are two slots - high and low.  
These slots contain numbers that indicate turns.

High  
A  
Low

In a hybrid, motion types are different and must be disambiguated.  
These rules indicate where to place the numbers:

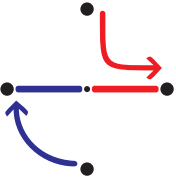
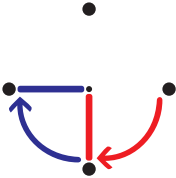
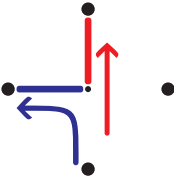
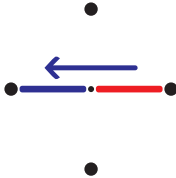
High  
Low  
Pro  
Anti  
Dash  
Static  
Shifts

**The motion that is higher on the list is indicated by the high slot.**

Remember the order with the acronym **PADS**, for **Pro**, **Anti**, **Dash**, **Static**.

Exceptions are the letters S and T with another factor - *leading/following*.  
In their case, leading is high and following is low.

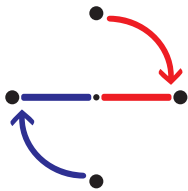
There are five hybrids, each shown below in their corresponding high/low slots.

| Type 1<br><i>Dual-Shift</i>                                                        | Type 2<br><i>Shift</i>                                                              | Type 3<br><i>Cross-Shift</i>                                                          | Type 4<br><i>Dash</i>                                                                 |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  |  |  |  |
| <i>Pro</i><br><i>Anti</i>                                                          | <i>Leading</i><br><i>Following</i>                                                  | <i>Shift</i><br><i>Static</i>                                                         | <i>Dash</i><br><i>Static</i>                                                          |
| C, F, I, L,<br>O, R, U, V                                                          | S, T                                                                                | W, X, Y, Z,<br>Σ, Δ, θ, Ω                                                             | Φ, Ψ, Λ                                                                               |

The remaining letters have combinations of the same motion type.

For these, put **left** in the high slot and **right** in the low slot.

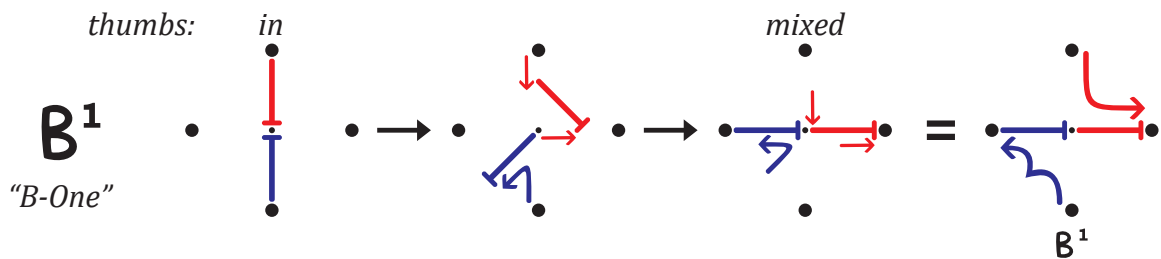
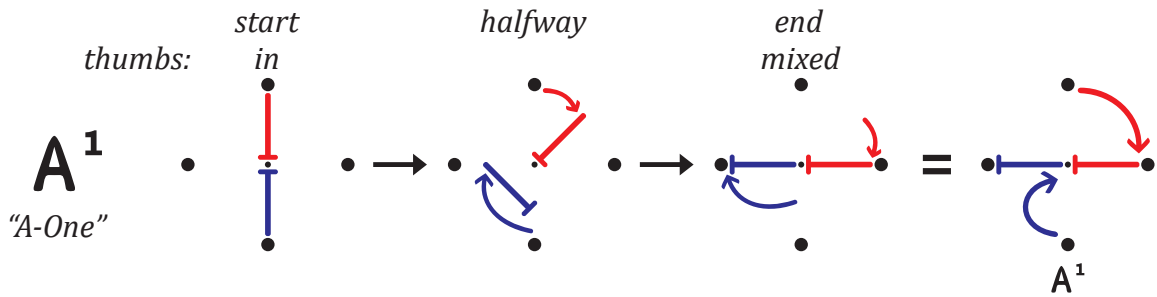
These letters include:  
A, B, D, E, G, H, J, K, M, N, P, Q, S, T  
Φ-, Ψ-, Λ-  
α, β, Γ,

  
Left  
Right

# Type 1 - *Dual-Shift*

When motion types are the same, put **left** in the high slot and **right** in the low slot.  
Here is a breakdown of A<sup>1</sup> (pro|pro) and B<sup>1</sup> (anti|anti).

**B** Left  
Right

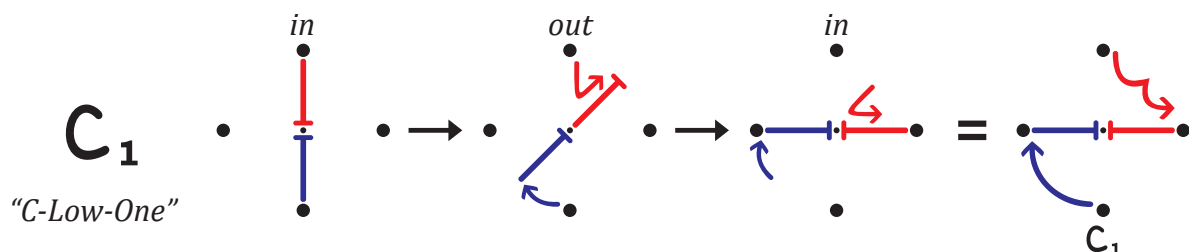
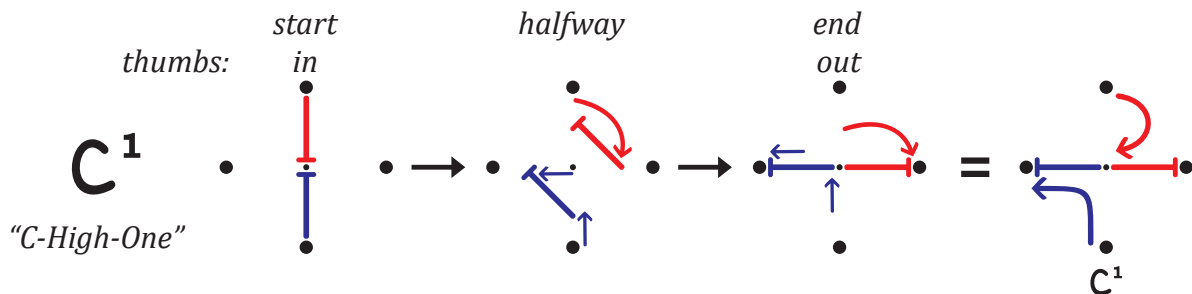


With hybrids like C, we can either add a turn to the prospin or the antispin.  
This results in multiple variations that we must disambiguate.  
To label them, we use the high/low position.

For pro/anti hybrids,  
**high = prospin and low = antispin,**

**C** Prospin  
Antispin

This includes C, F, I, L, O, R, U, and V.



For code or file-naming, indicate turns with parentheses like so: C<sup>1</sup> = C(1,0) and C<sub>1</sub> = C(0,1)

# *S and T*

S and T are a different type of hybrid.

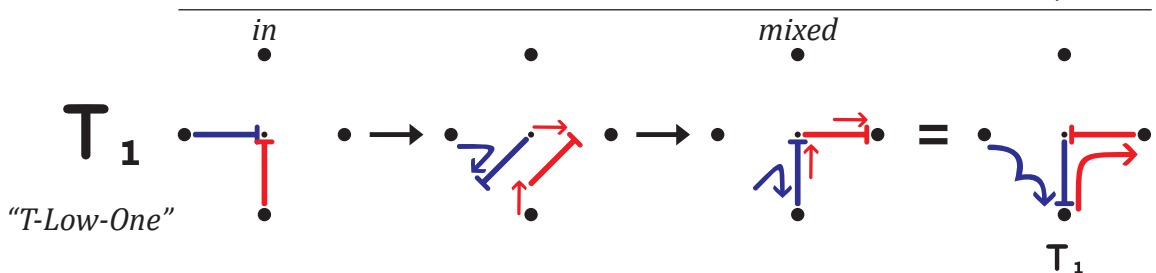
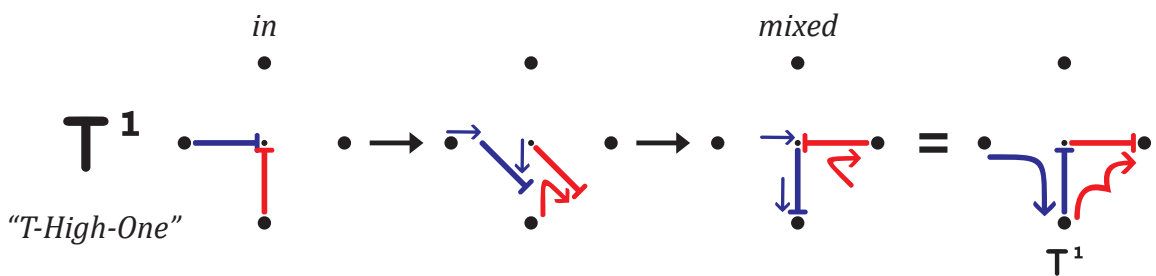
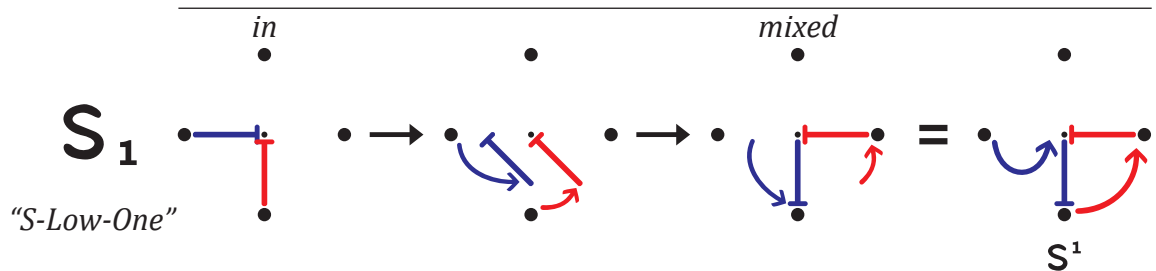
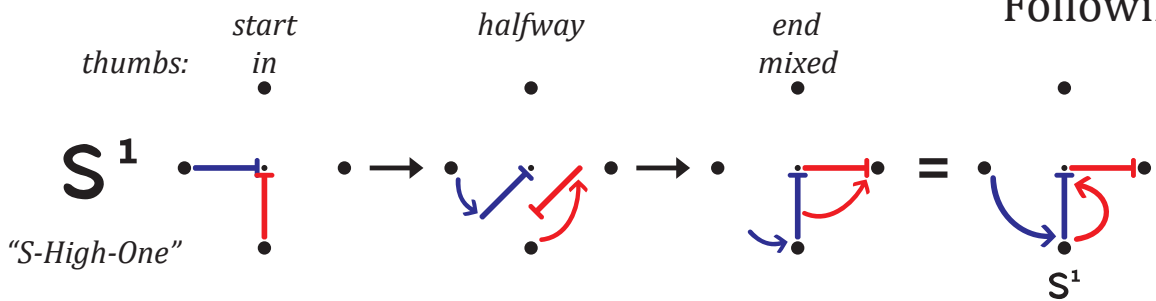
Even though their motions are a matching shift type (pro|pro, anti|anti), each has one hand **leading** and the other **following**. Though this doesn't affect their base forms, it produces additional variations when modifying their motions.

**S and T are the only letters with this unique quality.**

Fortunately, we have a tool to disambiguate hybrids - the high/low slots.

**For S and T,**  
**high = leading and low = following.**

**S** Leading  
Following



**Note that these leading/following rules do NOT apply to U and V.**  
Even though U and V have a leader/follower, their slots refer to pro/anti.



# Type 2 - Shift

Type 2 hybrids combine a shift and a static motion.

These two motion types are different, so we use the high/low slots to differentiate them.

To determine where they go, remember PADS.

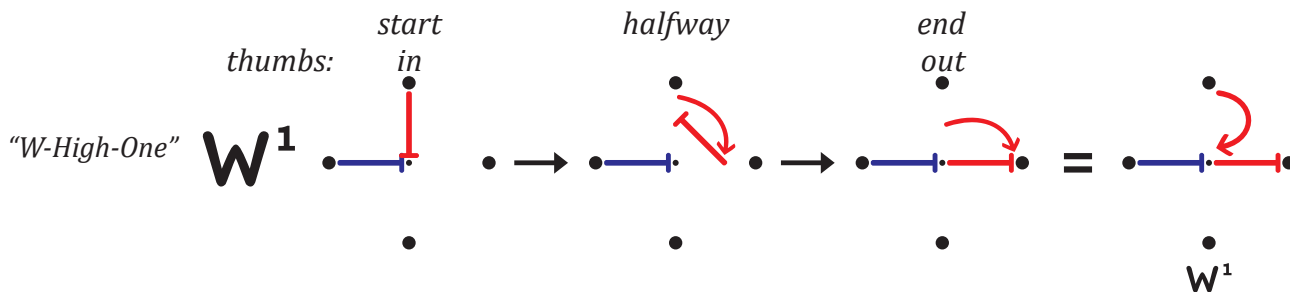
Because a shift (pro/anti) is higher than a static motion, we can confidently state that:

**For Type 2,  
high = shift and low = static.**

W Shift  
W Static

This includes W, X, Y, Z,  $\Sigma$ ,  $\Delta$ ,  $\theta$ , and  $\Omega$ .

Let's add 1 high turn to a Type 2 motion, which only affects the shift.

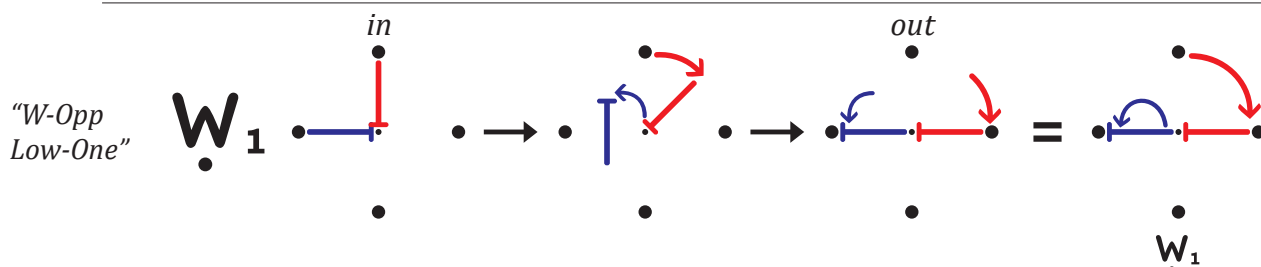
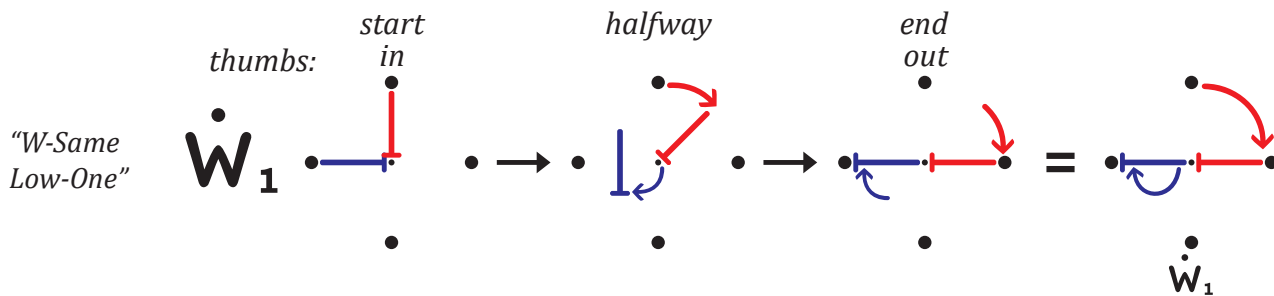


Since the static hand is still, this should be simple to execute.

Type 2 motions become more complex when we add turns to the static hand. Since this causes both props to rotate, it creates either a Same or Opposite relationship.

To indicate this, add a dot above or below the letter.\*

**A same-dot goes above and an opp-dot goes below.**



You can also use (s) or (o) as parameters to indicate "same" or "opp". E.g. "W(s,0,1)"

# Type 3 - **Cross-Shift**

Type 3 hybrids combine a shift with a dash.

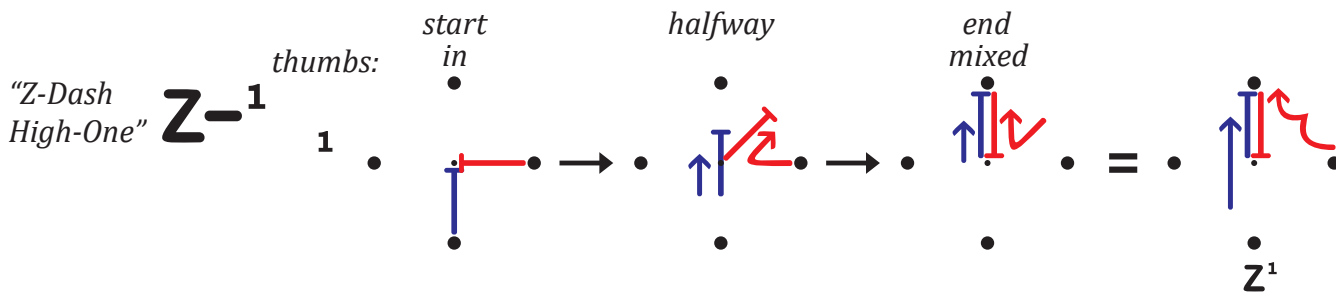
When we consult PADS, we find that a shift is higher than a dash, therefore:

**For Type 3,  
high = shift and low = dash.**

Shift  
**Z-**  
Dash

This includes W-, X-, Y-, Z-,  $\Sigma$ -,  $\Delta$ -,  $\theta$ -, and  $\Omega$ -.

First, we'll add 1 high turn to Z-, which only affects the shift.

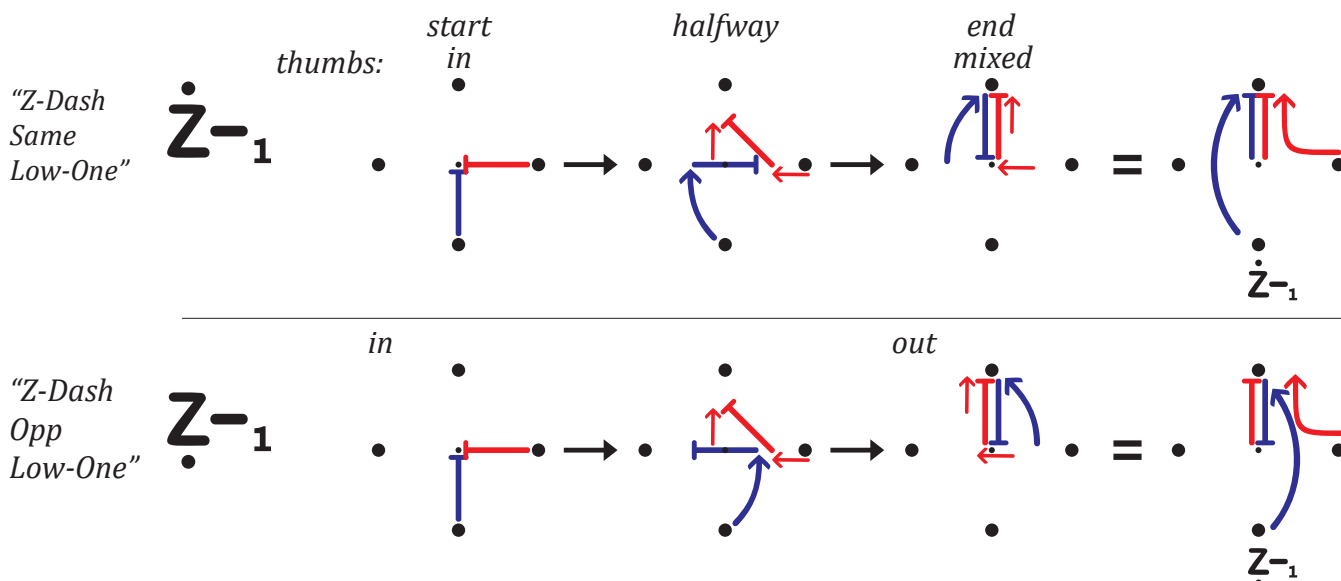


**Take note of this strange position at the halfway point.**

There is a hand-to-end relationship between the **left** hand and the **right** staff's pinky end. It is important to pass through this position for the timing to be accurate.

Now let's add 1 turn to the dash, leaving the shifting hand unmodified.

This creates a rotational relationship, so we'll need to use Same-dots and Opp-dots.



**The halfway position holds the key for executing cross-shifts with accurate timing.** Though unfamiliar now, these centric positions will be thoroughly deconstructed later on.

When writing code, put the dash after the letter and before the parentheses. "E.g. Z-(s,0,1)"

# Type 4 - Dash

Type 4 hybrids combine a dash with a static motion. There is no shift involved.

According to PADS, a dash is higher than a static motion.

We reflect that by using the high slot for dash and the low slot for static.

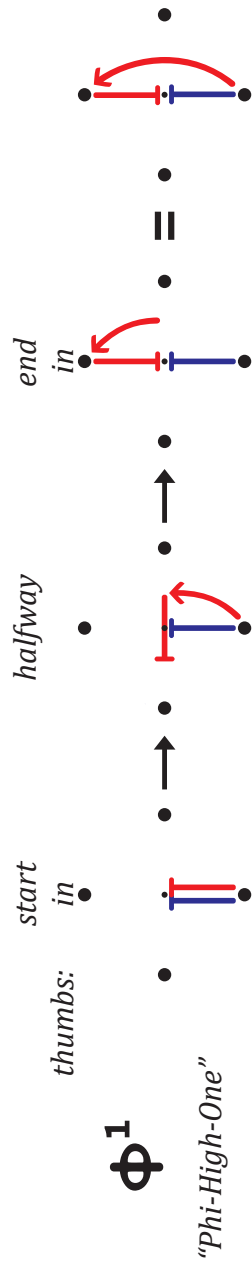
## For Type 4,

**high = dash and low = static.**

Dash  
 $\Phi$   
Static  
 $\Phi$

This includes  $\Phi$ ,  $\Psi$ , and  $\Lambda$ .

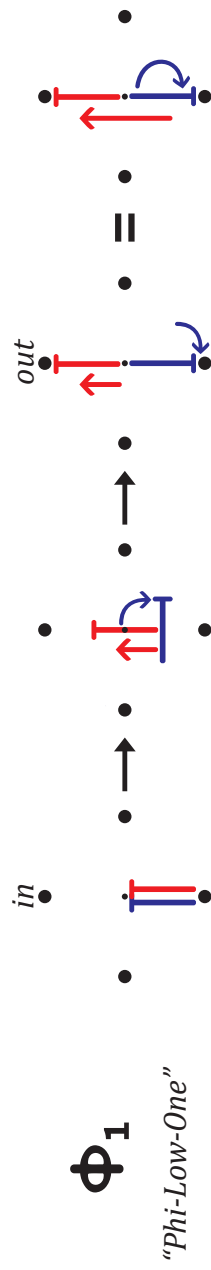
First we'll look at  $\Phi$ .



Since only one prop is rotating, there is no rotational relationship to describe.

If we follow the same dash while rotating in the opposite direction, the pictograph is a mirror image and needs no disambiguation.

Now let's add 1 turn to the static hand, leaving the dash in its base form.



**Pause at the halfway point and check your position.**

Here, there is a hand-to-end relationship with the **left** hand and the **right** pinky end.

Again, there is no rotational relationship to describe,

so we don't need to separate them.

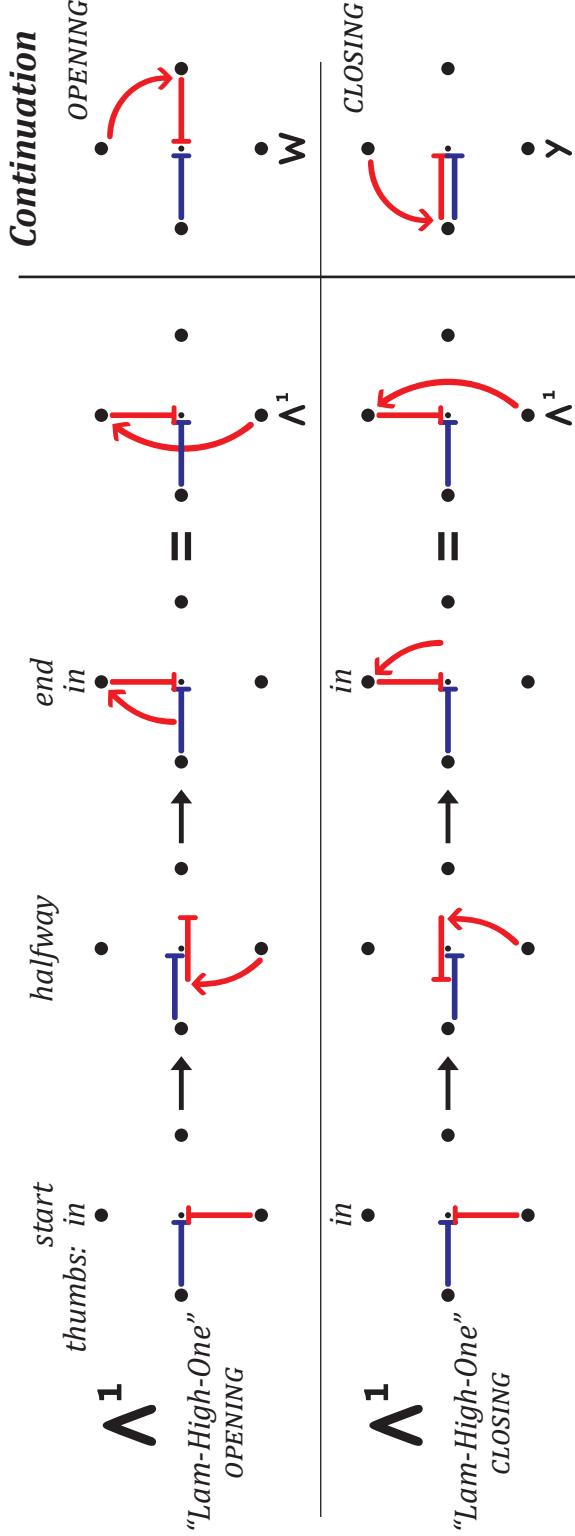
*When typing the words for sequences containing greek symbols, it's easier to just type the word or its first three letters. E.g. " $\phi(0,1)$ "*  
*The corresponding symbol can easily be swapped in with a simple script.*  
*The short versions of the seven greek letters are "sig, del, the, om, phi, psi, lam"*

# Opening/Closing

Because of Gamma's asymmetry,  $\Lambda$  (Lam) presents an extra variation when adding a turn. We can't use rotational relationship to tell them apart, because there isn't one to describe. Instead, we can disambiguate them with opening and closing.

This refers to the appearance of the 90° angle if we continue the rotation into a pro-shift.

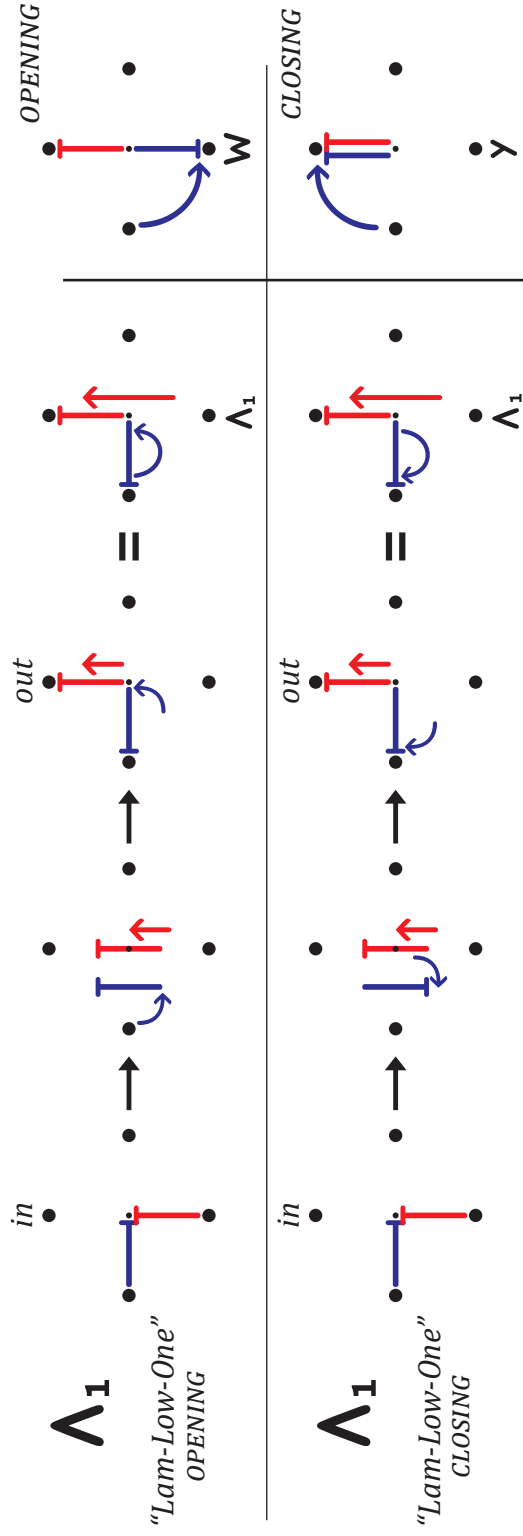
Take a look at the sequences below and their hypothetical continuation. Note the difference.



Now let's add 1 turn to the static hand, leaving the dash in its base form.

Since the dashed prop is not rotating, there is no rotational relationship to describe.

However the rotating static prop can still be identified as *opening* or *closing*.



It's not necessary to speak all of the glyph modifications when talking about a letter.

It would be cumbersome if you were required to say "Lam-Low-One-Closing".

In the context of a word or sequence, you can just refer to the base letter "Lam" instead.

To shorten this for code, include "op" or "cl" as a final parameter. E.g. " $\Lambda(0,1,op)$ " or " $\Lambda(0,1,cl)$ ".

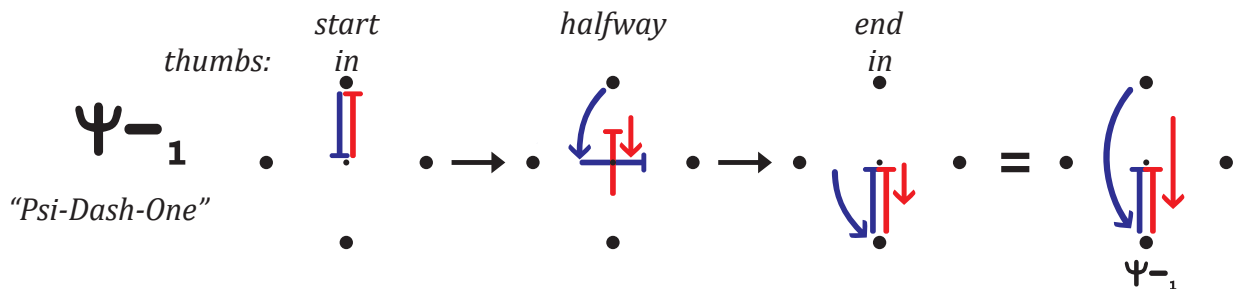
# Type 5 - *Dual-Dash*

In Type 5 motions, both hands are dashing, so there are no hybrids. Since they're the same type (dash|dash), the left goes in the high slot, and the right goes in the low slot.

This includes  $\Phi$ -,  $\Psi$ -, and  $\Lambda$ -.

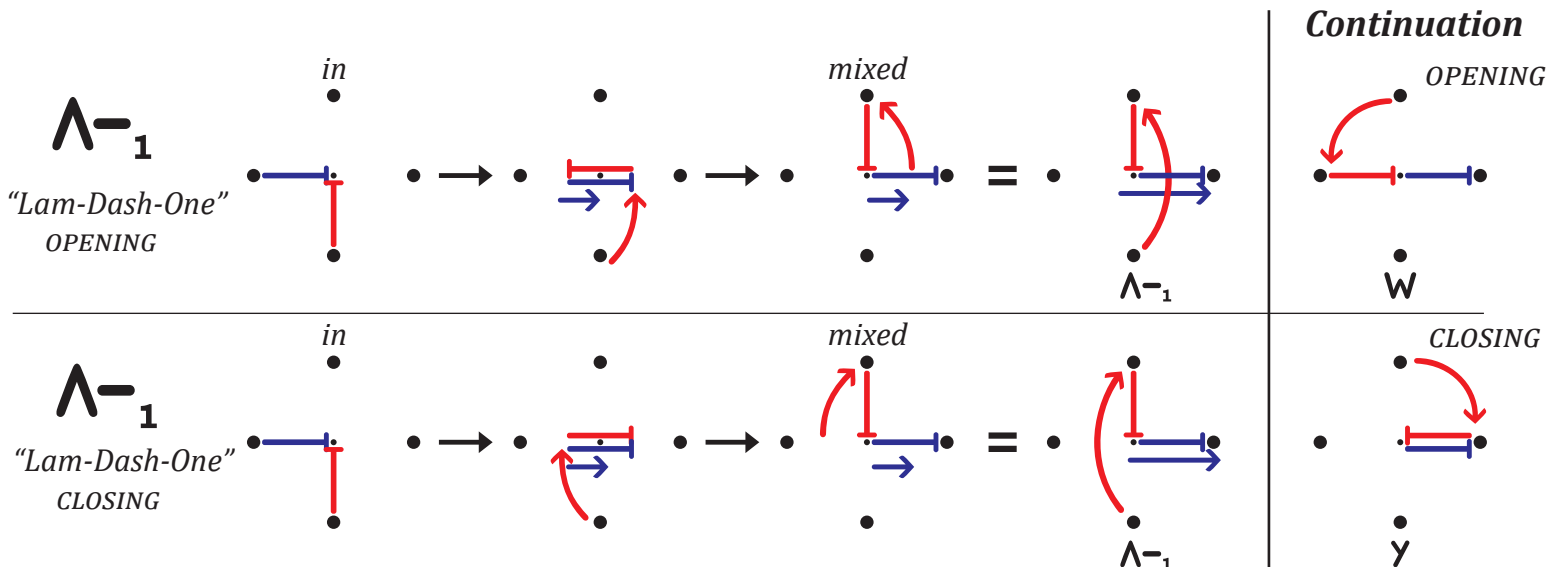
Left  
 $\Psi$ -  
Right  
*Psi-Dash*

Let's break down  $\Psi$ -<sup>1</sup>:



**Remember - the high/low slots do not refer to left/right.**  
Instead, their purpose is to differentiate two motion types.  
In Type 5, those motion types are the same (dash|dash).

Now let's look at  $\Lambda$ -<sup>1</sup>, which again presents variations of *opening* and *closing*.



As always, pause at the halfway point to drill it into your muscle memory.  
This will ensure proper timing.

# Type 6 - *Static*

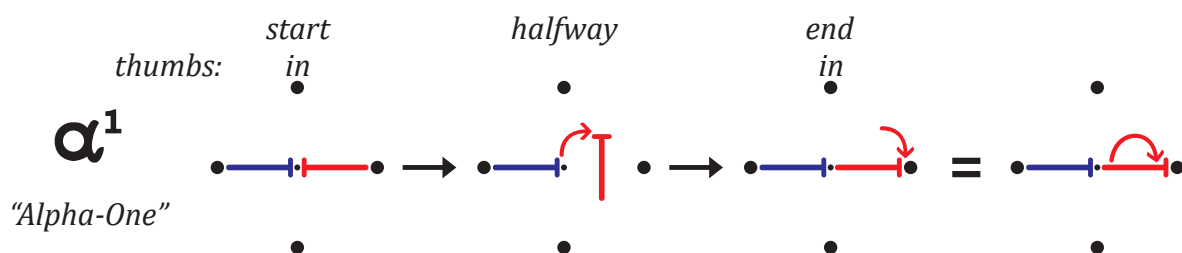
Finally, Type 6 letters have both hands remaining static.

Both types are the same (static|static), so the number goes in the high slot by default.

This includes  $\alpha$ ,  $\beta$ , and  $\Gamma$ .

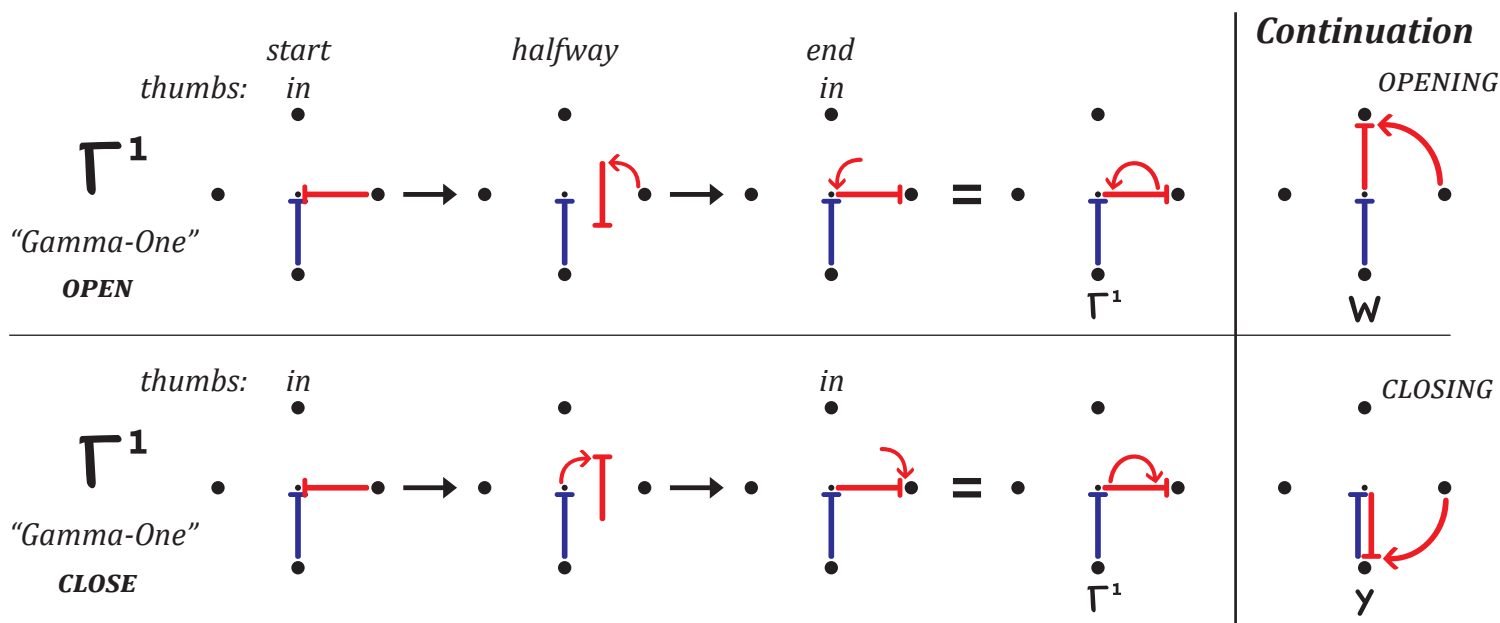
Static  
 $\alpha$   
Static  
*Alpha*

Let's break down  $\alpha^1$ :



Note that the arrow can follow the path of either the thumb end or pinky end.  
The optimal placement depends on context.

$\Gamma^1$  also presents variations on *opening/closing*.



These static single-turns are relatively simple.

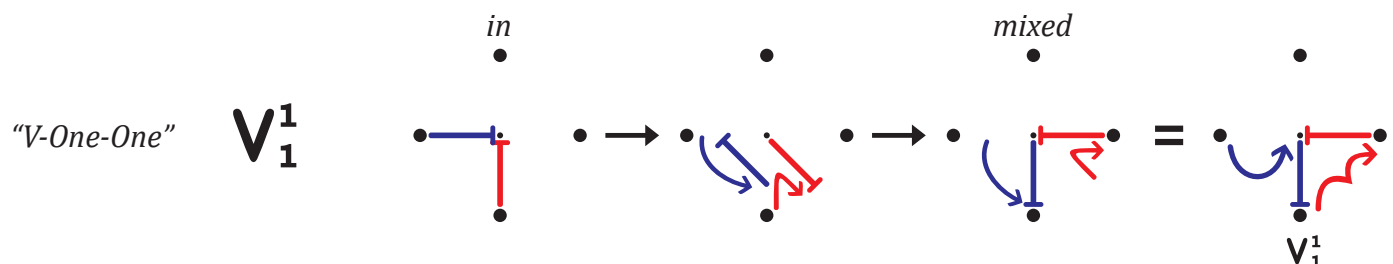
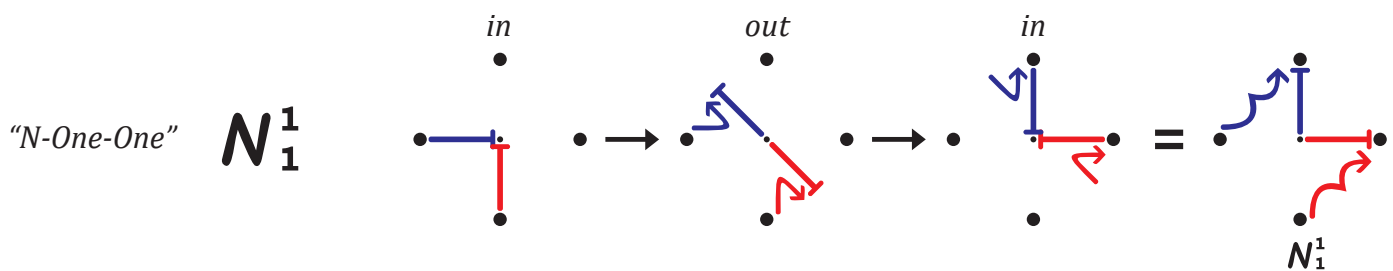
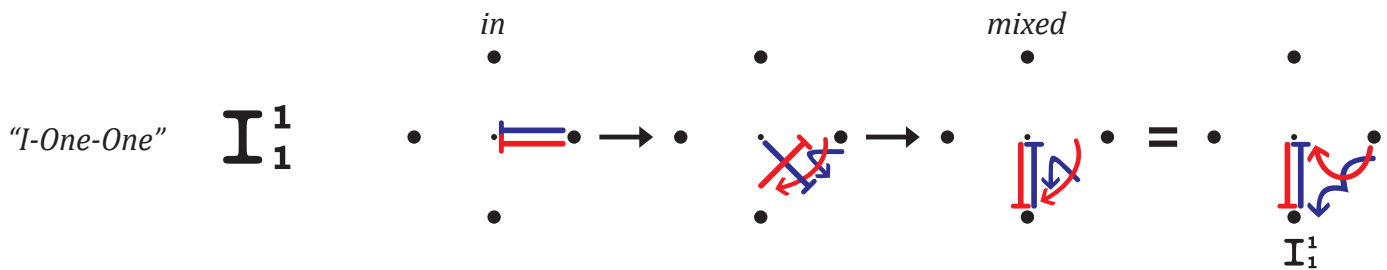
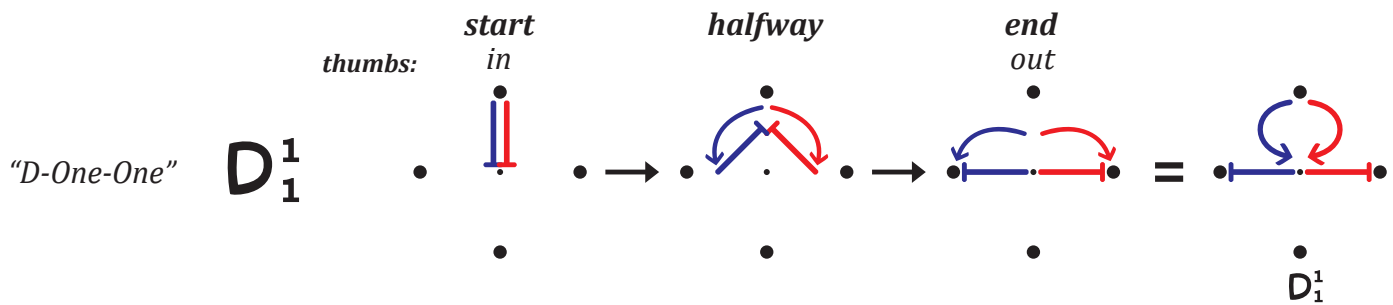
Next we'll look at dual-turns, in which both props are receiving a turn.

# 1 | 1 Turns

For a turn on both props, add a “1” in both the high and the low slot.  
This can also be written as 1|1.

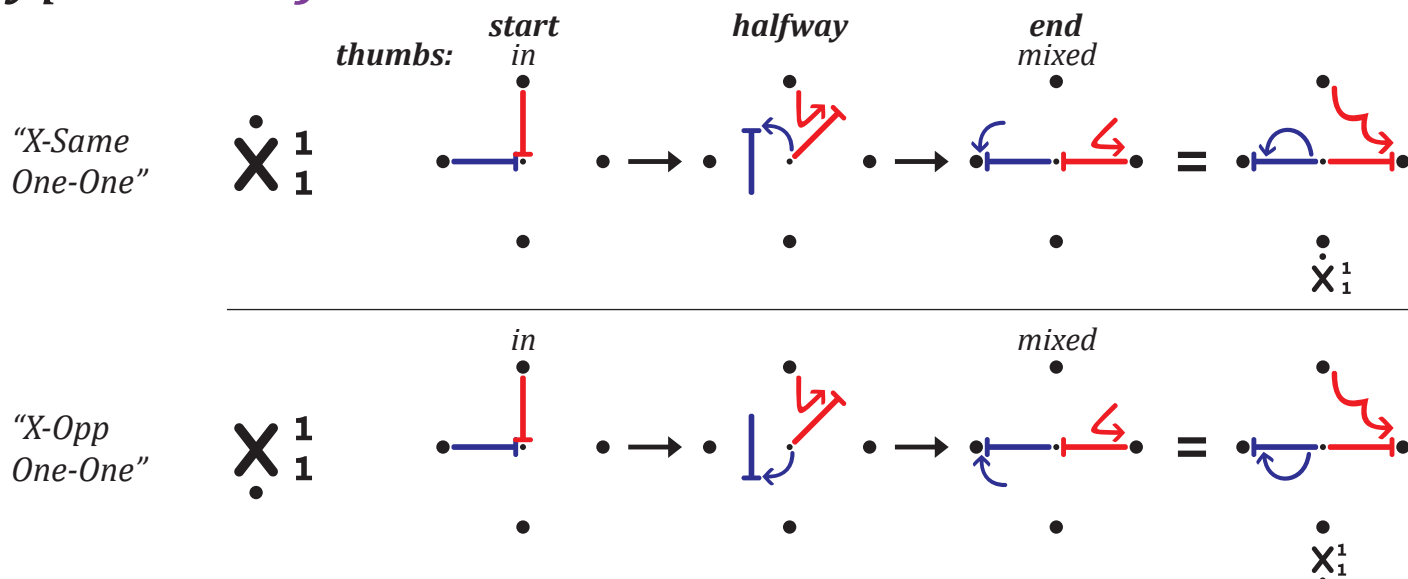
Here are some cherry-picked examples of 1|1 in each Type.  
Since you know all the mechanisms involved, explanation is kept to a minimum.

## Type 1 - Dual-Shift

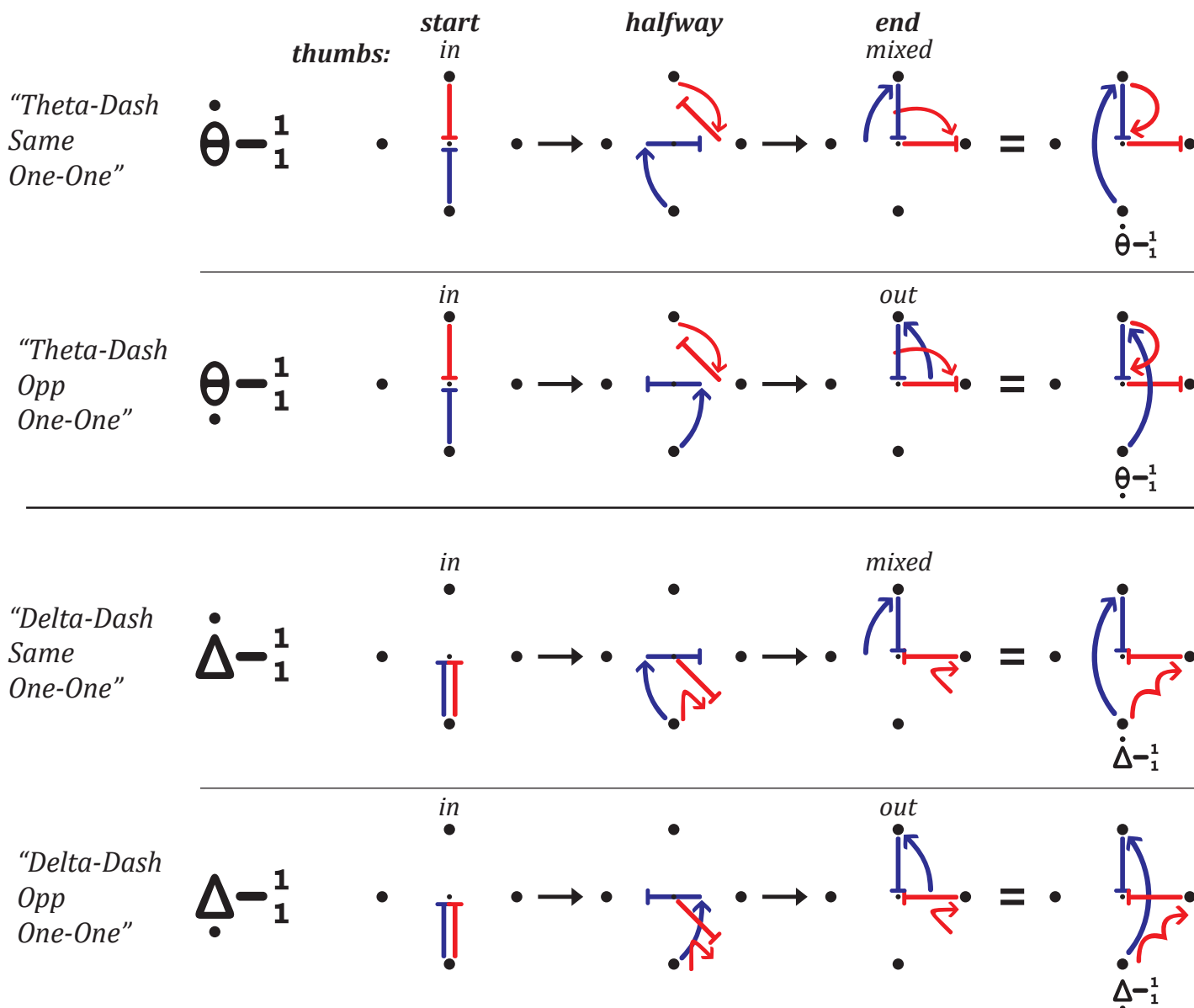


Pause at the halfway point of each motion while learning.  
This will ensure accurate timing.

## Type 2 - *Shift*

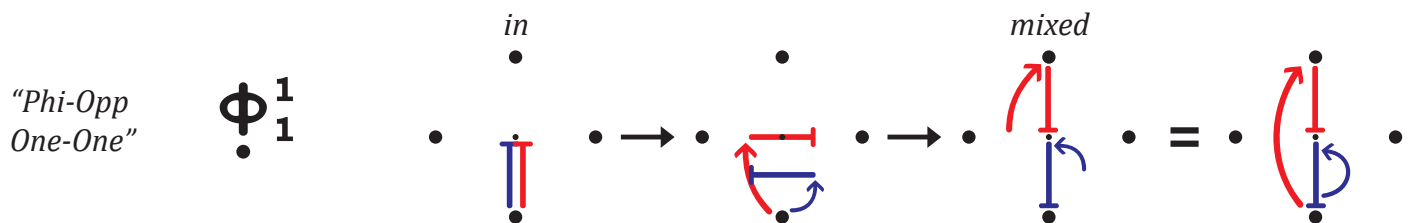
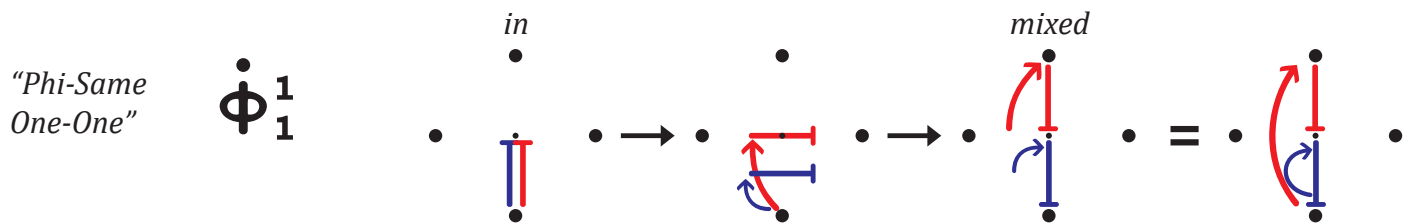


## Type 3 - *Cross-Shift*

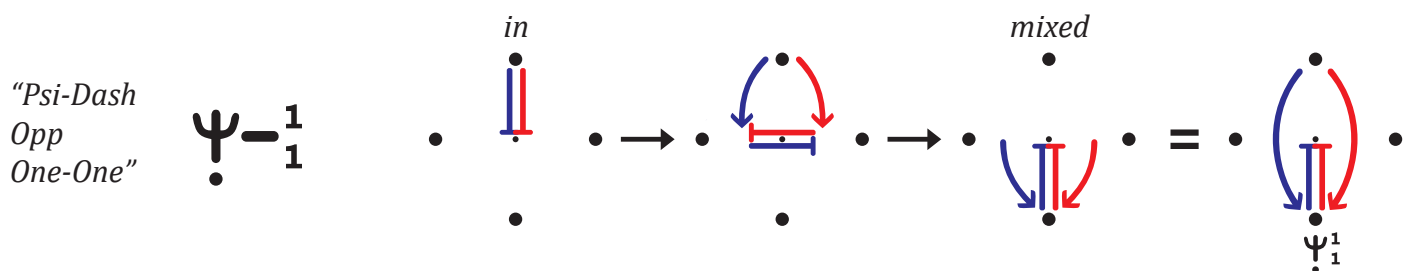
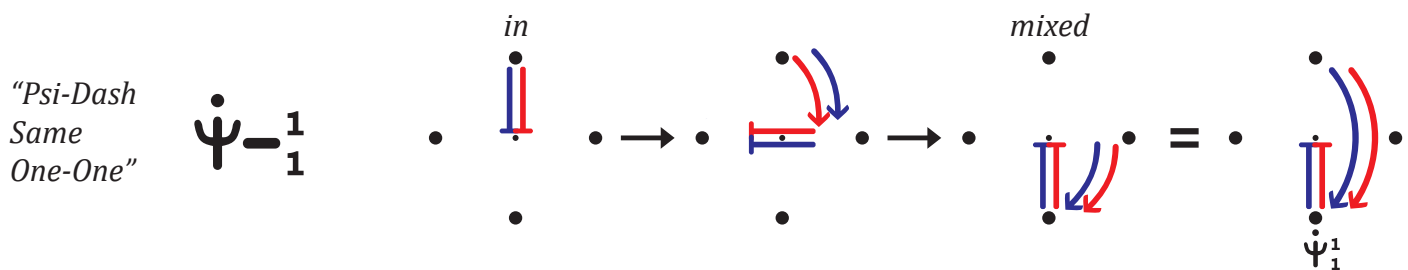




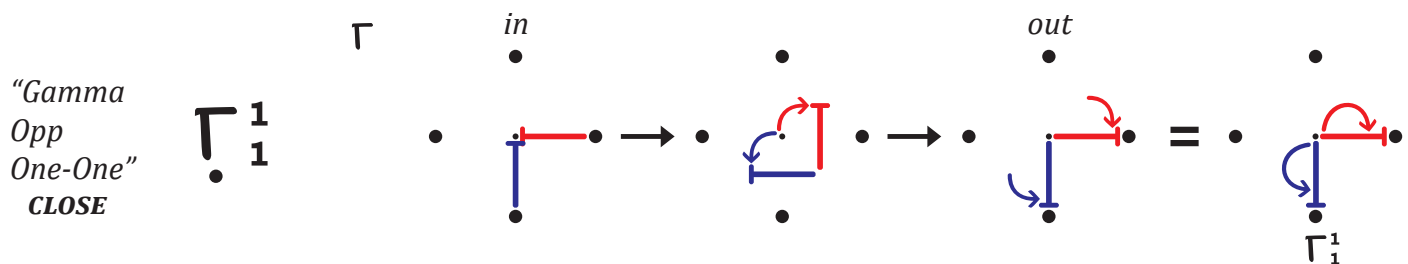
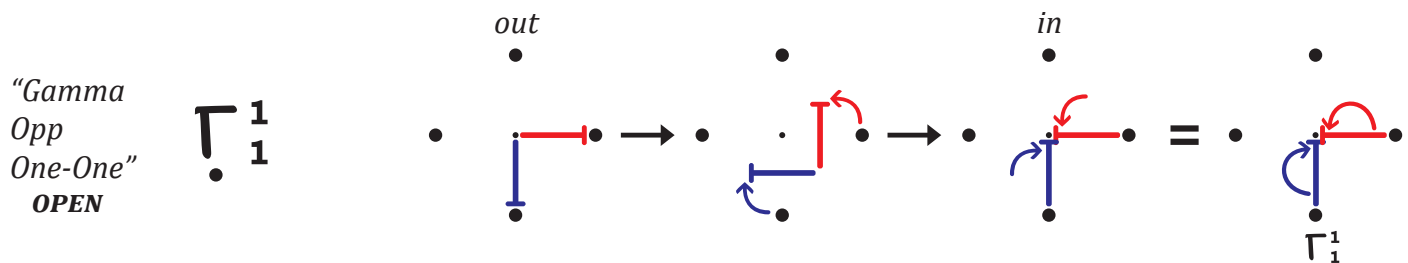
## Type 4 - *Dash*

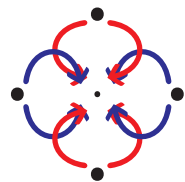


## Type 5 - *Dual-Dash*

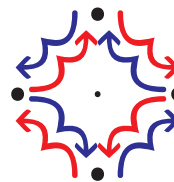


## Type 6 - *Static*

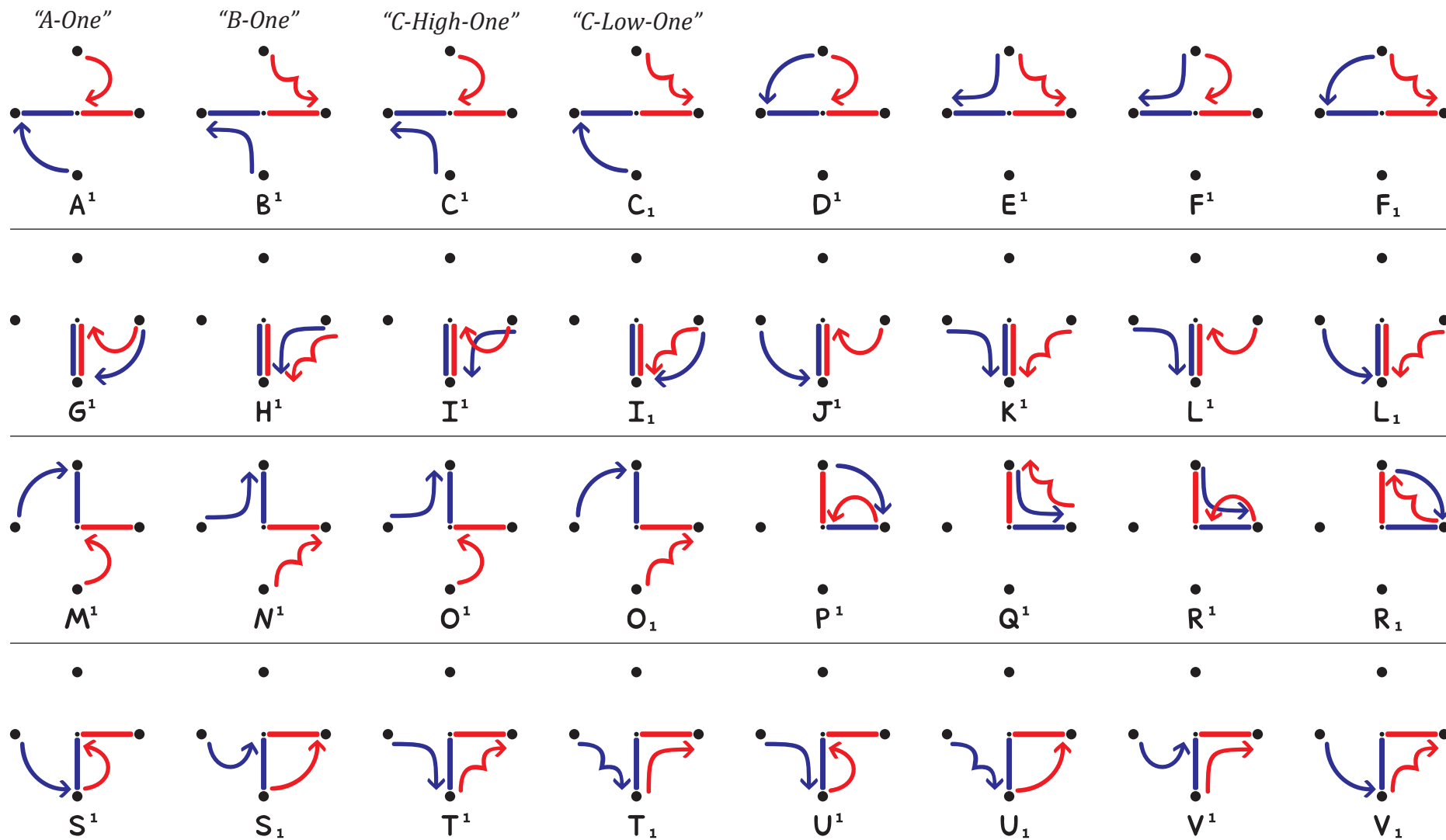


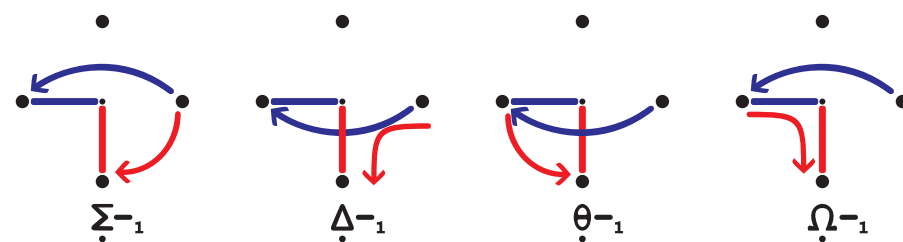
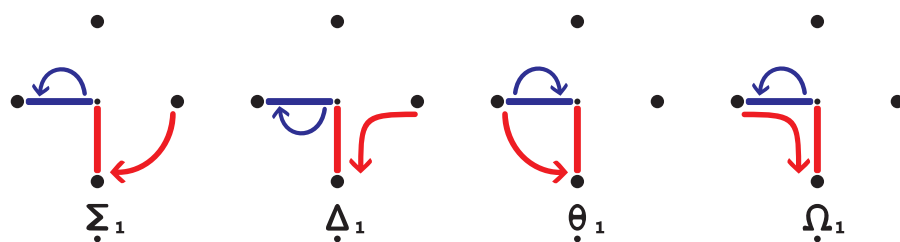
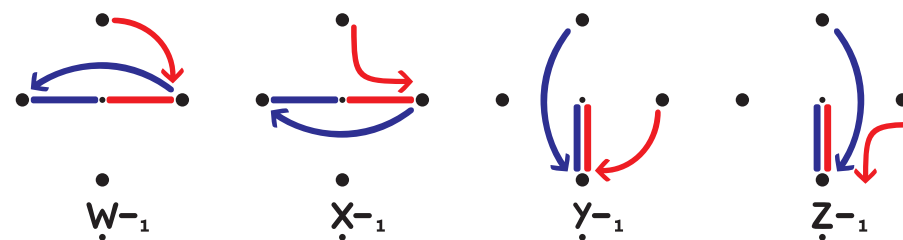
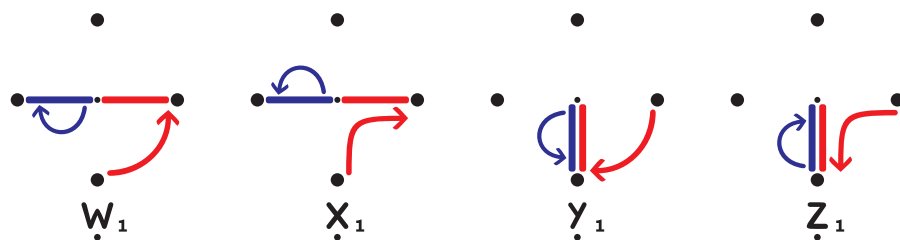
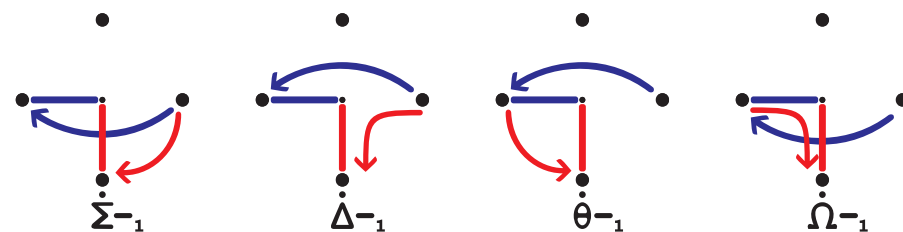
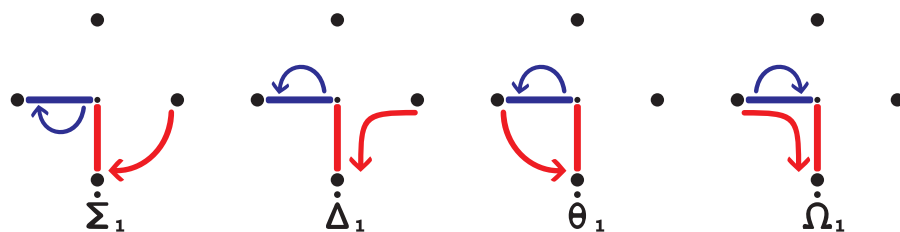
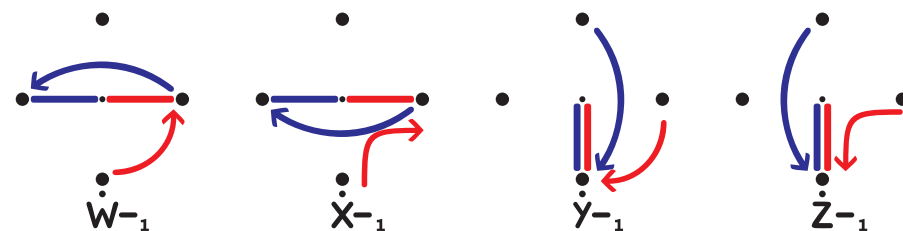
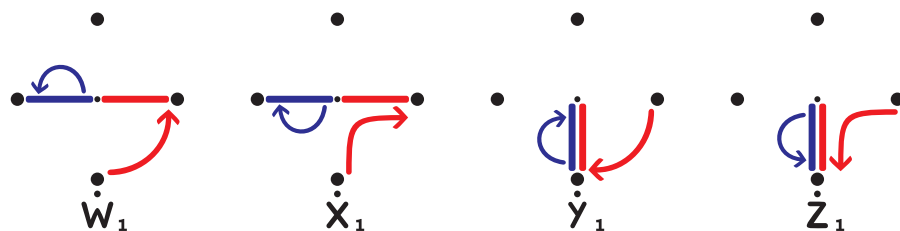


1 | 0



## Type 1 - Dual-Shift

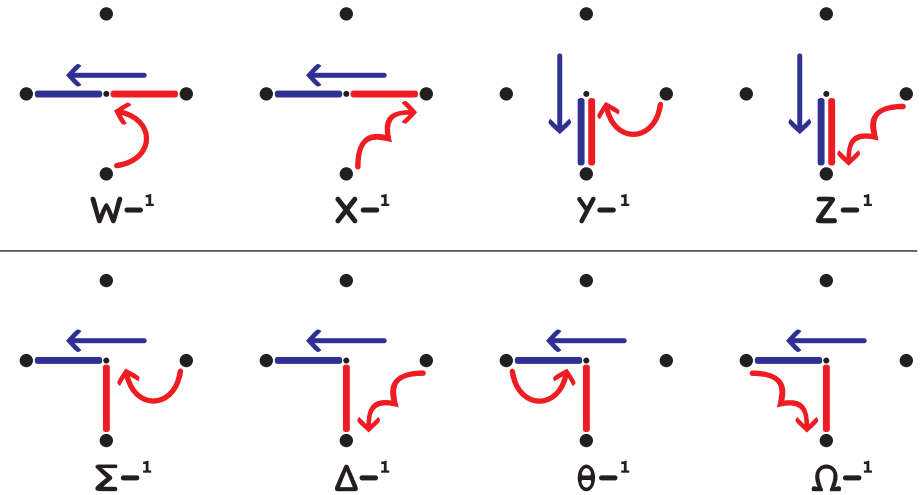
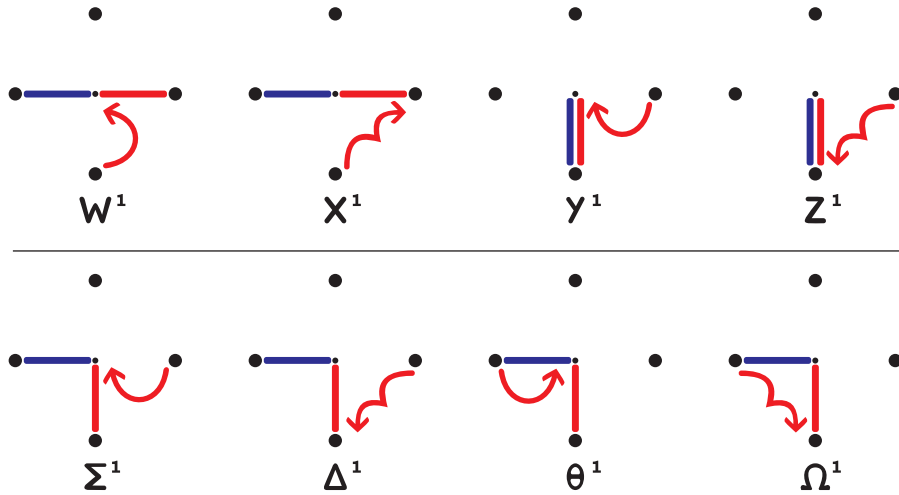


Type 2 - *Shift*Type 3 - *Cross-Shift*

Type 2 - *Shift*

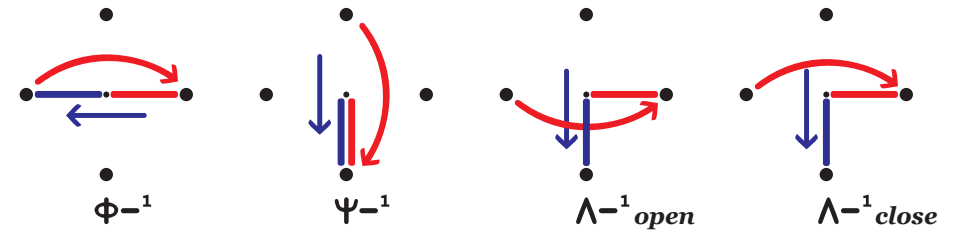
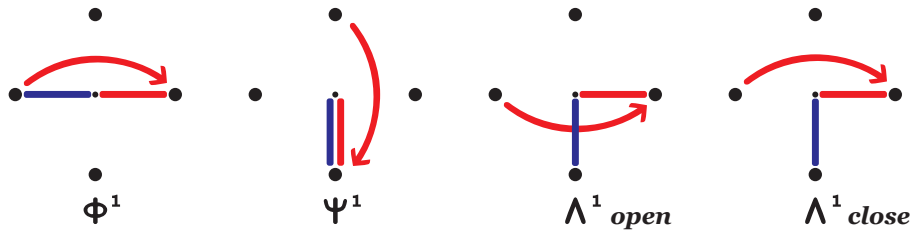
1 / 0

Type 3 - *Cross-Shift*



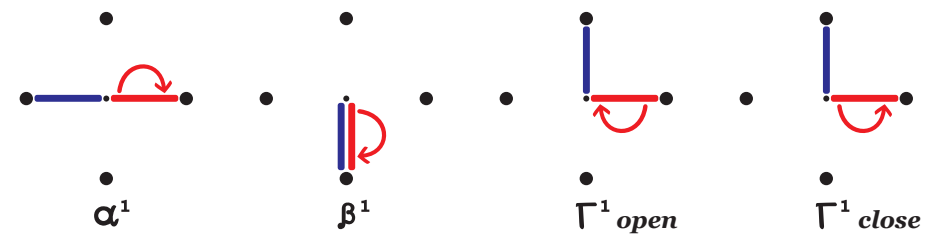
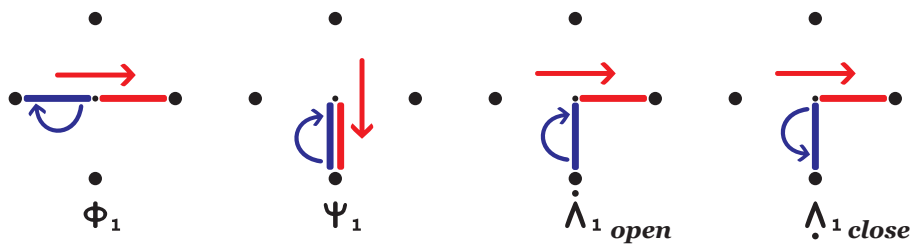
Type 4 - *Dash*

Type 5 - *Dual-Dash*



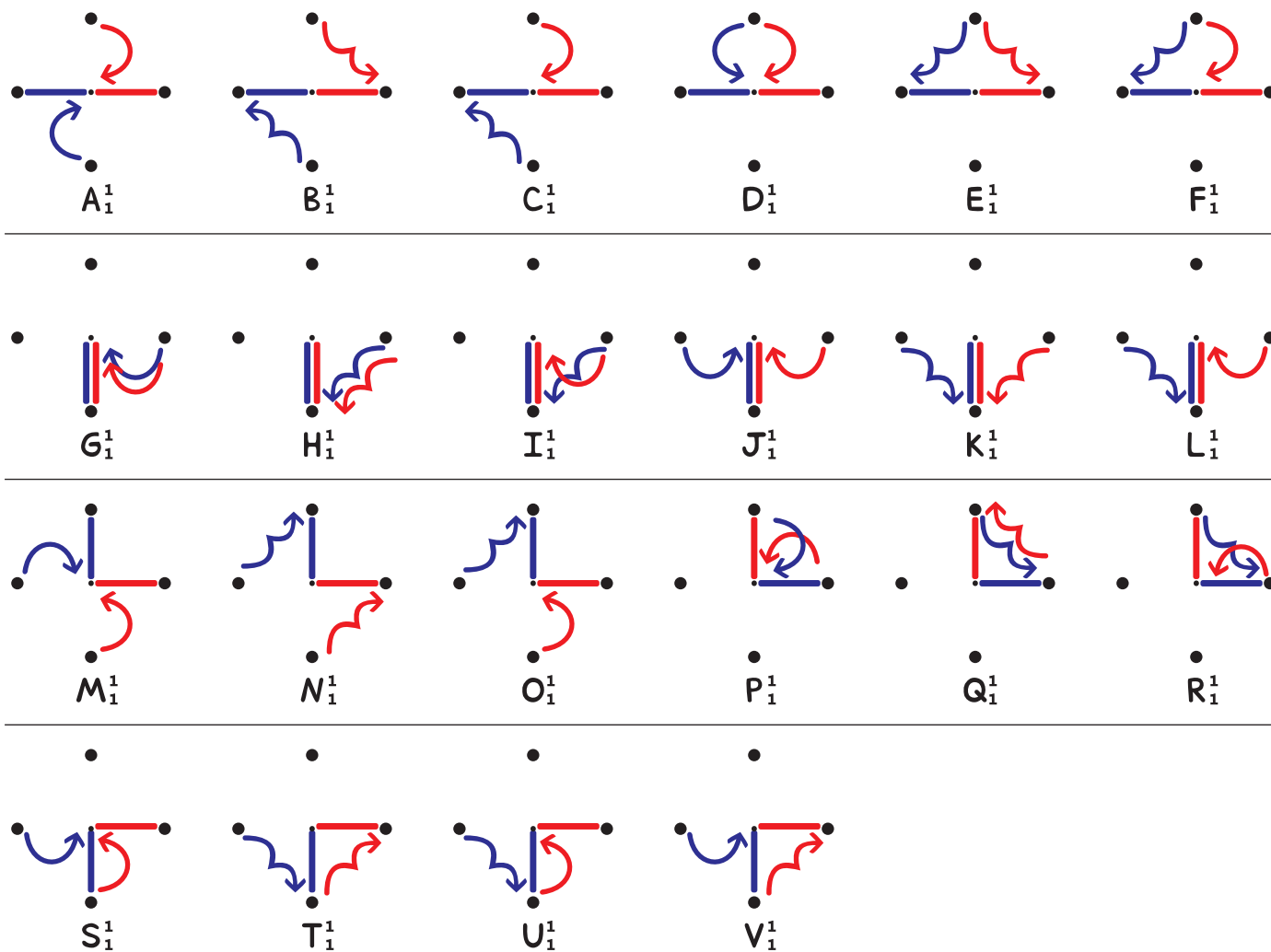
0 / 1

Type 6 - *Static*



# 1 | 1

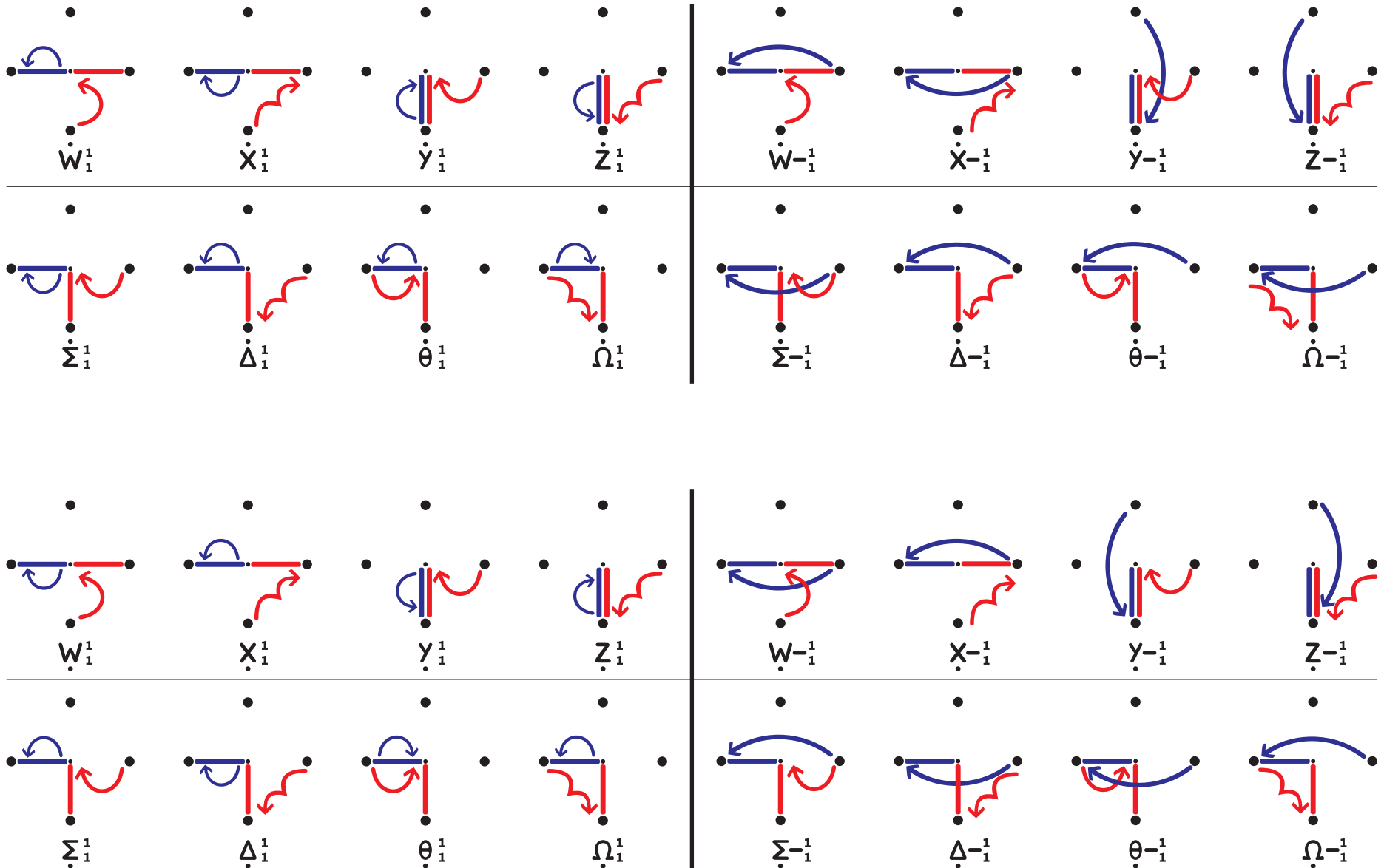
## Type 1 - Dual-Shift



1 / 1

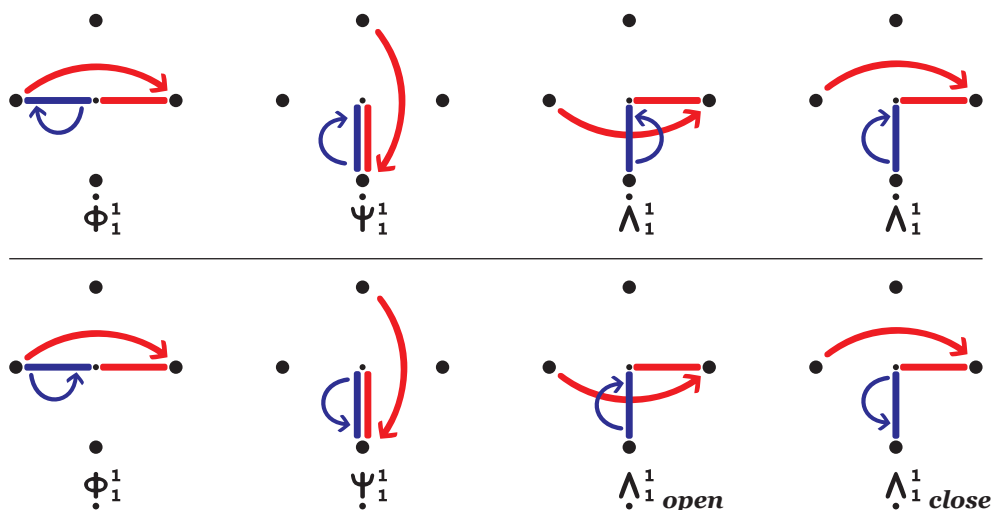
Type 2 - *Shift*

Type 3 - *Cross-Shift*

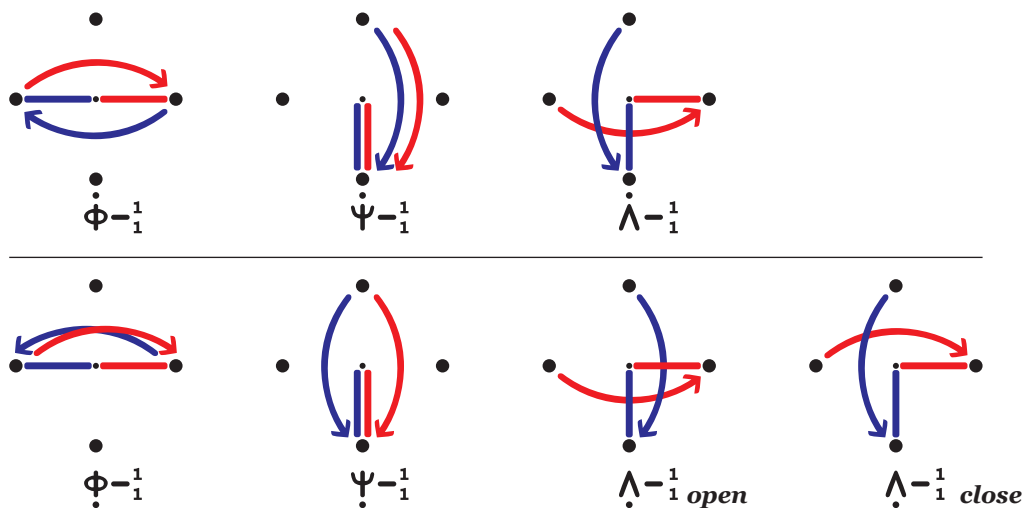


## Type 4 - *Dash*

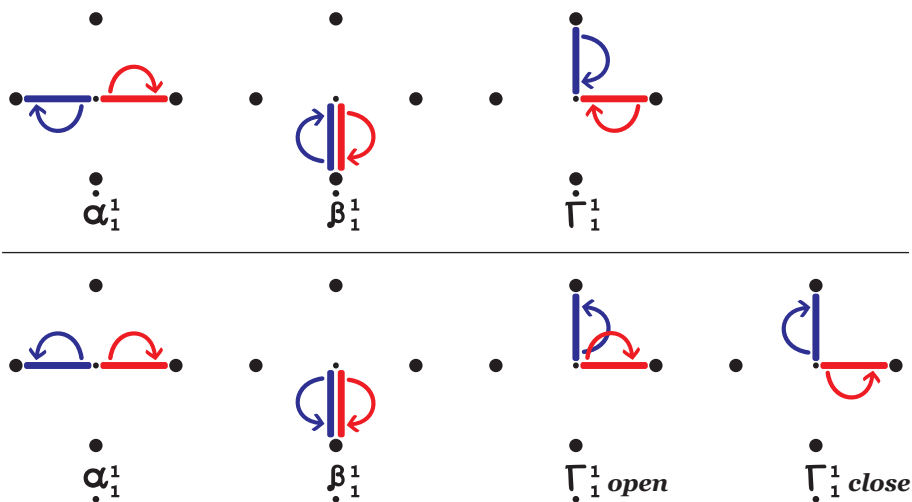
1 / 1



## Type 5 - *Dual-Dash*



## Type 6 - *Static*





# Double-Turns



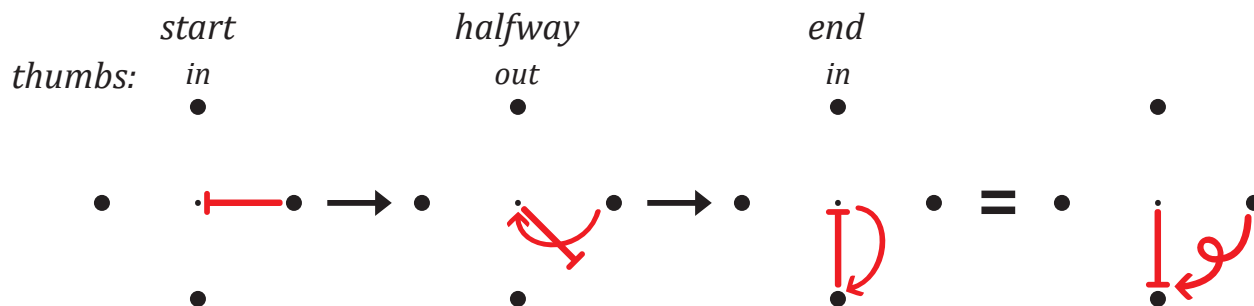
Double turns (indicated by a 2) add a 360 degree rotation to a motion.

## Shifts

VTG: 1:5

On a prospin with a double turn, note the 45° angle of the halfway position.

### Pro



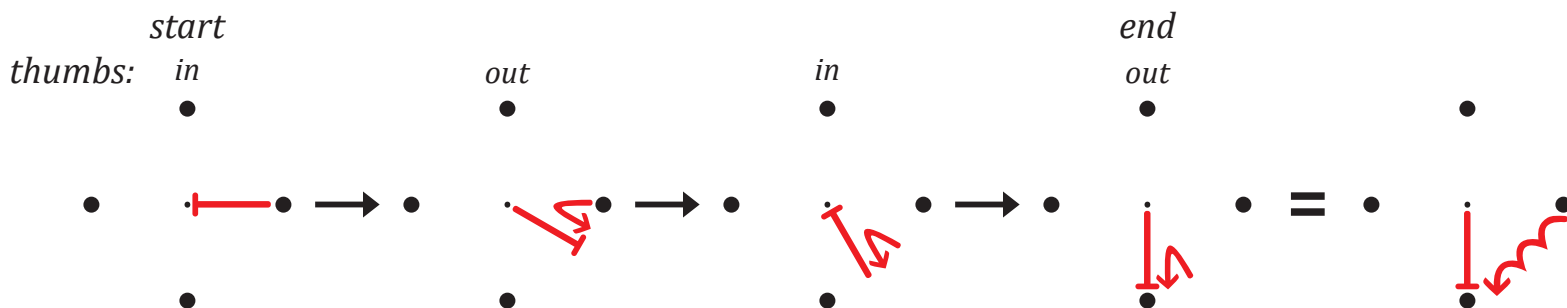
A base prospin (ASA isolation) has 0 thumb switches, therefore

**A prospin with 2 turns has 2 thumb switch (in → out → in)**

With a double-turning antispin, it's easier to visually conceive of the motion in thirds

At each third there is a staff end at the center point.

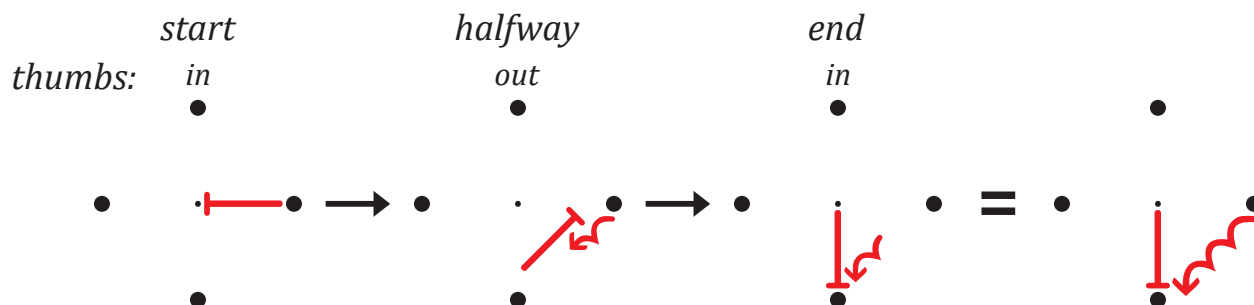
### Anti



A base antispin has 1 thumb switch. (in → out), therefore

**An antispin with 2 turns has 3 thumb switches (in → out → in → out).**

Here is the same motion broken in half:

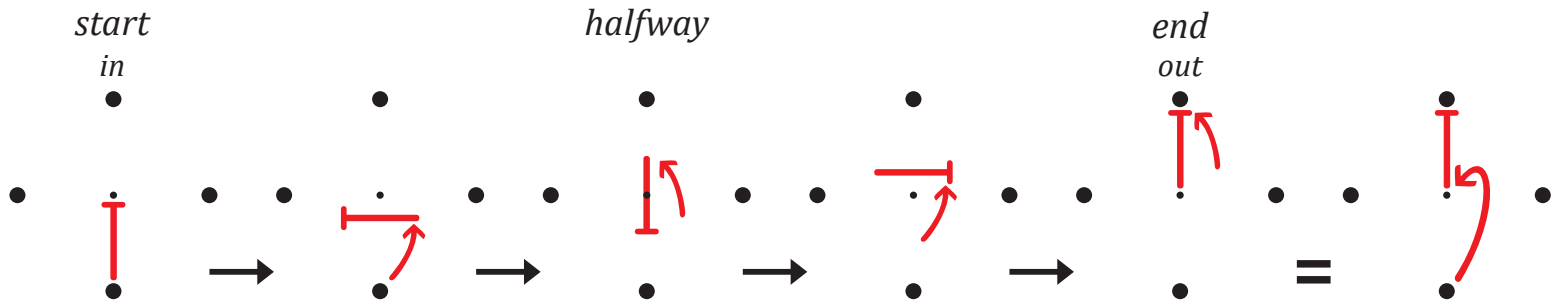




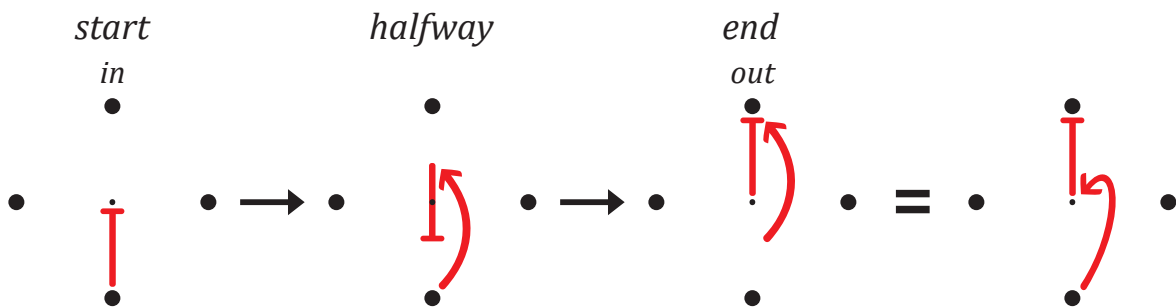
# Dashes

Now let's add a double turn to a dash.  
It's relatively complex, so we'll break it down into four parts.  
(These arrows refer to the pinky end on the first half,  
then to the thumb end on the second half.)

VTG: 2:1



As with all dashes, it's important to travel in a straight handpath even though the prop is rotating.  
Here is the same motion broken in half:



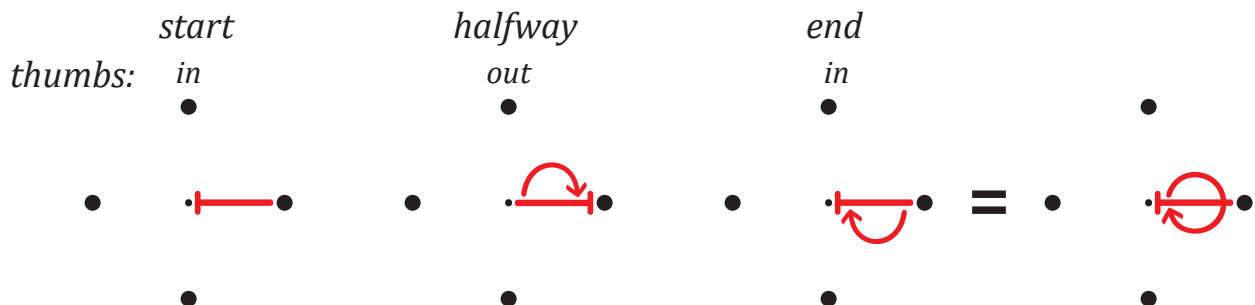
A base dash starting from thumb in ends with thumb out, therefore

**A dash with 2 turns also ends with thumb out. (in → out)**

**For a vertical dash such as this, you can use up/down as indicators. (up → down → up)**

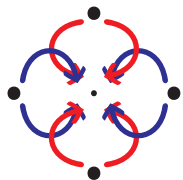
## Static

Finally, a static motion with 2 turns is simply a 360° turn in place.  
It's necessary to use negative space or a turn to achieve this.

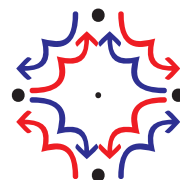


A static motion has 0 thumb switches, therefore

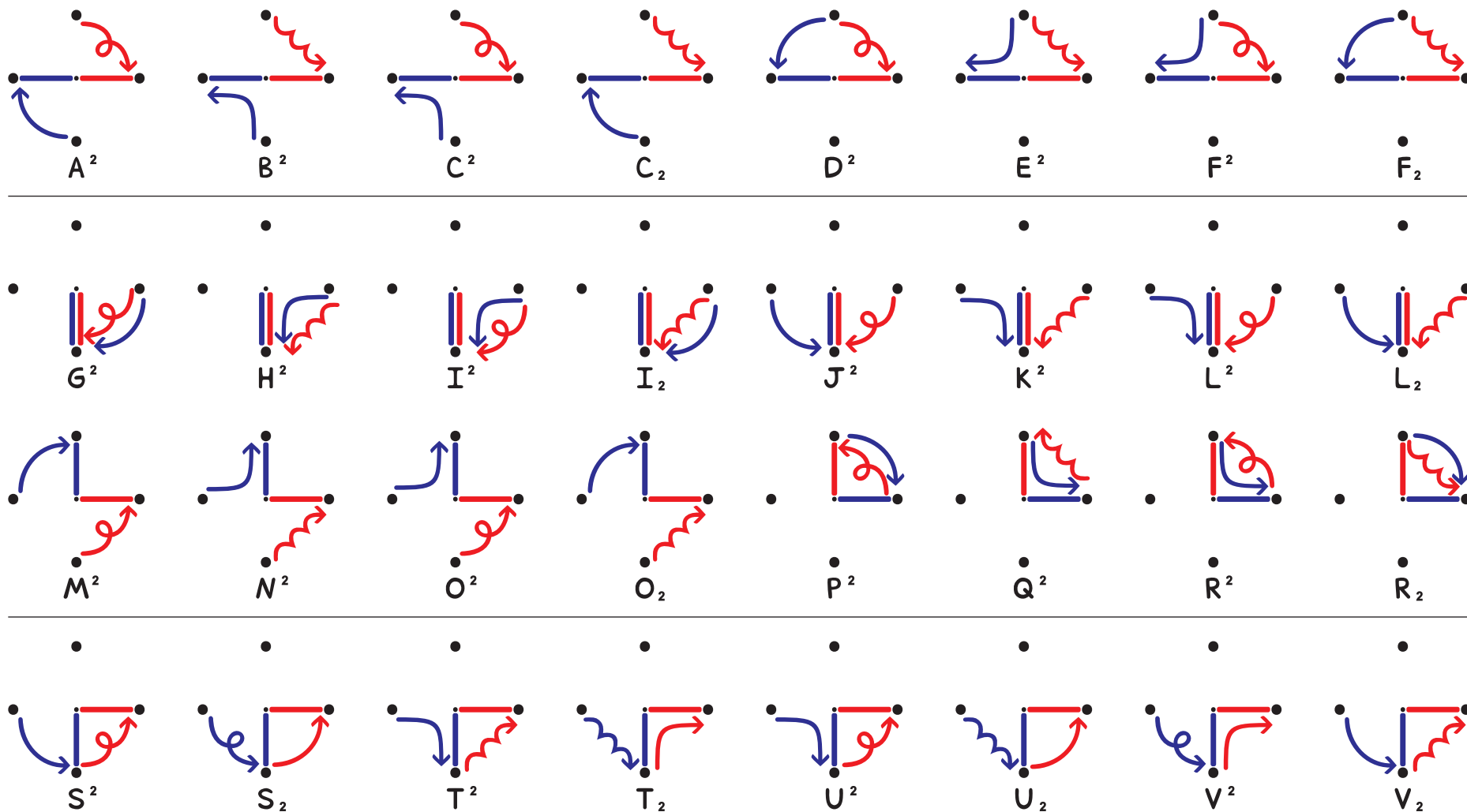
**A static motion with 2 turns has 2 thumb switches (in → out → in).**

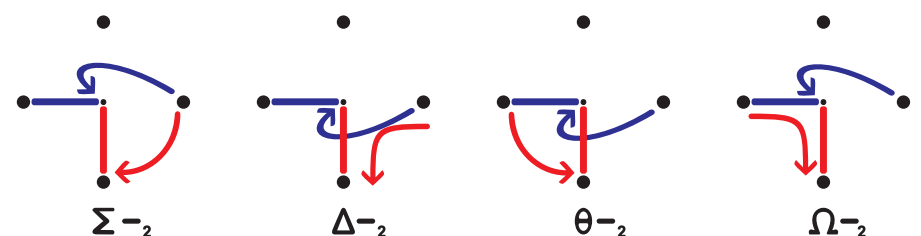
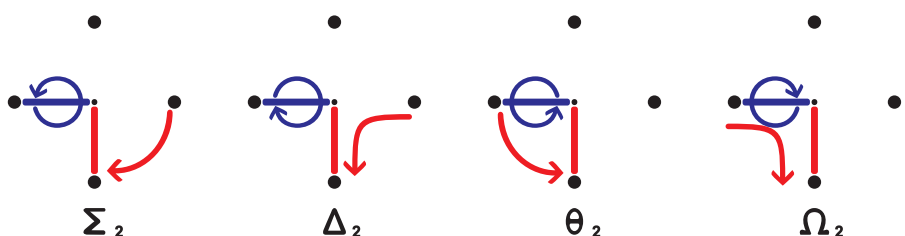
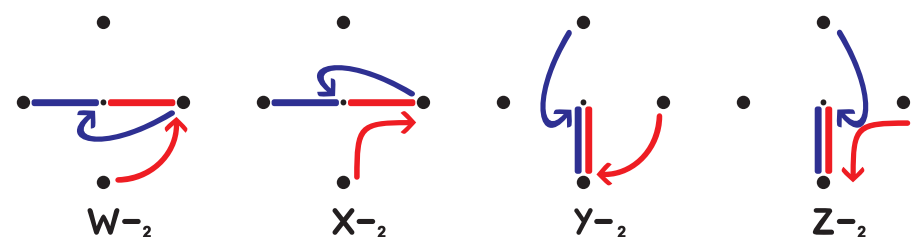
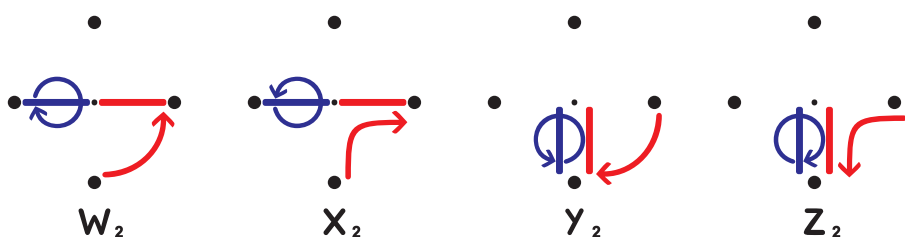
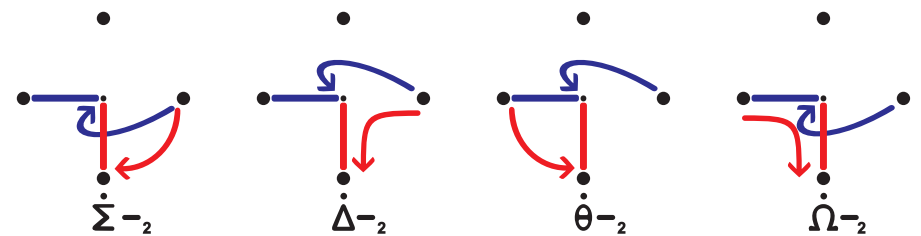
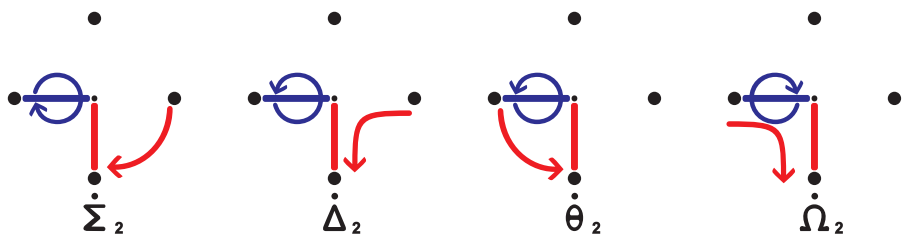
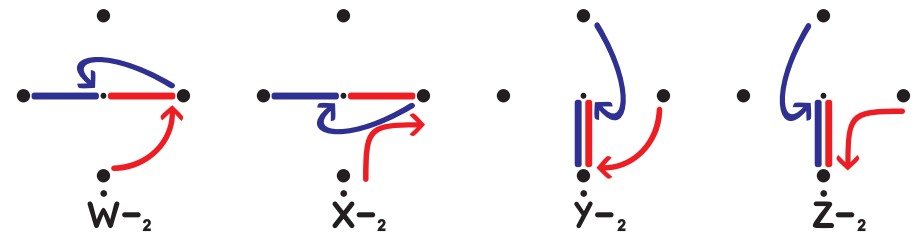
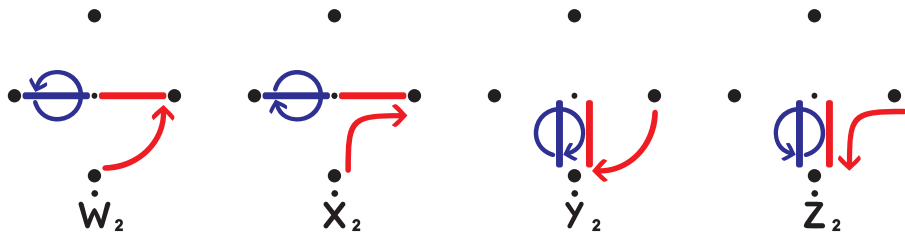


2 | 0



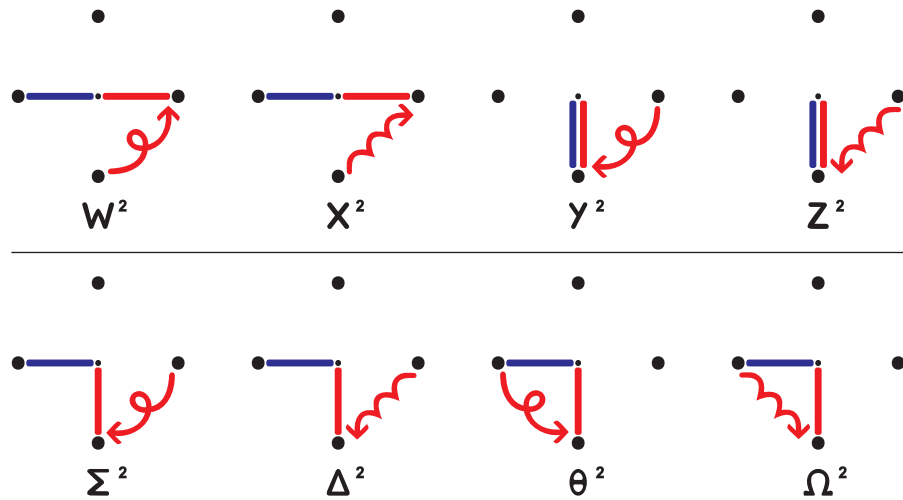
# Type 1 - Dual-Shift



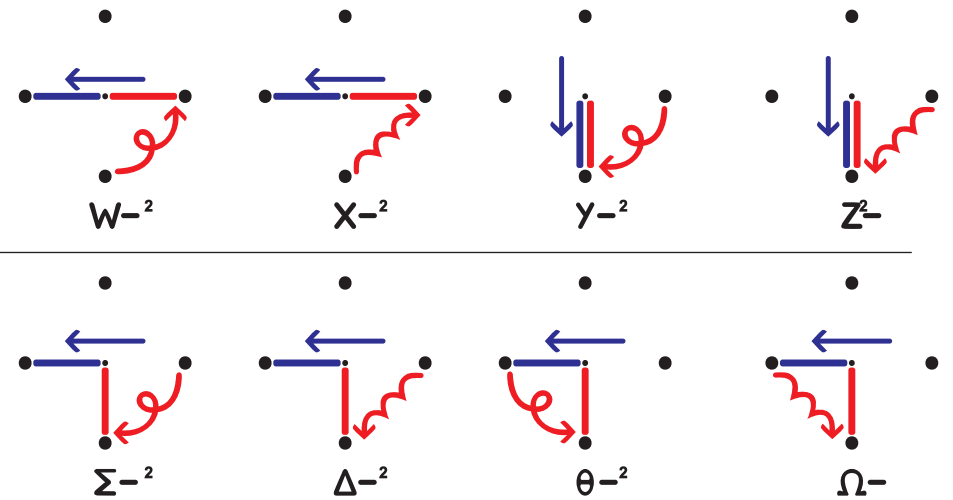
Type 2 - *Shift*Type 3 - *Cross-Shift*

2 / 0

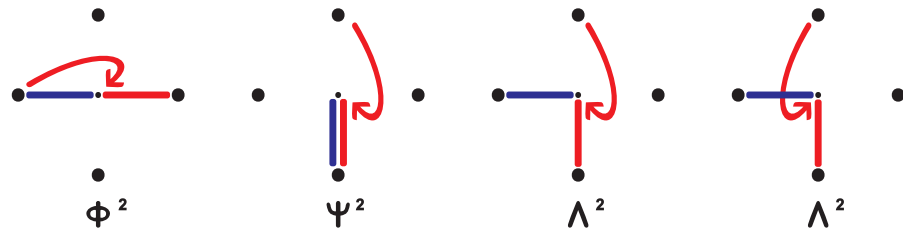
Type 2 - *Shift*



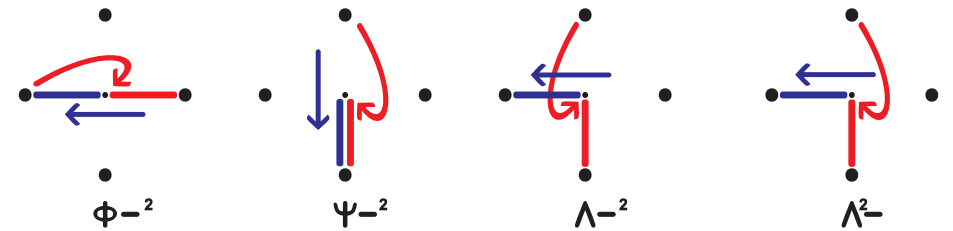
Type 3 - *Cross-Shift*



Type 4 - *Dash*

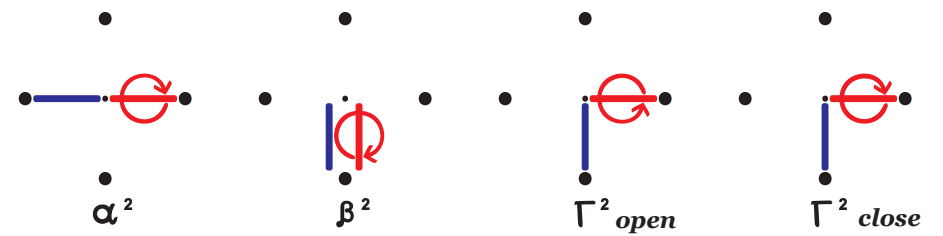
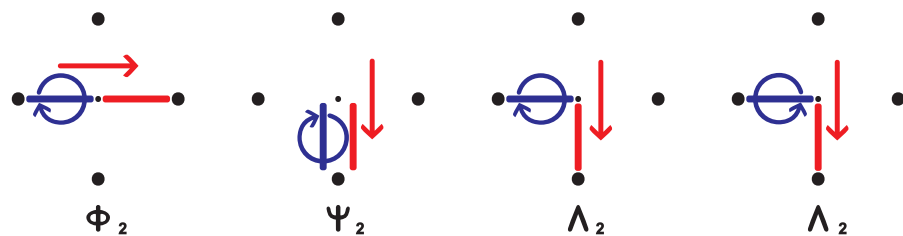


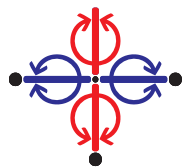
Type 5 - *Dual-Dash*



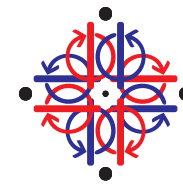
0 / 2

Type 6 - *Static*

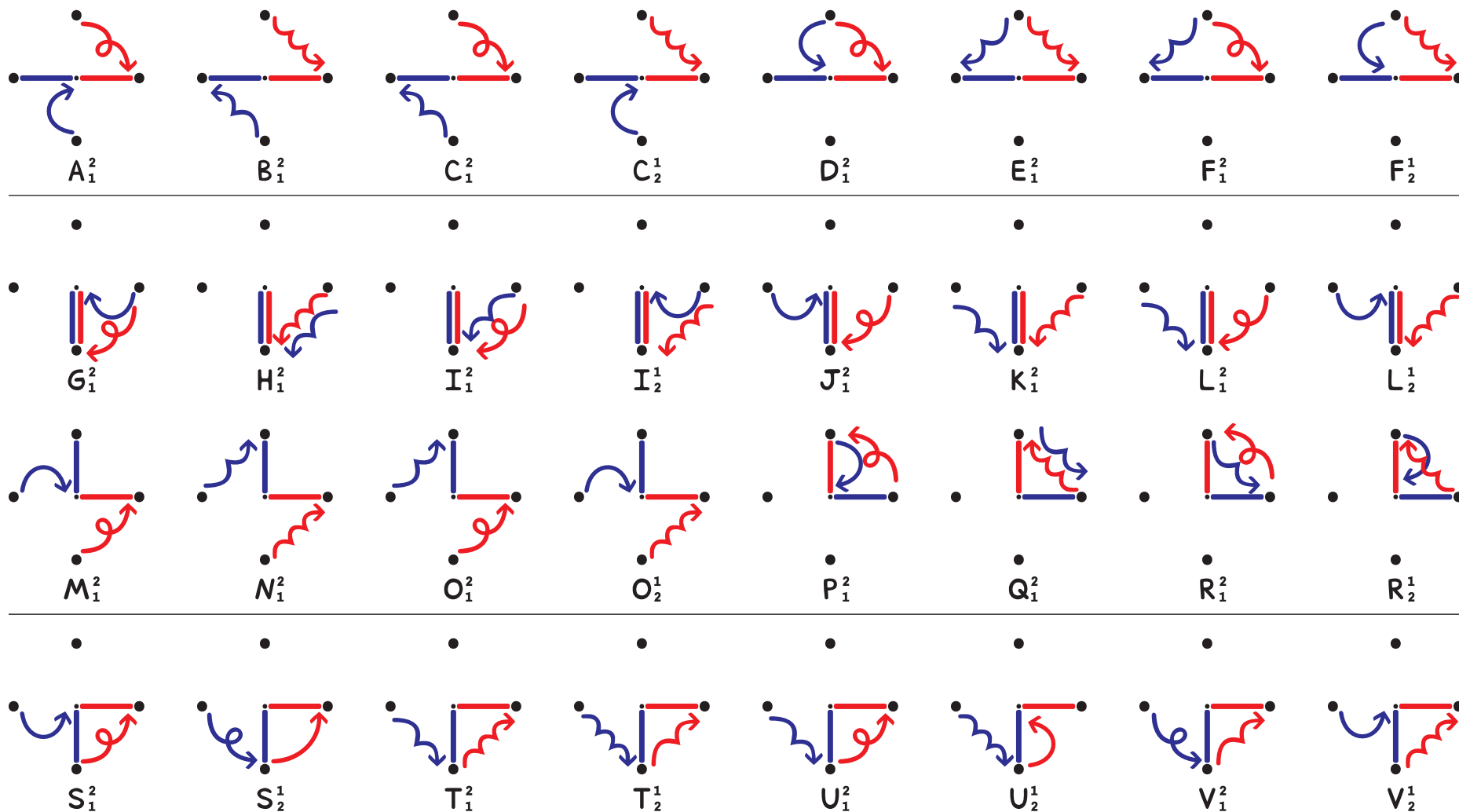




2 | 1

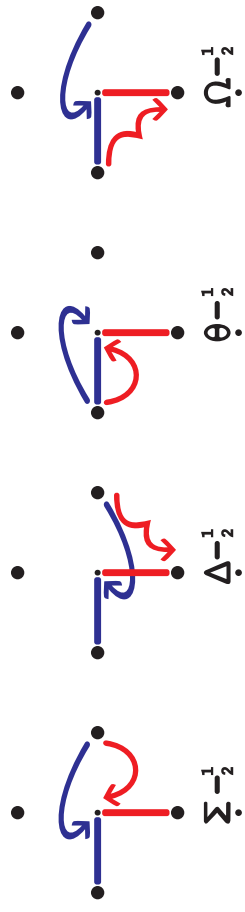
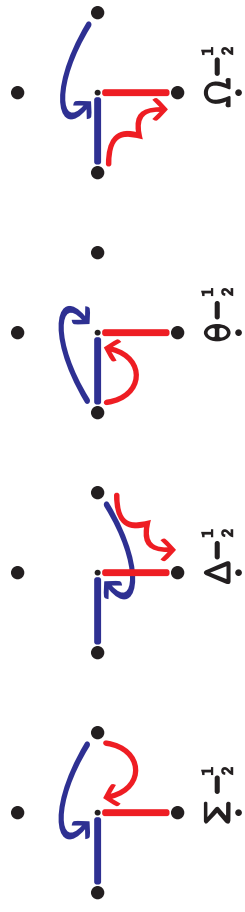
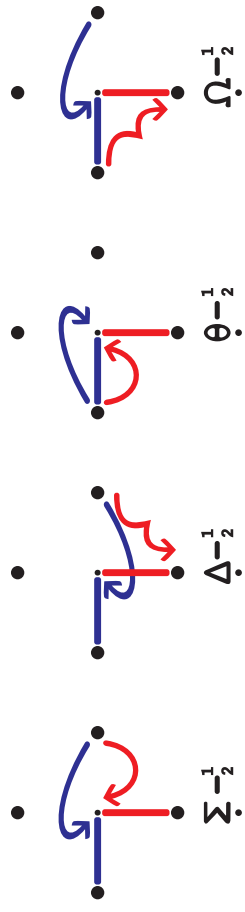
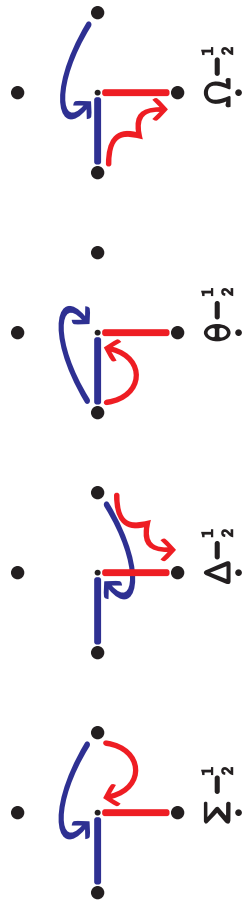
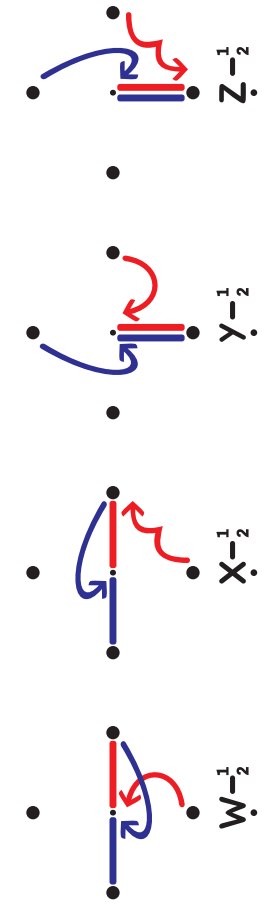
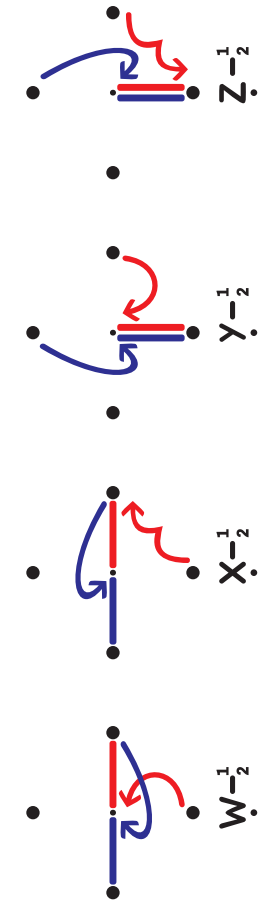
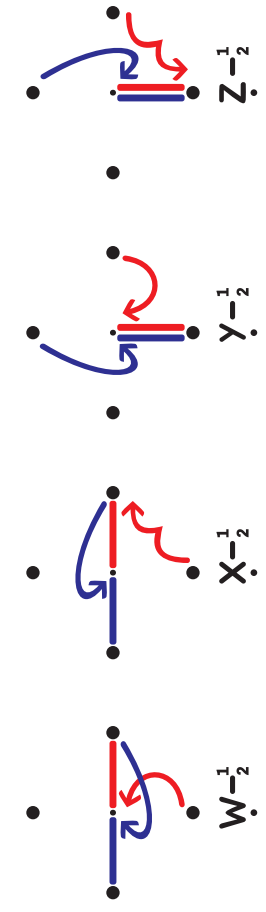
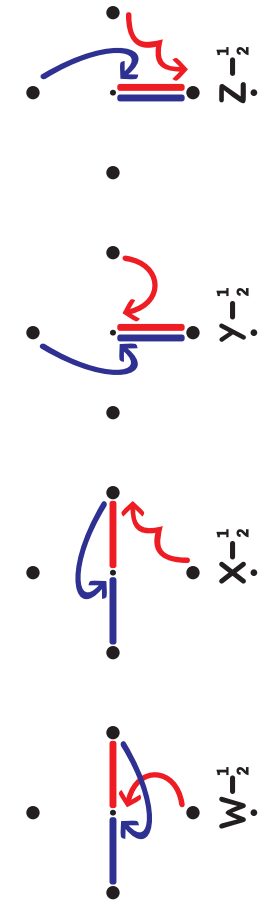
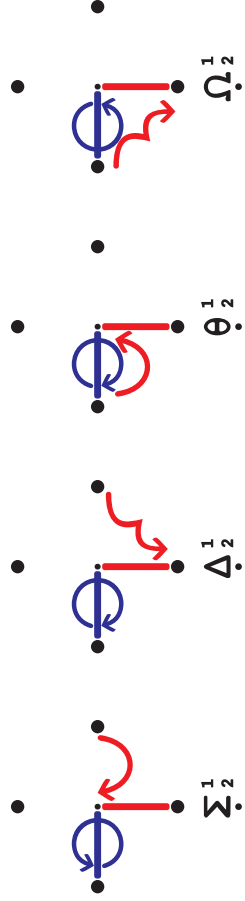
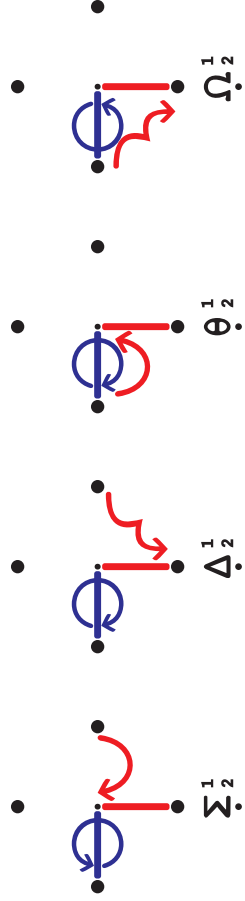
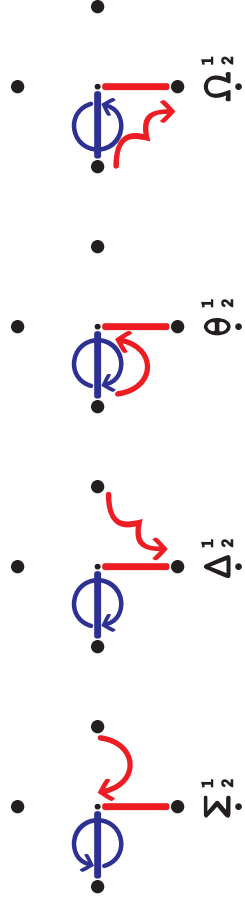
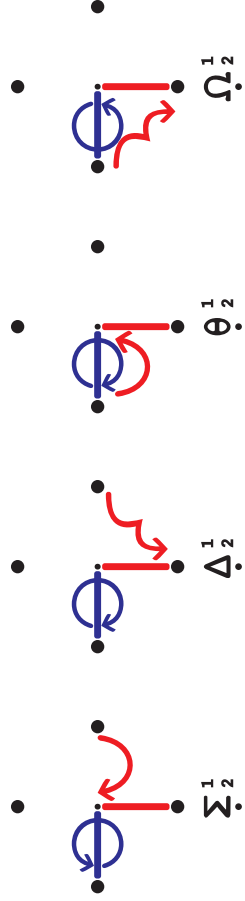
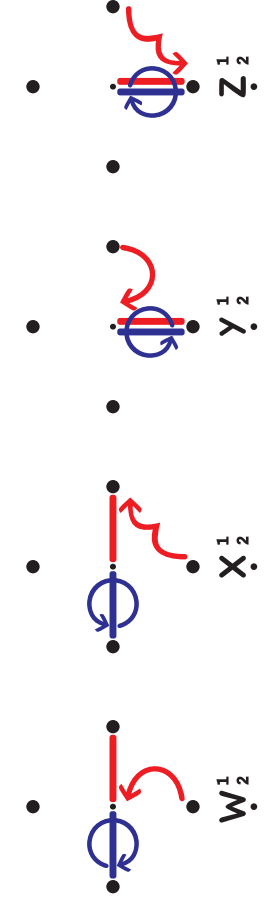
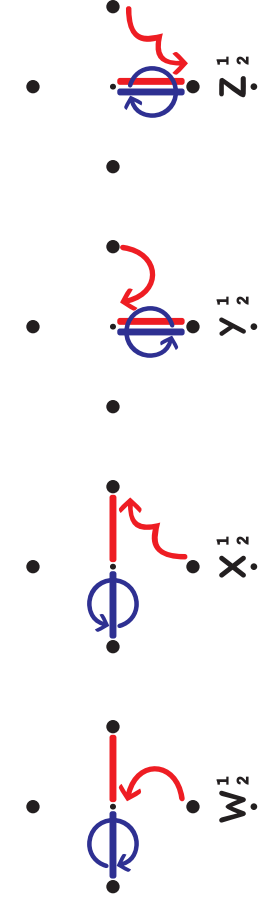
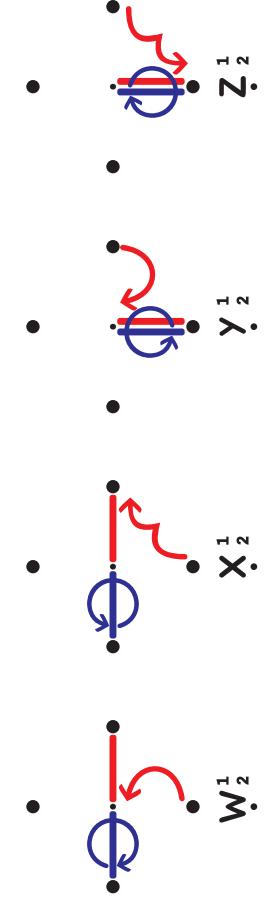
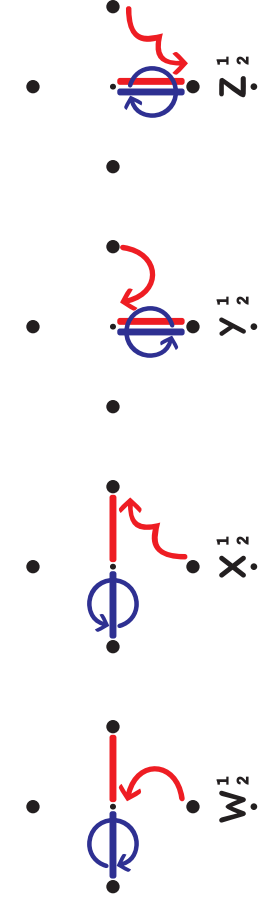
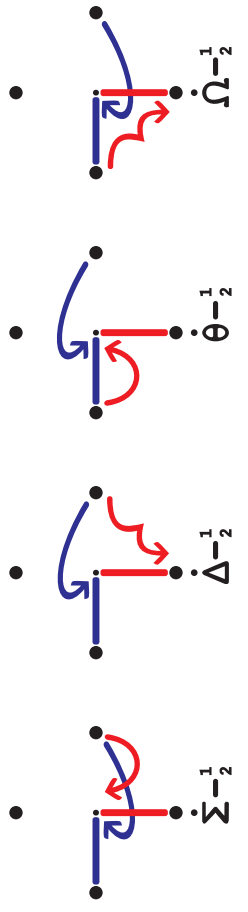
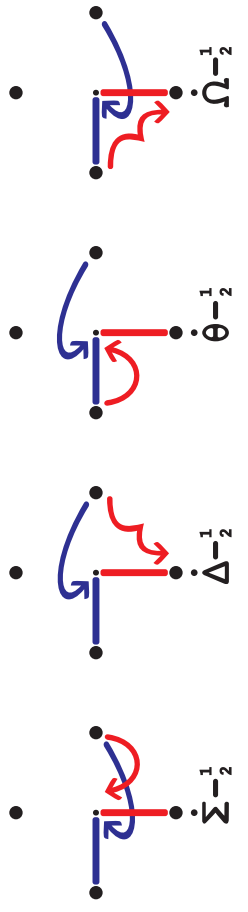
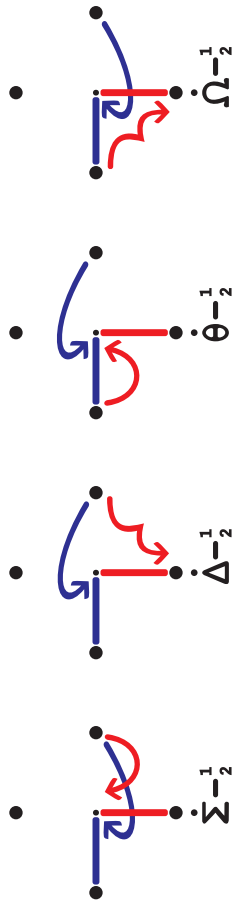
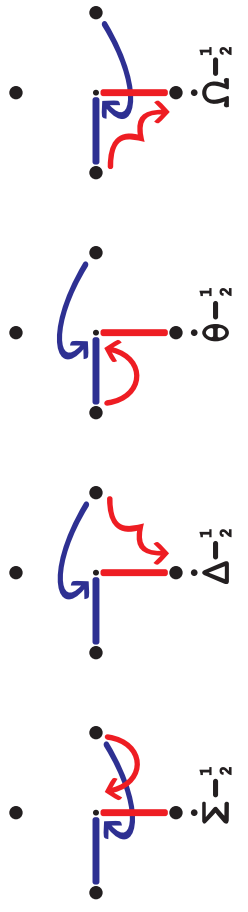
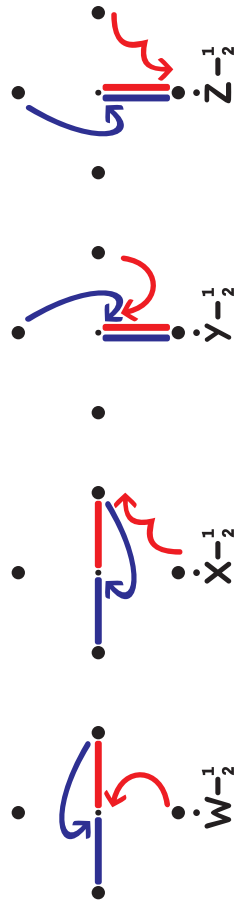
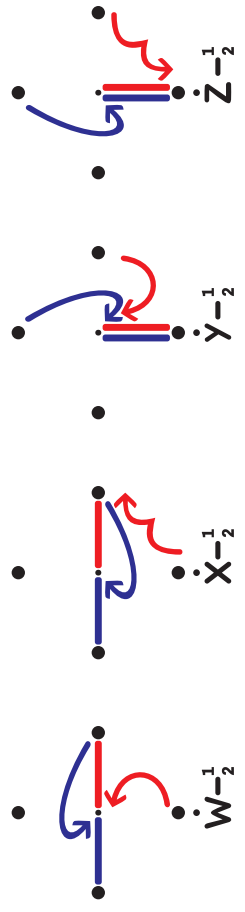
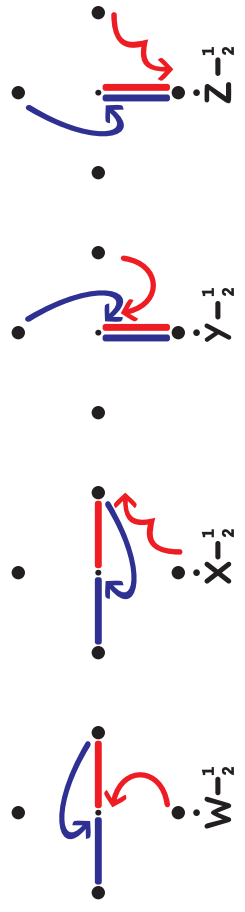
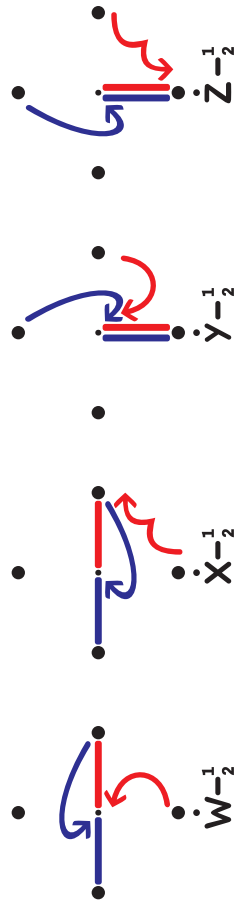
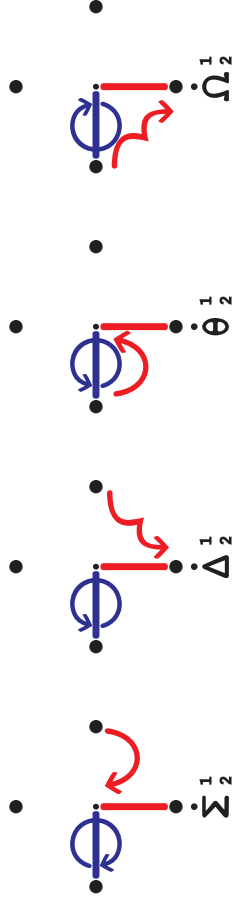
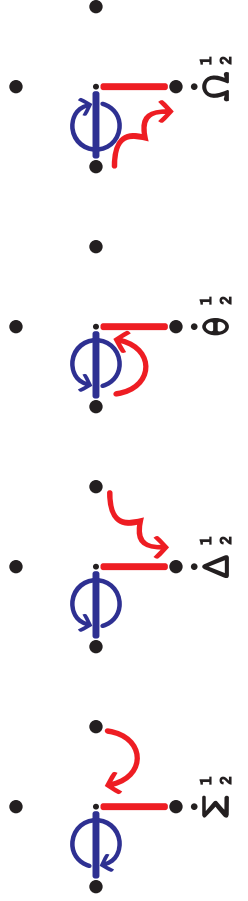
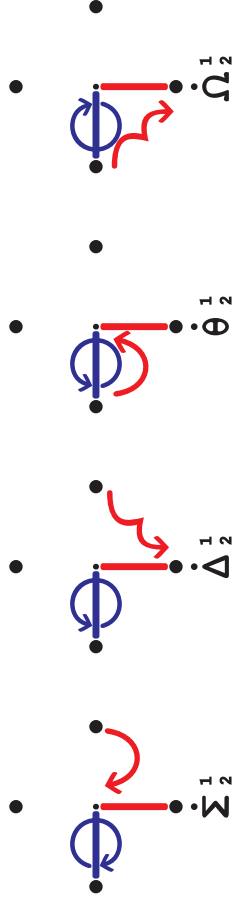
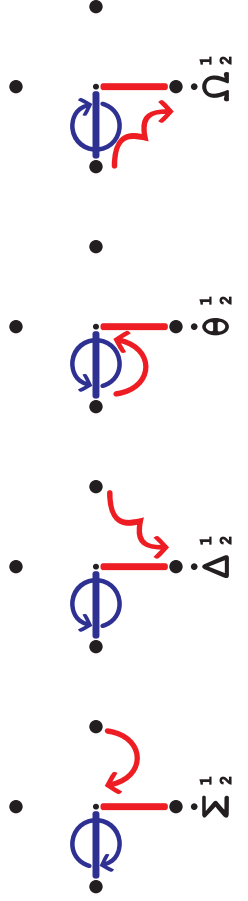
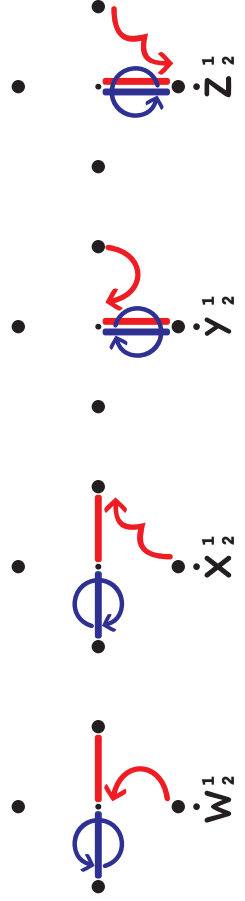
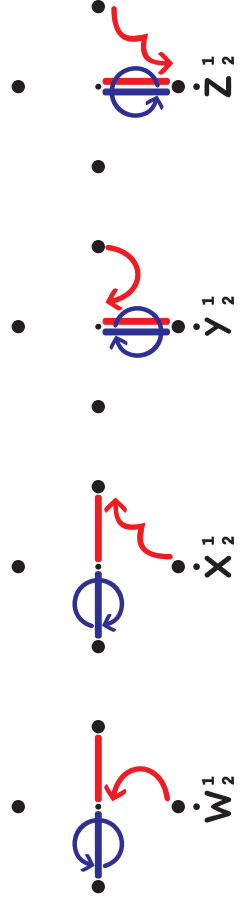
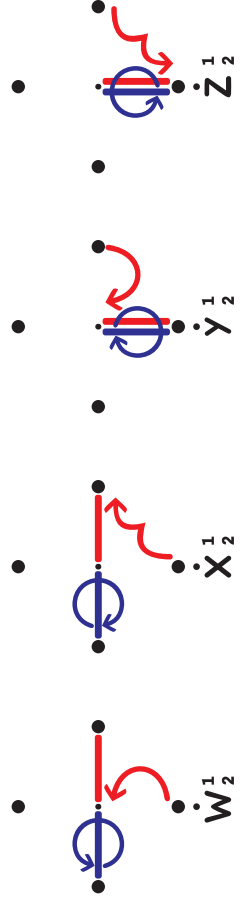
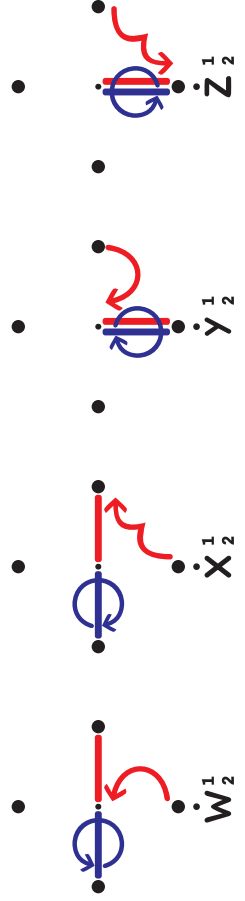


# Type 1 - Dual-Shift



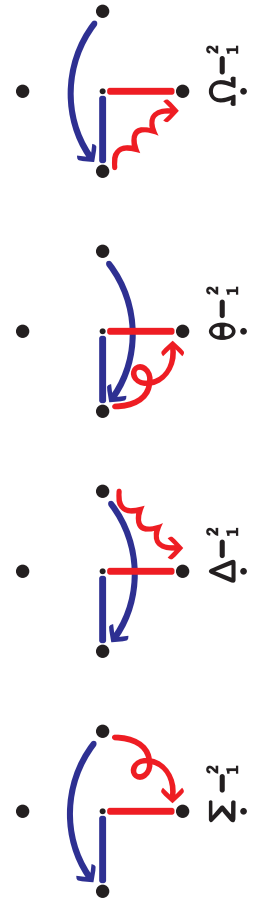
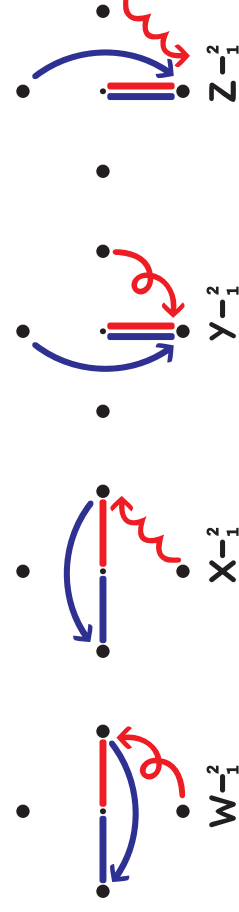
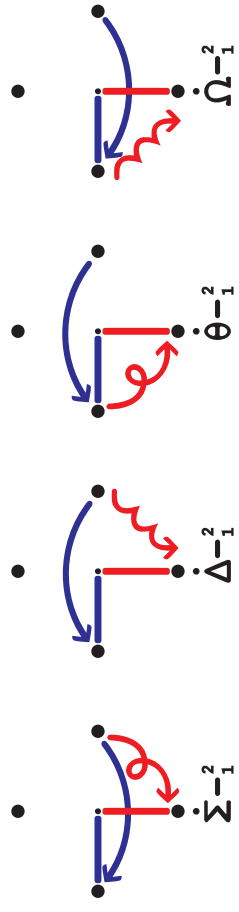
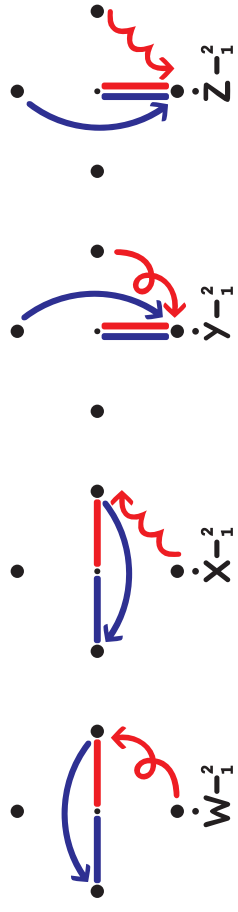
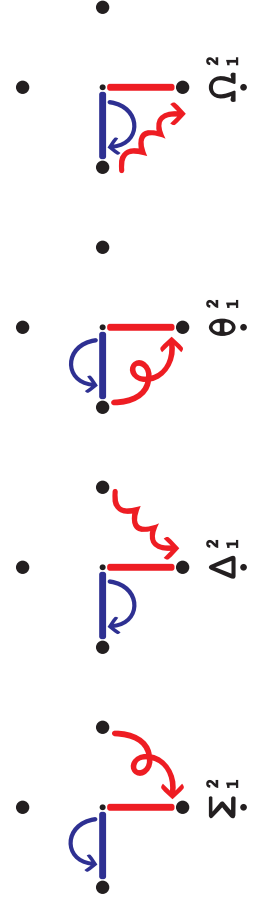
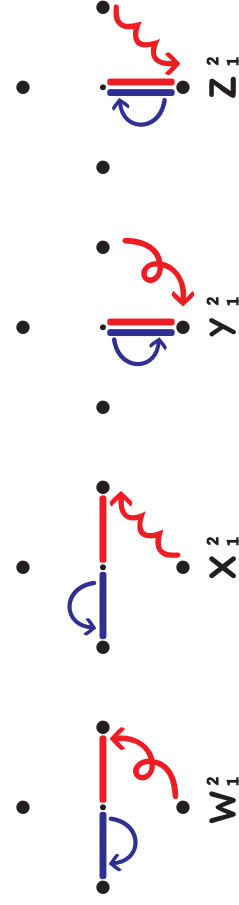
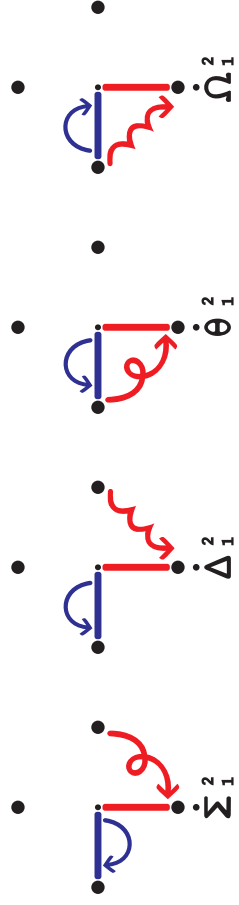
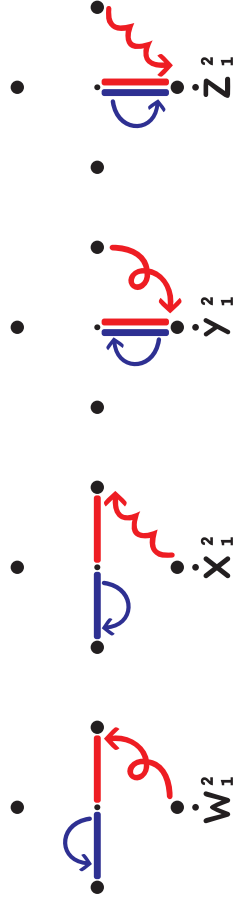
# Type 2 - Shift

# Type 3 - Cross-Shift

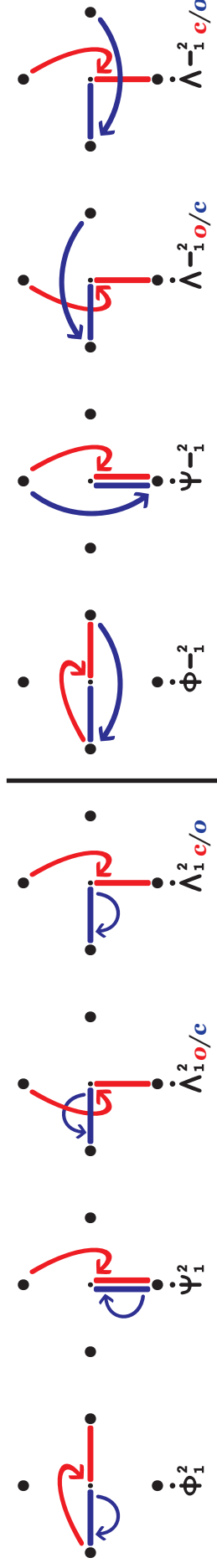


## Type 2 - Shift

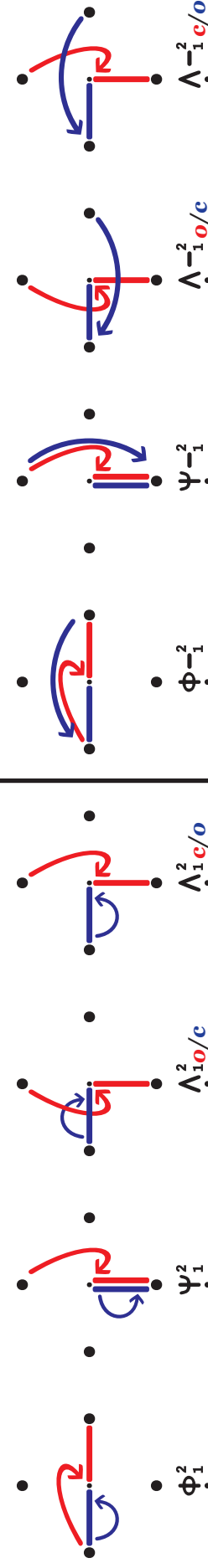
## Type 3 - Cross-Shift



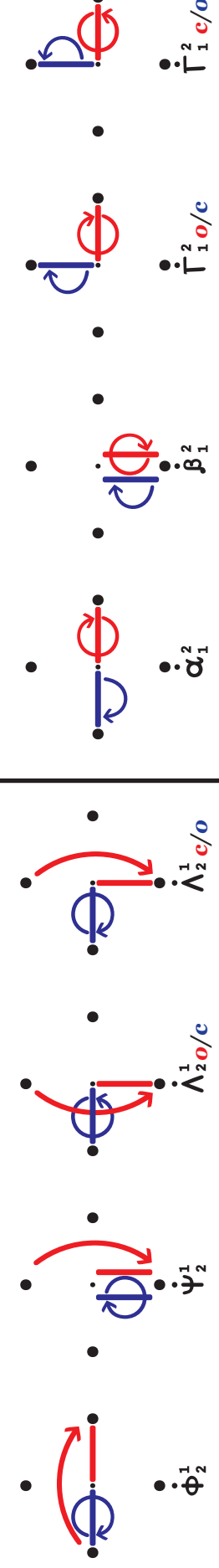
Same



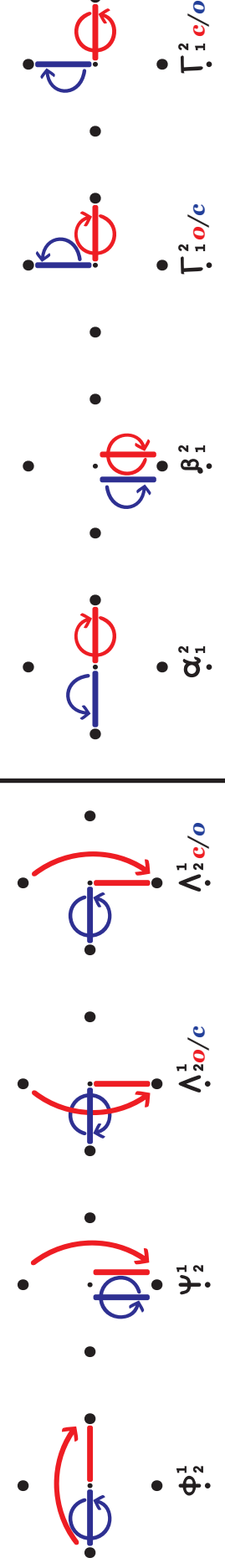
Opp



Same



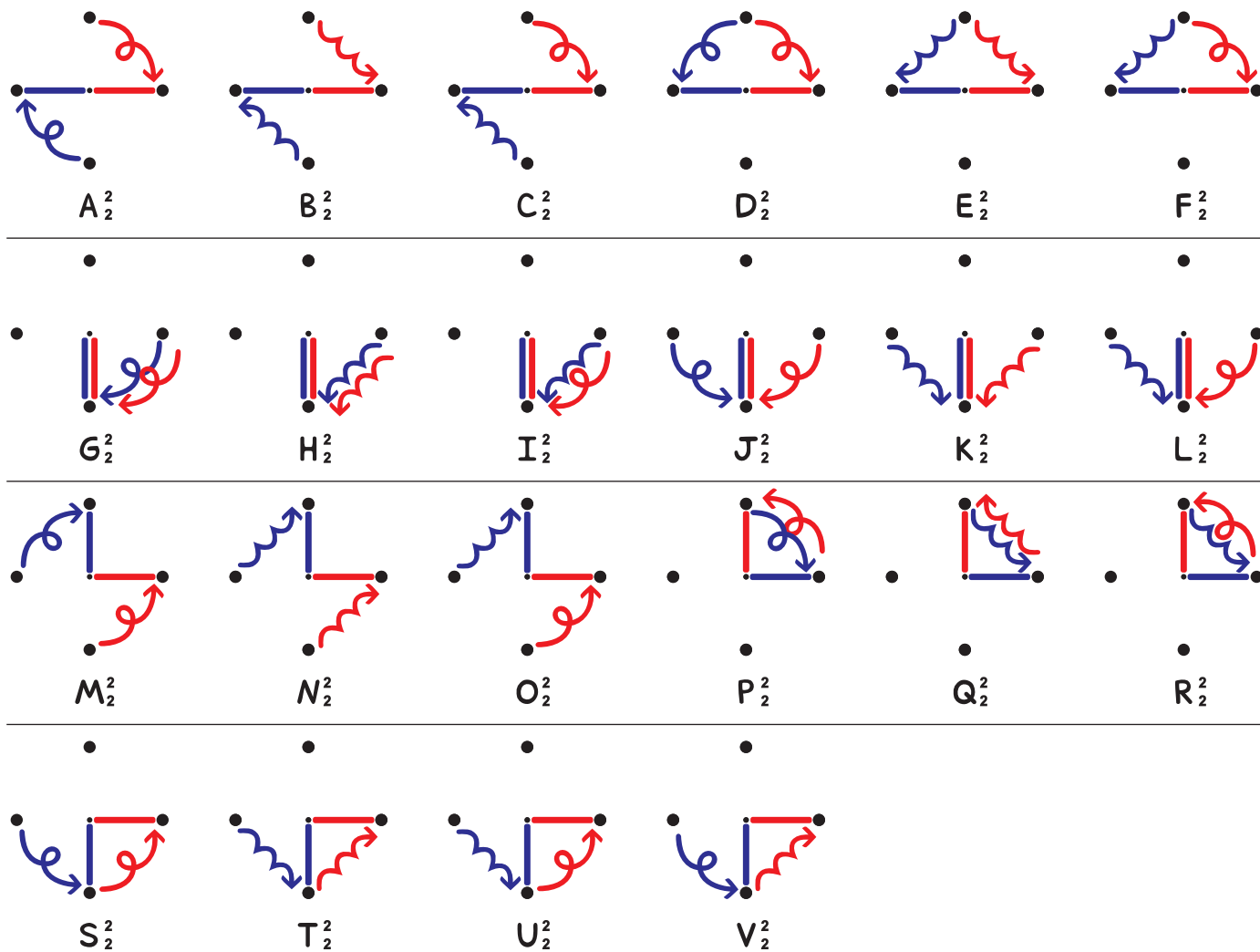
Opp





# 2 | 2

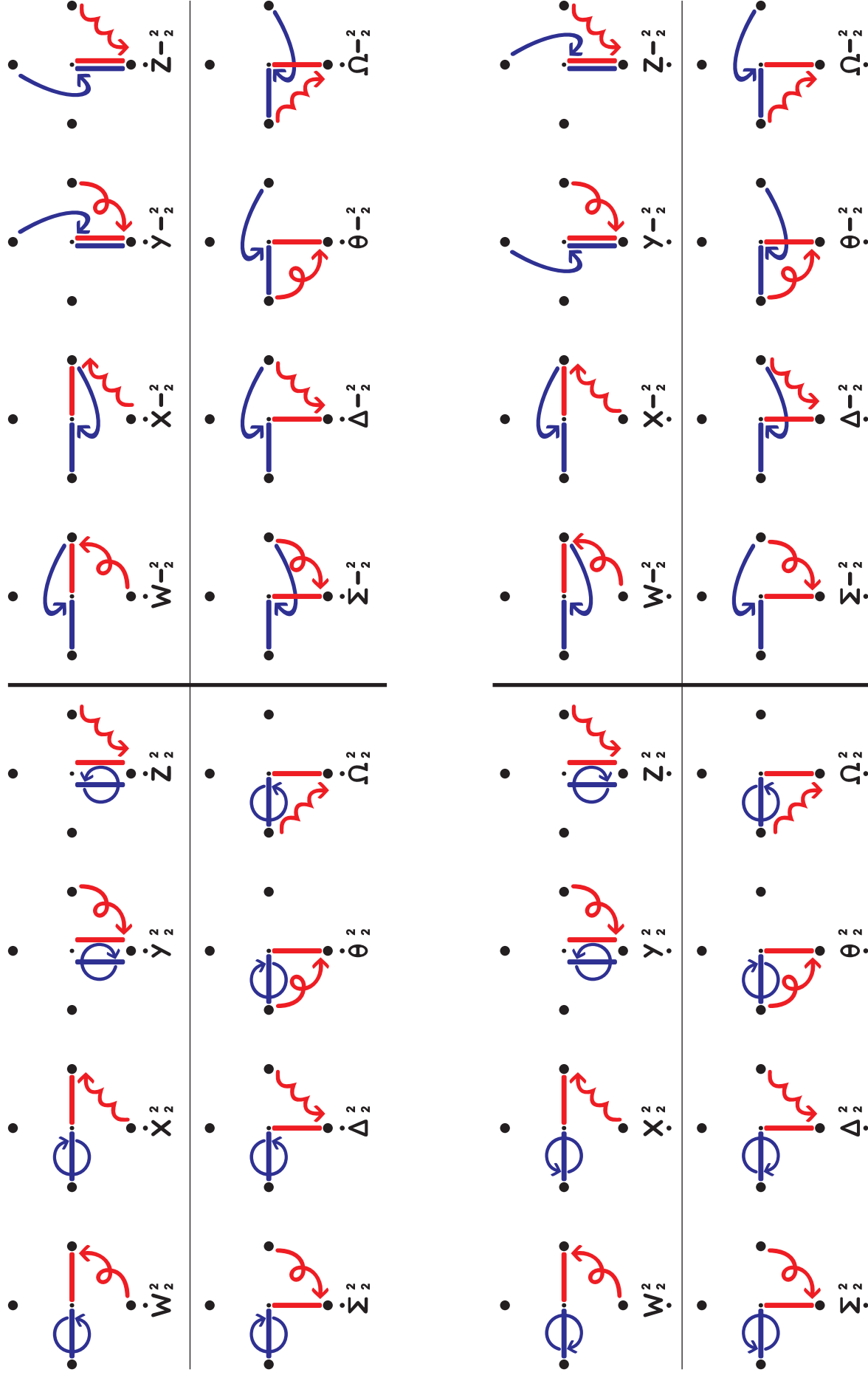
## Type 1 - Dual-Shift



# Type 2 - Shift

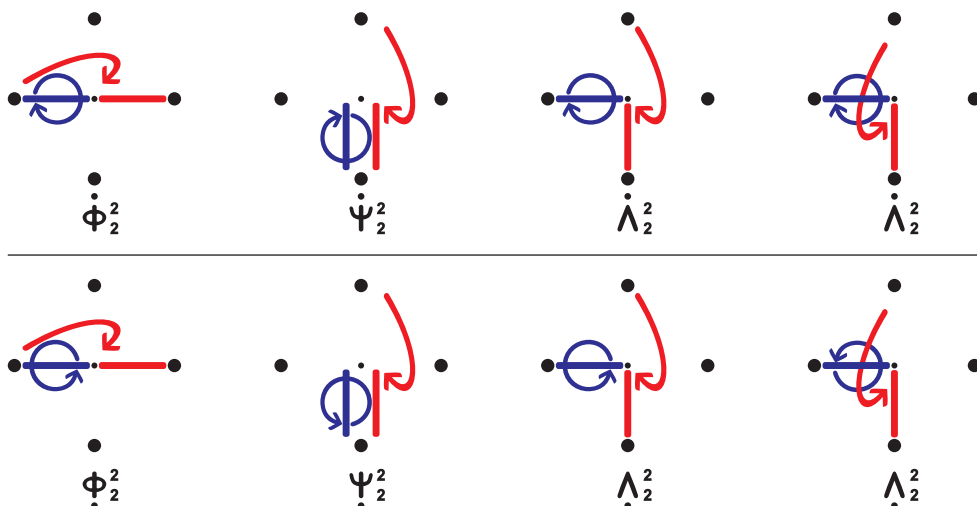
2 | 2

# Type 3 - Cross-Shift

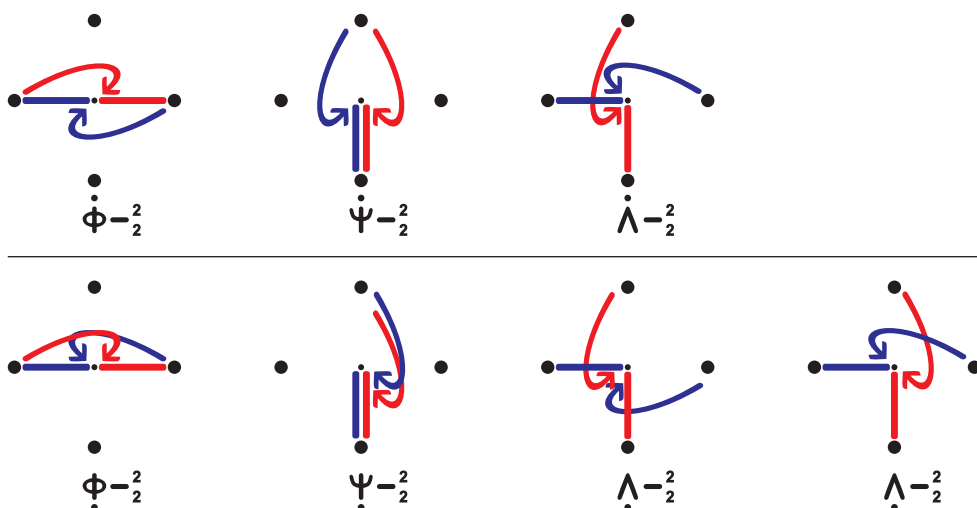


## Type 4 - *Dash*

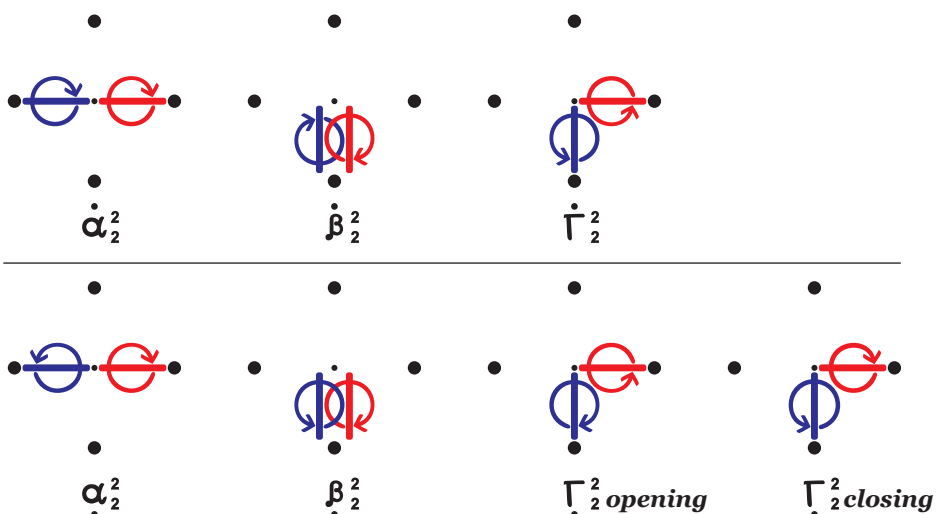
2 | 2



## Type 5 - *Dual-Dash*

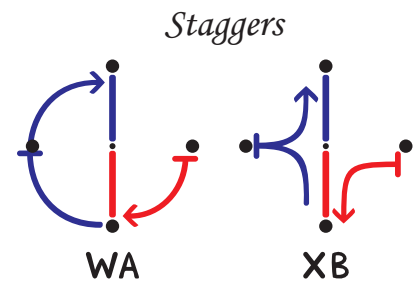
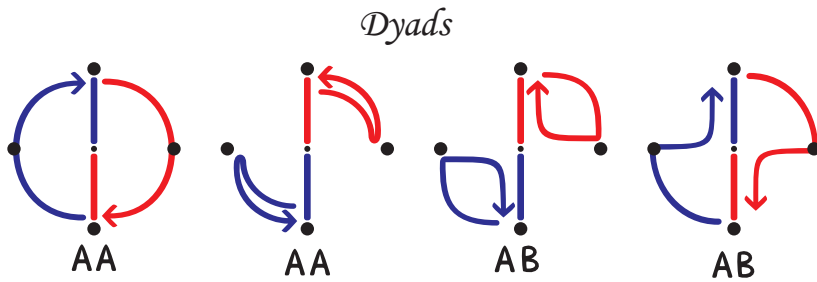


## Type 6 - *Static*

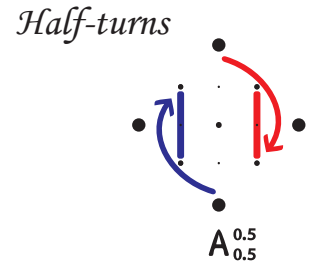
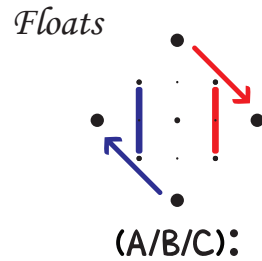
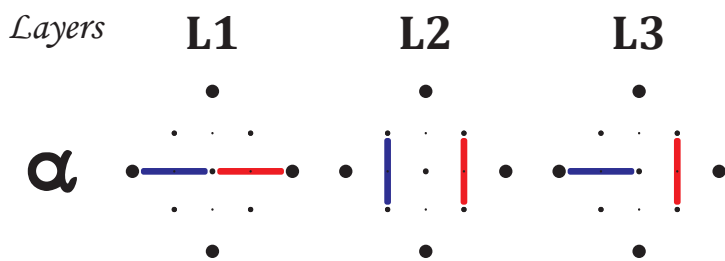


# You did it! What's next?

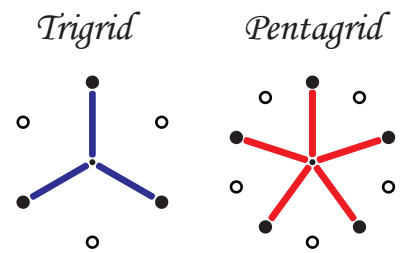
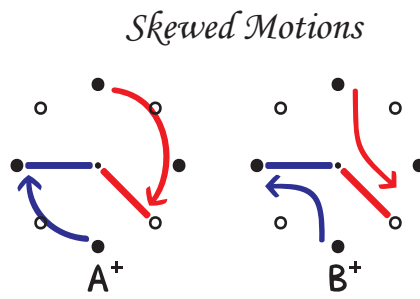
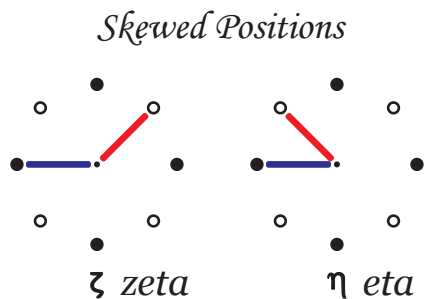
Congratulations for making it to the end of Level 1!  
The quest is far from over. Here's a sneak peek of what lies ahead:



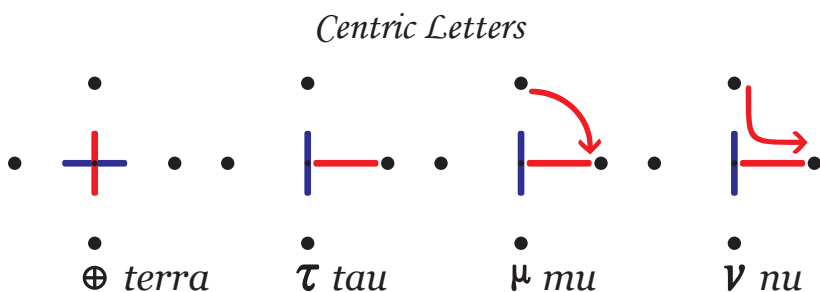
In **Level 2**, we'll cover the Dyads - pictographs containing every two-letter word in the Alphabet. We'll also learn about staggered motions. This forms the basis for *The Kinetic Dictionary*.



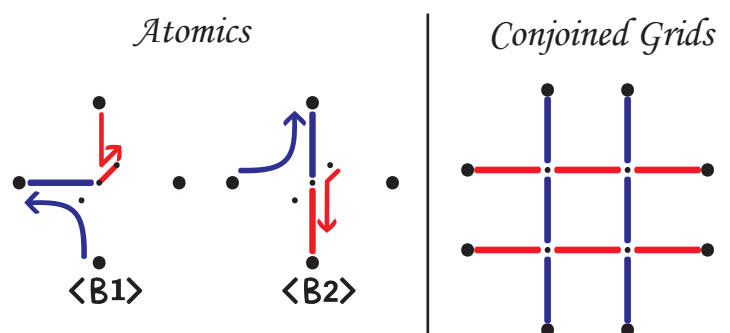
In **Level 3**, we'll explore Layers 2 and 3, multiplying the possibilities by adding variations to our base positions. We'll learn how to use floats and half-turns to traverse Layers.



In **Level 4**, we'll cover skews, where one hand is in box and the other is in diamond. We'll gain two new positions - Zeta/Eta. We'll also learn about the Trigrig and the Pentagrid.



In **Level 5**, we'll learn half-shifts and half-dashes, which will reveal the centric positions Terra/Tau, and the motions Mu/Nu, completing the letters.



In **Level 6**, we'll look at multi-grid variations such as Atomic motions and conjoined grids.

# Let's collaborate!

My first goal in developing TKA is to deliver tools to facilitate your choreo journey.

My second goal is to personally collaborate with you. Yes, *you*!

The sequences in The Kinetic Alphabet are so much more dynamic and engaging when applied by multiple performers set to music and dance!

Whether in a tunnel, side by side, staggered, or with mirrored/rotated variations,  
***The development of group choreography is the whole point of this system.***

**Let's craft sequences together!**

**Reach out @austenccloud**



Taco Tuesday Flow Jams are a celebration of flow arts and community! They're located in Chicago, IL in the heart of Palmer Square Park (2200 N Kedzie Blvd).

They've been around since 2017 and continue to be a weekly oasis for flow artists, jugglers, and acrobats to gather and share the joy of our art forms.

As a public outdoor event, it's sustained by the attendance of the people who show.

If you're thinking "*Is it happening this week? I'd love to go!*", then ask:

- Is the weather nice?
- Is it Tuesday?

If the answer is yes to both, then there will surely be people gathering in the park in the afternoon/evening, regardless of an event page or announcement!

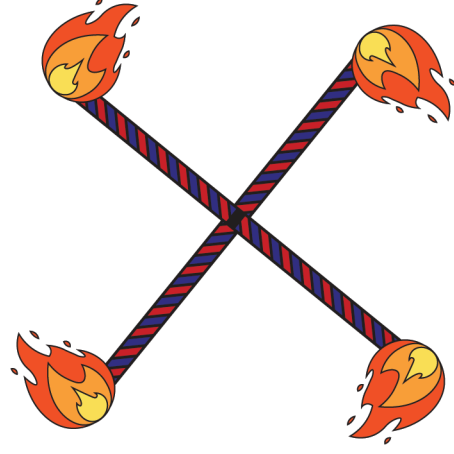
***Our glorious deity TacoCat welcomes you with paws wide open!***

Why not take a 5-minute stretch?

Your muscles will thank you with flexibility and longevity.

Don't neglect those hamstrings!

Go to  
*[TheKineticAlphabet.com](http://TheKineticAlphabet.com)*  
to download this book  
and the latest TKA software!



For feedback or collaboration,  
reach out at [TKA.FlowArts@gmail.com](mailto:TKA.FlowArts@gmail.com)

@TheKineticAlphabet